SUNDAY
October 11, 2026

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सत्यमेव जयते
Government of India

GOVERNMENT OF TAMILNADU
TRUTH ALONE TRIUMPHS

Driving Tamil Nadu's Growth through Modern Infrastructure

Inauguration, Dedication to the Nation and Foundation Stone Laying for Various Development Projects Worth Over Rs.13,000 Crore

INAUGURATION

- First 14.64 km Elevated Stretch of Chennai Metro Rail Phase–II
- 4-Laned Projects of NH-744 & NH-744A
- Major Port Infrastructure Projects
- 5 Amrit Bharat Stations - Palani, Namakkal, Paramakkudi, Ambasamudram, Vellore Cantt

LAYING OF FOUNDATION STONE

- Construction of 4-Lane Thiruvarur Bypass on NH-83
- 250 MW / 500 MWh Battery Energy Storage System - Ottapidaram, Anuppankulam & Kayatharu
- Group II/III Lube Oil Base Stocks (LOBS) Project
- Developmental projects of Kamarajar Port and V.O. Chidambaranar Port

DEDICATION TO THE NATION

- Karaikal – Peralam Rail Line and 3 Rail Flyovers

ANNOUNCEMENT

- Brain Atlas and "100 Human Brains" Mission

BENEFITS OF THE PROJECTS

- Travel time from Poonamallee Bypass to Porur Junction will be 20 minutes, while the journey from Porur Junction to Vadapalani will take 18 minutes by metro, saving time.
- Boosts the country's world-class, high-performance lubricant manufacturing capability.
- Enhances railway capacity and operational efficiency while boosting tourism and local economic growth.
- NH-744 & NH-744A - Strengthens connectivity in southern Tamil Nadu.
- Mission to create publicly accessible, cell-resolution 3D brain atlases across the human lifespan and diseases, advancing neuroscience research and enabling new insights into brain disorders, including stroke.
- Boosts trade, improves cargo movement and public facilities, and promotes cleaner, safer, and more sustainable port operations.

by

Hon'ble Prime Minister
Thiru. **NARENDRA MODI**

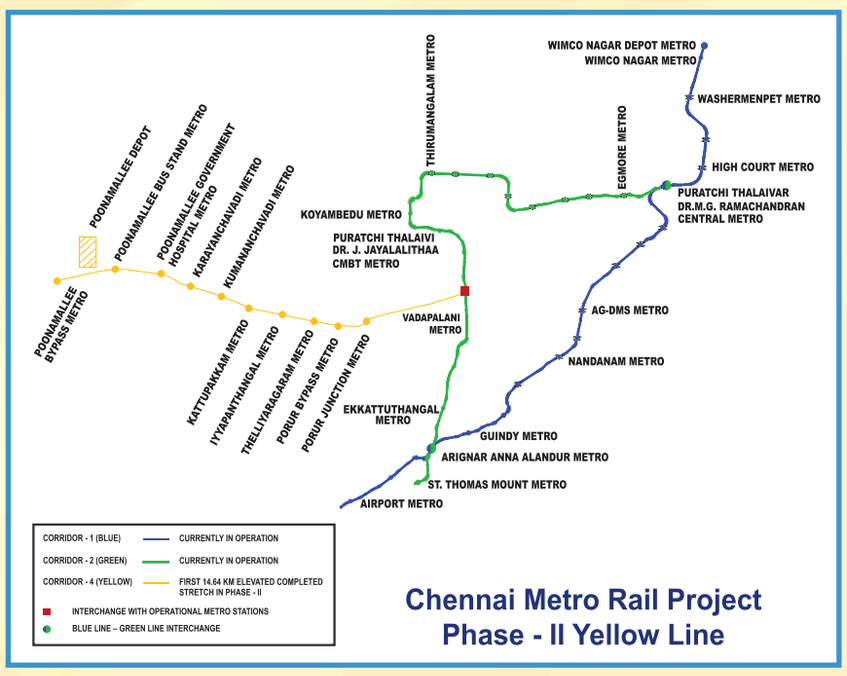
In the August Presence of

Hon'ble Governor of Tamil Nadu
Thiru. **RAJENDRA VISHWANATH ARLEKAR**

Hon'ble Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu
Thiru. **C. JOSEPH VIJAY**

Hon'ble Union Minister for Housing and Urban Affairs
Thiru. **MANOHAR LAL**

Date : 11.10.2026 (Sunday) **Time 1:30 pm.** **Venue : K.V.Ground, IIT Madras Campus, Chennai.**



Chennai Metro Rail Project
Phase - II Yellow Line

Dr.M. Sai Kumar, I.A.S.,
Chief Secretary to Government.

Watch the above event live on DD News Channel

DIPR / 878 / DISPLAY / 2026

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice

Following E-tenders are invited by DRM (Engg.) NWR/Ajmer at 15.00 Hrs. on the mentioned date. **Tender No.:** 119/2026 **Name of work:** AMC including Supply and Repair of Spare Parts of 07 Nos. MODSONIC Make B scan 9-Channel DRT USFD Machines for USFD unit, Ajmer. **Approximate Cost:** Rs. 2,19,03,781.12 **Earnest Money:** Rs. 4,38,100.00. **Tender Closing Date:** 16.10.2026. **Tender No.:** 120/2026. **Name of work:** Shallow Screening by SBCM & Deep screening of point and crossing. **Approximate Cost:** Rs. 5,69,21,566.82. **Earnest Money:** Rs. 11,38,400.00. **Tender Closing Date:** 21.10.2026. **Tender No.:** 121/2026. **Name of work:** Abu Road: Renovation and infrastructure improvement of existing DTTC/ABR. **Approximate Cost:** Rs. 98,09,978.32. **Earnest Money:** Rs. 1,96,200.00. **Tender Closing Date:** 23.10.2026. **Tender No.:** 122/2026 **Name of work:** Day to Day maintenance work under ADEN/BHL Sub division from km 9/500 to 175/450 in All-CNA section for 02 year. **Approximate Cost:** Rs. 5,24,77,283.42. **Earnest Money:** Rs. 10,49,600.00. **Tender Closing Date:** 29.10.2026. The detailed information of the above tender is available on website **www.ireps.gov.in** and Tender Notice Board of DRM Office, NWR/Ajmer.

1457-MG/26

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North Eastern Railway

Tender Notice

Chief Signal & Telecom Engineer/Tele /HQ, N. E. Railway, Gorakhpur for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tender for the following works from the contractors having sufficient experience as per eligibility criteria mentioned in tender document. **1. Tender no:** NER_SnT_PRO_GKP_1_2026 **2. Name of work:** "Hiring of Project Supervision Services Agency (PSSA) for the Supervision of KAVACH & its associated works in Sitapur city[Ex] - Burhwal, Burhwal Jn. - Gorakhpur Cantt., Manaknagar [Ex]- Lucknow Jn .- Malhaur [Ex] & Barabanki [Ex]- Burhwal of Lucknow Division and Gorakhpur Cantt.[Ex] - Goldenganj [Ex] of Varanasi Division on North Eastern Railway" **3. Tender Value:** Rs. 69228939.38/-(Six Crore Ninety Two Lakh Twenty-Eight Thousand Nine hundred Thirty-Nine Rupees and Thirty-eight Paisa only). **4. Bid Security:** Rs. 13,84,600/- (Rs. Thirteen Lakh Eighty-Four Thousand Six Hundred Rupees only/-) **5. Validity of offer:** 120 days **6. Place, Date & Time of closing and opening of Tender:** Office of the PCSTE office, N.E. Rly, Gorakhpur. 25/11/2026 at15:00 Hrs **7. Completion Period:** 24 months **8. Website where details of the tender notice & documents are available:** www.ireps.gov.in **9.** For any changes of tender, Please check on internet website for Corrigendum of the original tender notice. **10** The Bid Security shall be deposited either in cash through e-payment gateway or submitted as Bank Guarantee bond from a schedule commercial bank of India or as mention in tender document. **11** The tenders/bidders must have Class III digital signatures and must have to register on IREPS portal. Only registered tenders/bidders can participate on e-tendering. **12** All relevant papers must be uploaded at the time of participating in tendering process. **13** Detailed tender notice, Eligibility criteria, terms & conditions are available at website http://www.ireps.gov.in

Dy CSTE/Project/GKP
CPRO/Sig-130 **Gorakhpur**

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CHITTARANJAN LOCOMOTIVE WORKS

OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Open Tenders are invited for and on behalf of the President of India for the following work: **Sl. No. [1] .Tender No. : ELB92WELDINGSIMULATOR. Name of Work :** Supply, installation and commissioning of Welding Simulator with all standard concomitant accessories as per Scope of Work and detailed Technical Specifications. **Tender Value (₹):** 3665227.00. **Cost of Tender Document (₹):** Nil. **Earnest Money Deposit (₹):** 73300.00. **Period of Completion :** 90 Months. **NOTE: (i) Date of Closing:** 28-10-2026 at 15:00 hrs. **(ii)** Complete details can be seen in the Railway website **www.ireps.gov.in. (iii) Tender Calling Authority:** Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer / ELB, CLW, Chittaranjan. **(iv) Contact No.:** 9163340319. **(v) Email Id: dycmeelb@clw.railnet.gov.in.**

Dy. CME/ELB, CLW/
PR5/517 **CHITTARANJAN**

visit us on:www.facebook.com/clwrailways

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE (Single Stage Two Packet System on EPC mode basis)

Chief Electrical Engineer, Project, North Western Railway, Jaipur for and on behalf of the President of India invites Open E-Tender. Tenderer shall on-line submit their original/revised offer before the date and time of closing of E-tender. **E-Tender Notice No.:** EL-PROJ-PSI-JP-EPC-02. **Name of work with location.:** Design, Supply, Erection, Testing & Commissioning of 132/55 KV Traction Substation, Sectioning post (SPs) and Sub sectioning post (SSPs) in 2x25 KV Traction System (Scott Connected Transformer) in Bandikui-Jaipur section of Jaipur Division of North Western Railway. **Approximate cost of work:** Rs. 1,52,81,07,371.06/-. **Earnest Money to be deposited**: Rs. 3,05,62,200.00/-. **Completion Period:** 540 Days. **Closing Date & Time of submission of on-line E-tender:** 11/12/2026 (15:00 hrs.). **Website particulars where complete details of E-Tender can be seen:** www.ireps.gov.in. **Note:** No manual tender will be accepted. **1458-MG/26**

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WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY

OPEN TENDER

CE/Procurement West Central Railway, JBP for and on behalf of President of India invites E- Tenders against tender notice no. CPCWCR-07-2026,CPCWCR-08-2026, CPCWCR-10-2026, CPCWCR-11-2026 Dated: 06.10.2026. The Closing date will be 02.11.2026 at 15.00 Hrs. Bidders will be able to submit their original/revised bids up to closing date and time only. Manual offers will not be entertained against the above tender and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. The tender shall be opened at the notified date and time. **(1) NIT No.:** CPCWCR-07-2026, **Dated:** 06.10.2026 **Name of Work with location:** Execution of balance works i.e. drain & toe wall, and other Protection works of cutting area miscellaneous Civil Engineering works between Ghatoli station to Biaorastation, in the State of Rajasthan & Madhya Pradesh, in connection with the Ramganjmandi-Bhopal New BG Rail Line Project of Kota Division, West Central Railway Project. **Approximate Cost of the work:** ₹ 26,55,30,328.81/- **Earnest Money:** ₹ 53,10,700/- **Completion Period:** 06 Months including monsoon **(2) NIT No.:** CPCWCR-08-2026, **Dated:** 06.10.2026 **Name of Work with location:** Construction of Staff Quarters at (Gajrahi, Bahari, Deosar and Gondawali station and overhead & UNDER GROUND water tank with Water supply & distribution pipe line, including Plumbing, Bore well, Hand pump, Drainage, Sewerage & Sanitary work with Septic tank, boundary wall, Road work and other Miscellaneous work between Sidhi-Gondawali section and Miscellaneous protection works for Major/Minor bridges, high embankment slope protection, RCC Toe wall/Gabion wall at locations where water flowing parallel to alignment between Rampur Naiken to Sidhi in connection with Sidhi-Singrauli New BG Rail Line Project. **Approximate Cost of the work:** ₹ 85,57,49,295.24/- **Earnest Money:** ₹ 1,71,15,000/- **Completion Period:** 18 Months including monsoon **(3) NIT No.:** CPCWCR-10-2026, **Dated:** 06.10.2026 **Name of Work with location:** Heavy repairs to 28-unit (Type-II - 24 units, Type-III - 4 units) quarters at Saugor Nehru colony. **Approximate Cost of the work:** ₹ 3,12,91,194.34/- **Earnest Money:** ₹ 6,25,900/- **Completion Period:** 08 Months including monsoon **(4) NIT No.:** CPCWCR-11-2026, **Dated:** 06.10.2026 **Name of Work with location:** Supply installation and commissioning of track based rail gauge face lubricator (Electronic Type)-105 Nos in construction projects of WCR. **Approximate Cost of the work:** ₹ 10,92,57,325.20/- **Earnest Money:** ₹ 21,85,200/- **Completion Period:** 60 Months including monsoon **Time and Date of Closing & Opening of E-Tender:** Tender Sr.no 1, 2, 3 & 4: Closing at 15:00 hrs. & opening after 15:00 hrs on 02.11.2026. Tenderers are required to submit their bid online through IREPS website https://www.ireps.gov.in. Tenderers are advised to regularly visit IREPS website https://www.ireps.gov.in to note any changes/corrigendum. Minimum Eligibility Criteria as per; tender form shall be applicable for this tender.

(SD.)
Dy. CE/(Procurement) HQ/Con., WCR, Jabalpur

स्वच्छ भारत अभियान एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

RAIL WHEEL FACTORY

YELAHANKA, BENGALURU – 560 064.
Website: www.rwf.indianrailways.gov.in

TENDER NOTICE No: RWF/S/146/ 2026-27/09 Dated: 09.10.2026

On behalf of the President of India, Principal Chief Materials Manager invites E-Bids through the IREPS E-Portal **http://www.ireps.gov.in**

Tender No. RWFSS_RT_CWS2nd Slab Name of the work: Carriage of Condemned Wheel sets from various locations of Indian Railways to RWF. **Distance Slab:** 500Kms & up-to lead distance of 1000Km. **Approx Qty: 1100MT. Estimated value:** ₹ 48,29,000/- **EMD:** ₹ 96,600/-; **Contract Period:** 24 months from LOA.**Tender Closing Date: 02.11.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.**
Detailed Scope & corrigendum will be available in IREPS E-Portal.

Principal Chief Materials Manager

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JAPIT

Jharkhand Agency for Promotion of Information Technology
(An Autonomous body under Department of IT & e-Governance, Govt. of Jharkhand)
Ground Floor, Engineer's Hostel – I, Near Golchakkar, Dhurwa, Ranchi, Jharkhand
Phone. 0651-2401044/2401067,
E-mail- japit_doit@rediffmail.com

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

Item	Description
Tendering Authority	JAP-IT, Ranchi, on behalf of the Department of Home, Jail & Disaster Management, Govt. of Jharkhand
Name of Work	Selection of Service Provider for Supply, Installation, Commissioning and Maintenance of CCTV Based Surveillance System at Police Stations Buildings in Jharkhand
Mode of Tendering	Online, on the GeM portal (https://gem.gov.in) Bids in any other mode shall not be accepted.
Method of Selection	L1-cum-Reverse Auction as per GeM's guideline
Contract Period	Supply, installation & commissioning followed by 5 years comprehensive on-site warranty & maintenance from Go-Live,
EMD	Rs. 1,50,00,000/- (Rupees One Crore Fifty Lakh only), valid for 180 days, in the form of Bank Guarantee from a Nationalized/Scheduled Bank in favour of CEO, JAP-IT. The bank account detail of JAP-IT is as under: Account No-115201001768 Account Name-Jharkhand Agency for Promotion of Information Technology JAP IT IFSC Code-ICIC0001152 MICR CODE-834229005 SOL ID/BRANCH-1152/Ashok Nagar Ranchi, Jharkhand.
Availability of RFP	Downloadable from the portal from the date of publication
Pre-Bid Meeting	15.10.2026, 03:00 PM (offline mode)
Last Date and time for Online Bid Submission	29.10.2026, 03:00 pm
Technical Bid Opening	30.10.2026, 03:00 PM
Bid Validity	180 days from the date of opening of the Technical Bid;
Place of Pre-Bid Meeting/ Communication	JAP-IT, Ground Floor, Engineers Hostel 1, Near Golchakkar, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004
Contact	ceo.japit@jharkhandmail.gov.in, japit_doit@rediffmail.com; 0651-2401044/67

1. The Bidders are advised to submit the Bids well in advance. JAP-IT/GoJ will not be responsible for any delay in submission due to portal or connectivity issues.
2. Any corrigendum/amendment to this RFP shall be published only on the portal and shall be binding; no separate communication shall be made.
3. All modifications to any clause of this RFP, including the Technical Specifications, shall be made only by such published corrigendum.

Sd/-
Chief Executive Officer, JAP-IT

PR 391490 Information Technology (26-27)_D

CRIS — Centre For Railway Information Systems

Chanakyapuri, New Delhi-110021

TENDER NOTICE

Tender No. : 01265266, Subject: Expansion of ExaCC installed in CRIS Primary DC at Chanakyapuri. Date of Closing: **03.11.2026** (Tuesday) at **15:30 hrs.**
Tender Documents may be downloaded from Website **www.ireps.gov.in**. For future modification/extensions please see **www.ireps.gov.in**.

THE HINDU

Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 15/-

KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD

(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
No.2, 2/1 and 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar, Bengaluru-560009.
Phone No. 080-22265383, Website: www.kiadb.in

CORRIGENDUM AMENDMENT

Advertisement No. IADB/ENGG/ETND-EP-39/1726/2026-27 Date: 08.10.2026 published in this newspapers on **09.10.2026**. The word **"Eligible Contractor to be read as Scheduled Caste Contractors"** There are no other changes.

DIPR/CP/3161/ SMCL/2026-27

Sd/-
Engineer in Chief, KIADB, Bengaluru

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, NATIONAL HIGHWAY CIRCLE, KEONJHAR

Email :- senhkeonjhar@gmail.com

Letter No.1799, dt.09.10.2026

2nd Corrigendum Notice to NIT
Bid Identification No. CCE NHC KJR-04/2026-27/1641 dt.30.09.2026

Name of the Work :- Construction of Twin E-Type (G+1) Quarter at Baripada under NH Division, Baripada for 2026-27.

Bid Identification No.CCE NHC KJR-04/2026-27/Letter no.1641

Description of Corrigendum

1. The Bid documents will be available in the website **www.tendersodisha.gov.in** from **11:00 Hours of 12.10.2026 to 17:30 Hours of 26.10.2026** instead of 28.10.2026 upto 16:00 hours for online bidding.
2. Bids shall be received only "On-line" on or before **17:30 Hours of 26.10.2026** instead of 28.10.2026 upto 16:00 hours
3. Bids received **"On-line"** shall be opened at **11:30 Hours on 27.10.2026** instead of 29.10.2026 upto 13:00 hours.

The authority reserves the right to cancel any bid without assigning any reason.
All other terms and conditions contained in the NIT and Bidding Document remain unchanged.

Chief Construction Engineer, N.H.Circle, Keonjhar.
34001/995/2627 OIPR-34001/34145/1/26-27/0003

कार्यालय, कार्यपालक अभियंता, एन० आर० ई० पी०, सिमडेगा

अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना (2nd Call)

ई–निविदा संख्या –02-R/2026-27/NREP/SIMDEGA दिनांक – 09.10.2026

1. कार्य का विवरण :–

क्र0	प्रखण्ड का नाम	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि		परिमाण विपत्र की राशि (रूपये में)	अग्रधन की राशि (रूपये में)	कार्य अवधि
			अंक में (लाख में)	अक्षर में			
1	सिमडेगा	स्पोर्ट्स कॉम्पलेक्स बाजारटांड, सिमडेगा में 50 शैयावाले बालक खेल छात्रावास निर्माण।	2,83.03	दो करोड़ तिरासी लाख तीन हजार।	10,000.00	5,66,100.00	14 Months

2 Date of publication of Bid on Website :- 15.10.2026 at 10:00 AM
3 Mode of Submission of Tender :- Online Through www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in
4 Bid submission start date :- 15.10.2026, 10:00 AM onwards
5 Last date and Time of Online submission of Bid :- 29.10.2026 by 03:00 PM
6 Bid Opening Date and Time :- 31.10.2026 at 11:00 AM
7 Tender inviting Authority :- Executive Engineer, N.R.E.P., Simdega

विस्तृत जानकारी वेबसाईट www.jharkhandternders.gov.in एवं कार्यालय के नोटिस बोर्ड पर देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यापालक अभियंता
एन0 आर0 ई0 पी0, सिमडेगा

PR 391516 Simdega (26-27)_D

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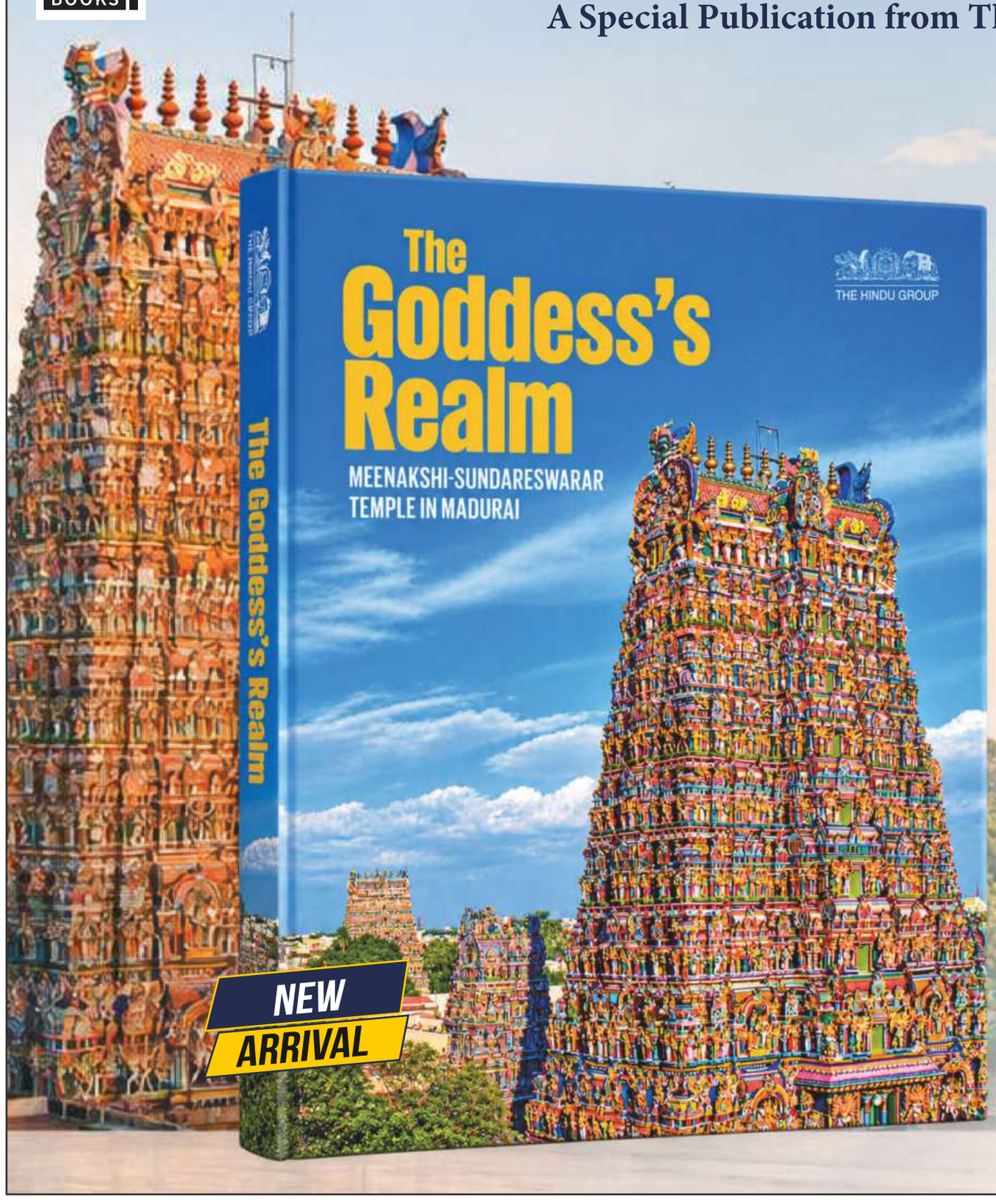

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October 11, 2026

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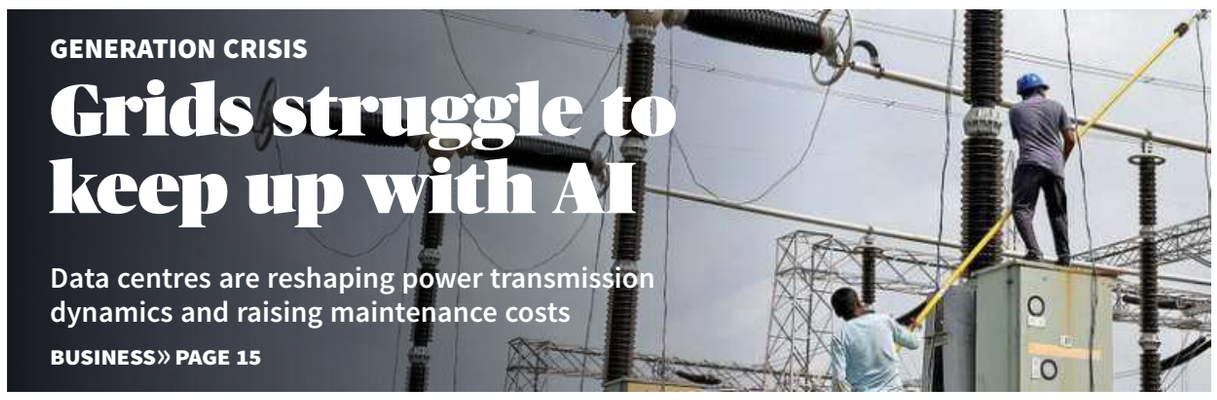

GENERATION CRISIS

Grids struggle to keep up with AI

Data centres are reshaping power transmission dynamics and raising maintenance costs

BUSINESS» PAGE 15

Trump strikes deal for diesel with Putin

WORLD » PAGE 19

T.N. may encounter El Niño differently

SCIENCE » PAGE 16

Shreyas' men will look to hit back in third T20I

SPORT » PAGE 20

Thousands held in capital clampdown

- Heavy security, transport curbs fail to stop inflow of anti-CEC protesters to Delhi
- Ex-CMs, journalists, lawyers among those detained; several picked up overnight
- 'Unprecedented' deployment leaves commercial hubs deserted in the city

Shrimansi Kaushik
Lavpreet Kaur
Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

On their toes: Security personnel rush to disperse protesters near Connaught Place on Saturday. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

Despite heavy security arrangements, transport restrictions, and an Internet shutdown, protesters on Saturday managed to reach locations near Jantar Mantar in central Delhi to demand the exit of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar over alleged electoral irregularities. With the designated protest site inaccessible, protesters led by All India Students Association (AISA) president Neha Bora attempted to assemble at Dilli Haat in south Delhi before being detained.

According to Delhi Police sources, nearly 2,500 protesters were detained across the capital during the day, indicating a high turnout despite the absence of prominent Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) leaders on the ground. A few journalists were also detained. These were in addition to around 1,000 people picked up in preventive operations across Delhi overnight ahead of the protest. Several lawyers who were also detained were released following an intervention by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant. While YouTuber Dhruv Rathee was detained from his residence in the morning, CJP leaders Abhijeet Dipke, Ashutosh Ranka, and Saurav Das were taken immediately after their flight from Mumbai landed at Delhi airport. The CJP leaders had publicly announced their visit on social media, urging supporters to assemble at Jantar Mantar at 10 a.m. on Saturday for what they described as the "Final Call to Save Democracy".

Connaught Place, one of Delhi's busiest commercial hubs, wore a deserted look amid an "unprecedented" security deployment in recent times, with multiple layers of barricading and police personnel restricting public movement. All roads leading to Jantar Mantar were barricaded, with loudspeakers warning people of legal action if they defied instructions.

Detention centres

The youth-led protest, called by Left groups, the CJP, and civil society groups, kept the police and security forces on their toes as police forcibly removed protesters, put them in buses, and took them to large halls and stadiums on the outskirts of Delhi that had been converted into detention centres. Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance (INDIA) leaders, including four former Chief Ministers – Mamata Banerjee, Pinarayi Vijayan, Manik Sarkar, and Arvind Kejriwal – were also among those detained.

Majority of detainees were released by late evening. However, the main CJP leaders were not released till last reports came in.

The CJP and the Students Federation of India announced that protest march to Jantar Mantar would be organised every day till the CEC resigned.

New Delhi district was virtually fortified on Saturday, with over 20,000 security personnel, including Central Armed Police Force and the Delhi Police, holding vigil from early morning till late in the day, preventing protesters from entering the district, let alone reaching Jantar Mantar. With 45 Metro stations shut, over 200 trains arriving in Delhi cancelled, schools and colleges suspending classes, and marketplaces across central Delhi closed, protesters continued to find ways to reach the site, with some walking several kilometres.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 12

Stopping crowd from regrouping a challenging task

NEW DELHI
Though the Centre succeeded in preventing protesters from converging at Jantar Mantar on Saturday, its next challenge appeared to be stopping the largely "leaderless" crowd from regrouping. » PAGE 12

Youth bodies vow to sustain stir till CEC Kumar quits

NEW DELHI
Leaders of youth and student organisations on Saturday vowed to continue their protest until all their demands, including the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar were met. » PAGE 13

Concerned by 'mass detentions' in Delhi: UN body

NEW DELHI
The Office of the United Nations Human Rights Commissioner on Saturday said it was "concerned" by "mass detentions" and urged authorities to respect the right to peaceful protest. » PAGE 14

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi interacts with a student during an event in Chennai on Saturday. S.R. RAGHUNATHAN

Rahul lends support to student protesters

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, on Saturday urged the protesting students in Delhi to carry on without fear and stand up for what they believe in, even in the face of a state crackdown through large-scale detentions and Internet shutdowns.

Speaking at a *Maanavargalin Kural* (voice of students) event here on Saturday, Mr. Gandhi said Prime Minister Narendra Modi was attempting to silence dissenting voices through such crackdowns, oblivious of the fact that his "game is over".

"He is silencing voices, as you saw today in New Delhi. The entire city was shut down, Internet was shut down, the police were beating students, the BJP released its own thugs and goondas who were thrashing students," Mr. Gandhi told a large gathering of students and youth.

When a participant expressed concerns over the detention of students, journalists, and lawyers, without dignity and respect, Mr. Gandhi replied: "I want to make it very clear to every single student who is protesting not only in Delhi [but] across the country: You have nothing to fear. We are with you and we are going to make sure that Mr. Narendra Modi, [Union Home Minister] Amit Shah, [RSS chief] Mohan Bhagwat, [National Security Adviser] Ajit Doval, and this group of conspirators who have destroyed Indian democracy, who are using [CEC] Gyanesh Kumar to steal elections, are brought to justice."

He also alleged that Mr. Modi had been "compromised by financial and international forces".

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 12

NEARBY

Rainwater enters ASI site in Adichanallur

THOOTHUKUDI
Recent showers have resulted in rainwater entering the 'C' site of the Archaeological Survey of India in Adichanallur. Although an ASI official had said last year that a shelter would be built to cover the site, work on this has only recently begun. » PAGE 8

Private institutes can't collect caste details, says HC

MADURAI
No private educational institution or employer in the State can mandatorily collect caste details, the Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court has directed. » PAGE 8

CLASSIFIEDS » PAGES 9, 10 & 11
MAGAZINE » 8 PAGES
DOWNTOWN » 8 PAGES
(TABLOID) (IN SELECT AREAS)

PM to launch CMRL's Phase 2 stretch today

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

Six years since the work on the Chennai Metro Rail Limited's (CMRL) Phase 2 network began, the first train from Porur Bypass is all set to run till Poonamallee on Sunday, with Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay among the first few commuters.

While the first stretch of the project will be opened from Poonamallee to Vadapalani for commuters, Mr. Modi and Mr. Vijay will only travel between Poonamallee and Porur Bypass.

After the flag-off around 11.30 a.m., the Phase 2 project will be inaugurated, along with a slew of other projects, at the Indian Institute of Technology-Madras around 2 p.m. It is to be noted that commuters can take a ride on the Poonamallee-Vadapalani stretch after 4 p.m.

FULL REPORT ON » PAGE 6

Several hurt in Saudi Arabia airport attack

Associated Press
CAIRO

U.S. President Trump says he is evaluating whether to join Saudi Arabia's strikes against Houthi rebels

Amid growing hostilities with the Iran-backed Houthi rebels in Yemen, Saudi Arabian officials on Saturday said the airport in capital Riyadh was attacked again and evacuated. A missile struck a complex housing terminals 3 and 4 for domestic flights at the Riyadh airport and many people were wounded, an official said.

The latest attack comes days after three Saudi Arabian citizens were killed as the kingdom faces an extraordinary series of assaults in the new front in the Iran war.

U.S. President Donald Trump told presspersons he was evaluating whether the U.S. should join Saudi Arabia's strikes against the Houthi rebels.

FULL REPORT ON » PAGE 19

Woman among 5 killed in Manipur clashes

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

The attacks followed a security operation carried out between October 4 and 7 along the Myanmar border. FILE PHOTO

At least five people, a woman among them, have been killed in clashes between armed groups and attacks on villages in separate incidents in Manipur's Kamjong and Ukhrul districts since Friday evening.

Two Naga civilians were also reported missing from the Litan area in Ukhrul district, where a Gurkha farmer from Senapati district, identified as 40-year-old Sandeep Rai, was gunned down while driving on the Mahadev-Talui road on Saturday. Former Manipur Chief Minister Nongthombam Biren Singh and people living along the India-Myanmar border said that seven people had died in the renewed violence.

The two additional deaths that they claimed were reportedly members of the extremist Kuki National Army (Burma), which allegedly attacked Naga border villages in the Naga-majority Kamjong district. These deaths were not officially confirmed

The attacks followed a security operation carried out between October 4 and 7, during which the Indian Army and the paramilitary Assam Rifles detected and defused 27 improvised explosive devices planted along an 8-km stretch of the Myanmar border in Kamjong district.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 12

CREDAI TAMILNADU

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Visible change: In a contrast to his Assembly poll campaign, when he made personal appearances only in a handful of areas, TVK leader and Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay devoted two days each to Dharapuram and Madurantakam, seeking votes with his nominees. S. SIVA SARAVANAN, PTI

Two seats and Tamil Nadu's return to a political duopoly

While the ruling TVK has won both the constituencies — Madurantakam and Dharapuram — in the recent byelections, the question today is whether Tamil Nadu will shift to a bipolar political landscape, an arrangement it has been familiar with. **T. Ramakrishnan** looks beyond the results of the byelections declared on Friday

As the cliche goes, one week is a long period in politics. And five months, therefore, would technically be very long. The political changes that Tamil Nadu witnessed in the past five months since the assumption of office by the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK)-led government have been reflected in the byelections to the Madurantakam and Dharapuram Assembly constituencies, both reserved for the Scheduled Castes (SCs).

Internally, the two Dravidian parties – the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) and the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK) – witnessed high drama soon after the TVK emerged as the single largest party in the Assembly election held in April-May. Three days after C. Joseph Vijay became the Chief Minister (on May 10), a group of 25 AIADMK MLAs broke ranks with party general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami and voted in favour of the TVK in the Assembly during the trust motion. By then, most of the allies had deserted the DMK and jumped on to the TVK bandwagon. Four MLAs – two from the Congress and one MLA each from the Viduthalai Chiruthaigal Katchi and the Indian Union Muslim League – were later made Ministers. The State's first multi-party Council of Ministers was in place. Meanwhile, the AIADMK's six MLAs, who cross-voted in favour of the TVK in the Assembly in violation of the party's direction, had quit their Assembly seats and joined the ruling party. A number of former Ministers and functionaries of the party followed suit.

On expected lines

It was against this backdrop that the byelections were held on October 6. When the results were out on October 9, they were along expected lines as byelections in the State have always gone in favour of the ruling party. In that sense, the victory of the TVK in the two constituencies was not surprising. However, while it was definitely among the probabilities, it was nevertheless not considered a certainty for a couple of reasons: first, the TVK did not secure a majority of its own in the April-May Assembly election, though it had a vote share of about 35%. Second, given a high degree of SC representation in the Cabinet, the talk had been doing the rounds in political and bureaucratic circles about the possible consolidation of intermediary castes, accounting for a substantial section of the population in the two constituencies.

Factors that were also expected to impact the elections included old caste and political alignments. In Dharapuram, the ruling party came third five months ago, securing around 23% of the votes polled. Besides, the constituency, where the intermediary community of Kongu Vellala Gounders accounts for around 40% and the SCs around 30% of the electors, is the AIADMK's traditional stronghold in the western belt. In a conversation a few weeks ago, a TVK Minister sounded more confident about his party's prospects in Madurantakam than in Dharapuram. Another factor in the mix was that the two TVK candidates had been victors in the Assembly election, as AIADMK candidates. A significant feature of the byelections was that the number of complaints about money distribution was fewer than in the past.

Apart from the changes in political alignments, the big change that was noticed in the byelections was the manner Mr. Vijay had campaigned in the two places. In a stark contrast to his propaganda work during the Assembly election, when he made personal appearances only in a handful of areas, he devoted two days each to Madurantakam and Dharapuram, taking along his nominees with him on the campaign vehicle. His campaign tour was packed with drama: he had a cup of tea at a roadside shop; drove a tractor; had a bullock cart ride; and even plucked drumsticks at a farm. "Mr. Vijay staked his personal image and aura to overcome widespread dissatisfaction with the party's candidates, particularly in Dharapuram. He literally sweated through intense public outreach and campaigning across these constituencies, while his Ministers and party workers left nothing to chance," says R. Kannan, a former diplomat-turned-writer.

> Mr. Vijay staked his personal image and aura to overcome widespread dissatisfaction with the party's candidates, particularly in Dharapuram
>
> **R. KANNAN,** former diplomat-turned-writer

Notably, in the course of his campaign, Mr. Vijay did not make any grand announcements or perceptive observations. However, both in Madurantakam and Dharapuram, he sought to project the TVK as the "true inheritor" of the legacies of AIADMK stalwarts M.G. Ramachandran and Jayalalithaa. He came down heavily on the AIADMK for "getting closer" to its traditional adversary, the DMK.

Shorn of theatrics

Comparatively, the campaigns of his political rivals seemed shorn of theatrics. Mr. Vijay's key challengers – former Chief Ministers M.K. Stalin of the DMK and Edappadi K. Palaniswami of the AIADMK – stuck to the conventional style of campaign. Both his opponents criticised Mr. Vijay for not being "serious" in matters of governance. Both attacked him and the TVK for having "forced" the byelections, which were held only to ensure that their government kept going.

Mr. Stalin charged the ruling party with being more interested in "purchasing" MLAs to protect the government. The AIADMK leader's repeated message to the electors was to teach a "befitting lesson" to the nominees of the TVK, who had crossed over from his party and were in the fray again. The Naam Tamilar Katchi and the Left were present, but their performance did not make any qualitative difference.

For all the intense campaigning by the Chief Minister, the results were not "one-sided". In both constituencies, the TVK's vote share did not exceed the 40% mark, despite the ruling party adding many parties to its alliance this time, unlike in April-May when it was on its own. The ruling party must have had its moments of anxiety when AIADMK nominee K. Banumathi was ahead of TVK candidate P. Sathyabama in the initial four rounds of counting in Dharapuram. Subsequently, the latter overtook her and DMK nominee S. Suganya finished as the runner-up.

Encouraging for the DMK

"As far as the DMK is concerned, I would say the result is, in a sense, encouraging, as we faced the electorate virtually single-handedly, barring the support of the Desiya Murpokku Dravida Kazhagam (DMDK). In both places, our vote share is about 30%, which is an achievement," says A. Subburathinam, who was elected in 1991 to the Assembly from Palani on AIADMK ticket and crossed over to the DMK early this year.

Despite the reduction in his party's vote share, former AIADMK Minister 'Pollachi' V. Jayaraman does not feel that the party's base has been eroded. He also contends that the TVK does not mean what it says. Referring to the Chief Minister's statement during the campaign on how the previous governments did not follow up properly with Keralam regarding the Anamalaiyar-Nallar scheme, a project to provide water to the western belt, the AIADMK's functionary points to reports that suddenly surfaced in the media about a group of Ministers who would go to Thiruvananthapuram on the eve of polling day to discuss the scheme. Eventually, the visit did not materialise.

Another former Minister of the AIADMK, R.B. Udhayakumar, is quick to restate that traditionally in Tamil Nadu, byelections have been favourable to the ruling party. "You have to view the outcome only that way. I do not think this will have serious implications for our party," he says.

It remains to be seen how the rebels in the party, including former Ministers S.P. Velumani and C.Ve. Shanmugam, make their next move, as they have not been able to corner Mr. Palaniswami within the organisation.

More dissidents

There is a perception that the outcome may encourage the TVK to attract more dissidents from the AIADMK to its fold. "What would cranes do in a dry pond?" asks S. Semmalai, Health and Education Minister in Jayalalithaa's Cabinet during 2001-04, who joined the TVK at Dharapuram on September 30, 2026. "We do not have to do anything, as the AIADMK's volunteers would have seen the writing on the wall when their party finished third at both the places," he explains.

Despite the TVK government being seen as one that is being propped up by diverse social groups, including the SCs, Mr. Vijay did not refer in his speeches in a significant way to his government's work and plans for the welfare of the community. After all, it is his government that has eight Ministers from the SCs. On the other hand, in the run-up to the byelections, the Chief Minister's visit to the Vanjiamman temple near Dharapuram, a place of worship dear to the Gounders, and Public Works Minister Aadhav Arjuna's reported statement about his party having 17 legislators from another intermediary community, the Vanniyars, did not go unnoticed.

A seasoned leader of the SCs from northern districts says, "It looks that the TVK, just like the DMK while in power, is of the view that there is no necessity to woo the community in a deliberate manner, as the votes of the SCs will go to it even otherwise." However, Mr. Semmalai, who hails from Salem and belongs to the Vanniyar community, says, "In the reserved constituencies, only the SCs can contest. But electors are from all communities. Besides, Mr. Vijay respects all communities, apart from representing all of them."

In a nutshell, the results, though favourable to the TVK, have not provided any overwhelming support to the ruling party and the nature of the verdict should keep Mr. Vijay and his colleagues on toes. As Dr. Kannan says, it is still too early to declare the State is shifting back to a bipolar political landscape, though current trends point to that possibility.

Eating into AIADMK votes

In Madurantakam and Dharapuram, which is the AIADMK's traditional stronghold in the western belt, the TVK put up candidates who had won as AIADMK nominees in the April-May Assembly election. In his campaign, the Chief Minister sought to project the TVK as the "true inheritor" of the legacies of AIADMK stalwarts M.G. Ramachandran and Jayalalithaa.

VOTER TURNOUT IN THE TWO CONSTITUENCIES

Year	Madurantakam			Dharapuram		
	Electorate	Votes polled	Turnout (%)	Electorate	Votes polled	Turnout (%)
2011	1,80,495	1,47,781	81.88%	2,05,145	1,62,499	79.21%
2016	2,18,831	1,77,879	81.29%	2,38,070	1,82,911	76.83%
2021	2,26,715	1,85,842	81.97%	2,58,581	1,93,991	75.02%
2026 (April-May)	2,12,666	1,98,251	93.22%	2,22,434	1,99,944	89.89%
2026 (October)	2,13,788	1,85,292	86.67%	2,23,333	1,80,532	80.84%

BREAKDOWN OF ELECTORS

Feature	Madurantakam	Dharapuram
Electors	2,13,788	2,23,333
Men	1,04,926	1,07,312
Women	1,08,797	1,16,013
Third Gender	65	8
Service Electors	27	27
First-time Electors	5,916	4,640
Persons with Disability	2,462	1,344
85 plus	1,383	2,658

HOW PEOPLE VOTED IN THESE CONSTITUENCIES

Year	Madurantakam			Dharapuram		
	VOTE SHARE					
	Winner	Runner-up	Third slot	Winner	Runner-up	Third slot
2011	AIADMK 53.64%	Congress 41.13%	Independent 1.28%	AIADMK 51.68%	DMK 42.42%	BJP 2.07%
2016	DMK 41.43%	AIADMK 39.77%	PMK 9.12%	Congress 45.67%	AIADMK 40.19%	BJP 4.24%
2021	AIADMK 46.62%	DMK 44.7%	NTK 5%	DMK 46.39%	BJP 45.67%	NTK 3.48%
2026 (April-May)	AIADMK 32.58%	TVK 29.2%	DMK 28.14%	AIADMK 40.56%	DMK 32.2%	TVK 23.23%
2026 (October)	TVK 39.96%	DMK 29.15%	AIADMK 25.61%	TVK 37.02%	DMK 31.78%	AIADMK 25.08%

Northeast monsoon onset likely around October 17, says RMC

It expects temperatures to gradually fall across State after October 16 with the withdrawal of southwest monsoon from South Peninsula

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Wet spell: An upper air cyclonic circulation may emerge in Andaman Sea around October 11 and influence a low pressure area's formation over the southeast Bay of Bengal. R. RAGU

Northeast monsoon, which is expected to bring relief from rainfall deficit and replenish rapidly depleting water resources, is likely to set in over Tamil Nadu on October 17 or 18.

As the State prepares for the onset of the monsoon later next week, the Regional Meteorological Centre (RMC) has forecast a gradual dip in the temperatures from October 16.

With the southwest monsoon expected to retreat completely from the South Peninsula by October 15, conditions could turn favourable for a reversal in wind patterns and arrival of northeast monsoon in the following days.

An upper air cyclonic circulation may emerge in the Andaman Sea around October 11 and influence formation of a low-pressure area over the southeast Bay of Bengal around October 13.

V.R. Durai, Head, Regional Weather Forecasting Centre, RMC, said, "If it moves towards land or the Tamil Nadu coast, it will help enhance conditions for a reversal of wind pattern to northeasterlies, potentially accelerating the onset of the monsoon."

However, the weather models indicate that the system is unlikely to intensify. The RMC expects temperatures to gradually fall across the State after October 16, as moisture incursion and cloud cover would begin to increase.

Some parts of the State, particularly north interior Tamil Nadu, may continue to experience above normal temperatures till October 14, as it is still in the monsoon transition stage.

However, a weather system over the Gulf of Mannar and adjoining south Tamil Nadu would trigger wet spell over the southern and interior parts of the State.

Rainfall of light to moderate intensity may continue over south Tamil Nadu till October 16. However, temperatures could remain elevated in some areas in the absence of sustained cloud cover during the monsoon transition period, officials said.

On Saturday, several weather stations across the State recorded day temperatures two degrees Celsius above average.

Over 100 participants ran from Sivananda Salai, near Marina Beach, to Napier Bridge as part of the marathon. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Walkathon organised on mental health day

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Department of Social Work (Self Finance), Madras School of Social Work, organised a walkathon to mark World Mental Health Day on Sunday.

Held under the theme "Lived Experiences Heard: Real Voices, Real Change", it brought together over 100 participants, including students, faculty members, and volunteers.

They ran from Sivananda Salai, near Marina Beach, to Napier Bridge.

Media personality and mental health activist Jeyachandran, and Director of the Banyan Academy of Leadership in Mental Health, Ramesh, participated, a press release said.

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REGISTRAR

Noted *mridangam* artiste Guruvayur Dorai passes away

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Noted *mridangam* player Guruvayur Dorai, who accompanied seven generations of musicians, beginning with Chembai Vaidyanatha Bhagavathar, died on Saturday, following age-related complications. He was 92 and is survived by his wife and daughter.

Dorai evolved a distinctive style, blending his own technique with lessons learnt from the late Palani Subramania Pillai. His *gumkis* were particularly admired. In the 1940s, he accompanied his sister, Guruvayur Ponnammal, as a vocalist and a *mridangam* player. He performed with all the leading musicians of his time and was M.S. Subbulakshmi's regular *mridangam* accompanist for many years.

Dorai developed an interest in *layam* (rhythm) at a very young age. His father, concerned about his physical disability – Dorai had been affected by polio – persuaded Palghat Subbaiyar, who had accompanied Chembai Vaidyanatha Bhagavathar for a concert, to teach him *mridangam*.

"He taught me a few lessons, which I repeated without mistakes. He was impressed with my ability," Dorai recalled in an interview with Parivadini, an organisation that promotes music. He later learnt from Narayana Pisharody.

Dorai acknowledged the role played by Chembai in shaping his career. At the age of eight, he accompanied Chembai in a concert that marked his *arangetram*. It was Chembai who later helped him learn from Palani Subramania Pillai. After moving to Chennai, Dorai approached Pillai to study under him. However, Pillai was initially hesitant as the finger techniques of his school differed from those Dorai had already adopted. Pillai's wife, Kolar Rajam, persuaded him to teach Dorai.

Humble and unassuming, Dorai trained many students. Music historian Lalitharam recalled that after an enthralling concert at the Music Academy, Dorai travelled to Thiruvaiyaru to participate in the Thyagaraja Aradhana, taking an ordinary bus. "I could not bring myself to talk to him. Later, when I met him, he rendered a brief *alapana* in *Sri raga* and sang *Kamalambike*," Lalitharam said. Dorai received the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award, the Kalaimamani award, and the Padma Shri.

CINEMA ❖ ARTS ❖ EVENTS

MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan,
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Saroja Parasaran Memorial Endowment
"Navaratri Festival" - Oct 11-20, 2026
Today: 11th Oct: 4.30 pm: Sri Raghavan Manian (Vocal / Instrumental), 6.00 pm: **Inauguration**: **Justice Sri Jagadeesan**, (Vice-Chairman, Bhavan's Chennai Kendra) Presides, Welcome address by **Sri K.N.Ramaswamy** (Director, Bhavan's Chennai Kendra), Special Invitees: **Dr.Sudha Seshayyan** (Director Sastra University, Chennai) (Speaks on "**Navarathri Mahimai**"), **Sri Sathish Parasaran** (Senior Advocate) (S/o. Sri K.Parasaran & Saroja Parasaran). 6.30 pm: **Smt.Anahitha & Smt.Apoorva** (Vocal).
Tomorrow: **12th Oct**: 5.00 pm: **Ms.Aishwarya & Ms.Soundarya** (Vocal), 6.30 pm: **Sri Sruthi Sagar** (Flute). Prasadham at 8.30 pm.
All are welcome.
In Association with : Nalli

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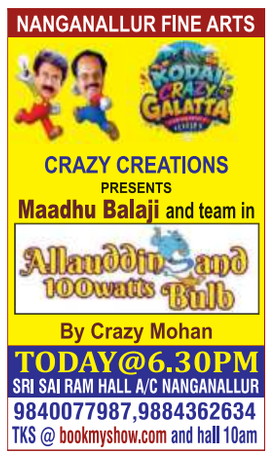

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Sri Thyaga Brahma Gana Sabha (Regd.) Vanimahal, Ph: 28152166
Today 6.30 pm at Vani Mahal NAVARATHRI FESTIVAL - 2026 Veena Concert by Ms. Veena Venkatramani, Sri Akshay Ram (Mrud.), Sri K.R. Sivaramakrishna (Kanjira). All are welcome.

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Navarathri Music Concerts, Today 5 p.m. Sanjana Meenakshi - Vocal, Chittoor A Giridhar, M. Karthik Thriuvengadam, 6.30 p.m. Vivek Sadasivam - Vocal, Gayatri Shivani, Aaduthurai Guru Prasad. All are welcome.

Sri Sringeri Jagadguru Sankara Math (Branch), Krupasankari Street, West Mambalam
11.10.2026 – 7.00 pm- Gayathri Venkataraghavan - Vocal, Mysore V. Srikanth, Neyveli R. Narayanan, S. Harihara Subramanian.

TOM Mediaas / Bharat Kalachar
TODAY OCTOBER AALAPANAI 2026 @ YGP AUDITORIUM, T.NAGAR. 5 pm: Super Senior: M. Sughi Praarthana, Guru: Dr. M. Senthil Kumar & Dr. Himaja Athul Kumar. 5:30 pm: Sub Junior: V. Mithila, Guru: Swetha Manoj Prabhakar. 5:55 pm: Junior: Soumyaa G, Guru: Kalaimamani Smt. Anitha Guha. 6:30 pm: Saadhvi Santhosh Disciple of Kalaivalarmani Smt. B. Srimathi Venkat Founder and artistic director Sri. Nrithyalaya Academy of Fine Arts (B/N). 7:30 pm: Sarvashri V. Madhan, Disciple of Dr. Smt. Sheela Unnikrishnan (B/N). All are welcome.

MISCELLANEOUS

Humour Club International Triplicane Chapter, Ph: 9841161196, 9884688390, 9841532212
Welcomes you for AN ENJOYABLE SPECIAL PROGRAMME "PENMAI ENUM PAERAZHAGU" by Thirumathi ANUGRAHA AADHI BAGAVAN at 4 p.m. today at TAG - Mylapore Fine Arts Club Auditorium, Oliver Road, Near St. Isabel's Hospital, Mylapore, Chennai-600004. All are welcome. Membership enrolled. Sponsored by: CUB, Super Auto Forge, Ramraj, Integrated Enterprises, DCB Bank, Srimukha, Sowbaghya, Limra Edn., GRT, Geri Care, TTK Health Care, Prestige, Nandhavanam, Swathi Builders, Savithri Foundations, Sangeetha, Ripple Tea, Sara Halwa, ITC Sunfeast, Kalimark, and Kalakendra.

Narada Gana Sabha Trust, Ph: 24993201
Today - Main Hall - (Sathguru Gnanananda Hall) - 3 pm - Hari Nama Sangeerthanam by Bhagavatha Sammelana Samajam. All are welcome.

Sringeri Bharathi Vidyashram, T. Nagar, Ph: 24348964
Navarathri Mahotsavam 2026 Pooja Commencing Today Till 21.10.26, 5 a.m. Ganapathi Homam, 7.30 a.m. Daily Sevakartha Sankalpam, Vedaparayanam, Sapthasathiparayanam, Laksharchani. (Upto 19.10.26), 11.00 a.m. Suvasini, Kanya Pooja, Mahadeeparadhanai, Mahaprasadam. Eve 5.00 p.m. Special Alankaram for Goddess Sharadamba, 8.30 p.m. Maha Deeparadhanai, Ashtavadhana Seva. All are welcome.

Sri Sringeri Jagadguru Sankara Math (Branch), Krupasankari Street, West Mambalam
11.10.2026 – 9.00 am - Sri Surya Namaskara Parayanam, Surya Narayana Astakshari, Aswarudamba Mantra Homams; Chandi Parayanam, Veda Parayanam, Sahasranama Archanai, Suvasini & Kanya Pooja; 12.30 pm – Annadhanam; 6.30 pm – Hamsavahana Alankaram.

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ISSN 0971 - 751X

INBRIEF

MTC to run bus services along new Metro Rail stretch

In a bid to provide last-mile connectivity to commuters, the MTC will operate services from bus stops near the Chennai Metro Rail's Phase II stations along the stretch between Poonamallee Bypass and Vadapalani from Sunday. Commuters accessing the Metro Rail stations can easily shuttle between bus and train services to travel to various parts of the city, the MTC said in a press release. Signage has been put up at all 11 Chennai Metro Rail stations to direct passengers to the nearest bus stops. To enhance the passenger experience, the MTC and Chennai Metro Rail will explore the need for and feasibility of operating additional feeder bus services based on passenger feedback and demand.

Governor participates in ESIC Medical College graduation

Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar on Saturday took part in the fifth graduation day of ESIC Medical College and Hospital in Chennai. He presented medals and certificates to 125 medical graduates, according to a press release.

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	36	25
Chennai Airport	36	28
Chennai City	35	28

Chennai Airport Today
35°C The weather will be warm with uneasy afternoon. Night also will be uneasy. Spell of light to moderate rain and thundershower to occur.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
36°C The weather will be dry. Day will be very warm and uneasy. Night also will be uncomfortable.

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Timings
CHENNAI

SUNDAY, OCT. 11		
RISE	05:59	SET 17:53
RISE	06:19	SET 18:14
MONDAY, OCT. 12		
RISE	05:59	SET 17:52
RISE	07:10	SET 18:55
TUESDAY, OCT. 13		
RISE	05:59	SET 17:52
RISE	08:03	SET 19:40

THE HINDU
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Modi to inaugurate Metro Rail's Phase 2 stretch today

The first train will run from Porur Bypass to Poonamallee, with Prime Minister Modi and Chief Minister Vijay among the commuters; the PM will also inaugurate other development projects

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

Six years since the work on the Chennai Metro Rail Limited's (CMRL) Phase 2 network began, the first train from Porur Bypass is all set to run till Poonamallee on Sunday morning, with Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay among the first few commuters.

While the first stretch of the project will be opened from Poonamallee to Vadapalani for commuters, Mr. Modi and Mr. Vijay will only travel between Poonamallee and Porur Bypass.

After the flag-off around 11.30 a.m., the Phase 2 project will be inaugurated, along with a slew of other projects, at the Indian Institute of Technology-Madras (IIT-Madras) around 2 p.m. It is to be noted that commuters can take a ride on the Poonamallee-Vadapalani stretch after 4 p.m.

To begin with, train services on this stretch will operate from 7 a.m. to 9 p.m., unlike those on the Phase 1 network, which run from 5 a.m. to 11 p.m. Sources said this is to facilitate the construction of stations between Porur Junction and Vadapalani - Alapakkam, Karambakkam, Valasaravakkam, Alwarthirunagar, Saligramam Warehouse, and Saligramam - at night.

Initially, 15 trains will run from Poonamallee to Vadapalani. Commuters can access a train every 10 minutes during the peak hours (8 a.m.-11 a.m. and 5 p.m. to 8 p.m.) and one every 15 minutes in the non-peak hours (7 a.m.-8 a.m., 11 a.m.-5 p.m., and 8 p.m.-9 p.m.). The frequency will be improved once the civil work is completed in all six stations, sources said.

Phase 2 journey

The Metro services from Poonamallee to Vadapalani are taking off after a 10-month delay

January 2019: Tamil Nadu government accords in-principle approval for the phase 2 project

November 2020: Union Home Minister Amit Shah lays foundation stone for the project

July 2021: Piling work for the elevated stretch from Poonamallee to Vadapalani gets under way on Arcot Road

October 2024: Union Cabinet approves the Chennai Metro Rail's phase 2 project

October 2024: First driverless train arrives at Poonamallee depot

March 2025: Chennai Metro Rail completes the viaduct between Poonamallee and Porur

April 2025: Chennai Metro Rail carries out trial run from Poonamallee till Porur

December 2025: Railway Board approves the operation of signalling system

January 2026: Trial run carried out from Porur Junction to Vadapalani

February 2026: Commissioner of Railway Safety inspects the Poonamallee-Vadapalani stretch and gives only conditional approval

May 2026: Commissioner of Railway Safety gives final authorisation for operations from Poonamallee to Vadapalani

October 2026: Prime Minister Narendra Modi to inaugurate the first stretch of the phase 2 network

B. VELANKANNI RAJ

Ready for launch: A view of the Porur Bypass Metro Station.

Other projects

Mr. Modi, in a post on X, said he would inaugurate and lay foundation stone for development works worth over ₹13,000 crore in Chennai on Sunday. He went on to mention some of the projects across the Metro Rail, highway, railway, port, petroleum, and scientific research sectors.

He will visit the Jalakandeswarar temple at 12.15 p.m. and tour the Sudha Gopalakrishnan Brain Centre on IIT-M campus.

Around 1.30 p.m., he will launch the development projects, and around 3 p.m., attend the golden jubilee celebrations of Jaigopal Garodia Hindu Vidyalaya Matriculation Higher Secondary School.

In the highway sector, Mr. Modi will inaugurate and lay the foundation stone for projects worth around ₹3,700 crore. These include the inauguration of the 36-km Vadugapatti-Therkuvenganallur section of NH-744 and the 30-km Madurai Ring Road section of NH-744A.

The railway projects, worth more than ₹750 crore, include the dedication of the Karaikal-Peralam railway line and three rail overbridges in Coimbatore and neighbouring areas. Five redeveloped stations – Palani, Vellore Cantonment, Ambasamudram, Paramakkudi, and Namakkal – will also be inaugurated under the Amrit Bharat Station Scheme.

Maritime infra

Several projects aimed at expanding maritime infrastructure and cargo-handling capacity will be launched at Chennai Port, V.O. Chidambaranar Port, and Kamarajar Port. Mr. Modi will also inaugurate a paved storage yard, four export-import godowns, an upgraded cruise terminal, and a Seafarers Club at Chennai Port.

In the petroleum sector, he will lay the foundation stone for a Group II/III lube oil base stocks project at the Chennai Petroleum Corporation Limited's Manali refinery.

The Greater Chennai Traffic Police have announced traffic diversions from 8 a.m. to 4.30 p.m. in view of Mr. Modi's visit. For more details, visit newsth.live/trafficdiversions

(With inputs from R. Sivaraman)

A protester being detained by the Chennai police on Saturday.

City police arrest over 100 persons for anti-CEC protests

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

More than 100 cadres of the All India Students' Federation (AISF) and the All India Youth Federation (AIYF) were arrested by the Chennai police on Saturday while attempting to take out a procession to the Tamil Nadu Secretariat, demanding the removal of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar.

The members had gathered to march to the Secretariat and lay siege to the office of the Chief Electoral Officer, Tamil Nadu. Led by AIYF State secretary K. Bharathi and AISF State president K. Ibrahim, the protesters assembled near the Periyar statue on Anna Salai and proceeded along Sivananda Salai.

The city police prevented them from moving further.

The protesters accused the CEC of orchestrating "vote theft" and called for criminal proceedings and other action against him.

They also raised slogans demanding his removal and condemning the Prime Minister Narendra Modi-led government for allegedly supporting those accused of stealing votes.

The police forcibly bundled the protesters into vehicles despite their resistance and heated arguments. They were detained at a community hall.

During the scuffle, Kavin, a protester from Mylapore, sustained a head injury and was taken to hospital for treatment.

Meanwhile, a gathering of about 40 youngsters from different walks of life, including advocate Ra. Shhiva and social activists Sachin George and Radhika Ganesh, protested at Elliot's Beach in Besant Nagar, urging the revocation of the provision of the law that provides "life-long immunity" to the CEC and the halting of the SIR exercise.

The police said the group had not secured permission to stage a demonstration at the beach. When the protesters declined to leave, the police detained them. They were taken to the Urur Kuppam Corporation Community Hall.

Later, DMK leaders A. Raja, Ma. Subramanian, and Thamizhachi Thangapandian, along with the party supporters, reached the hall and sat in dharna, demanding the immediate release of protesters.

The protesters were released around noon.

Dept. of Posts celebrates National Postal Week

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Department of Posts organised a public outreach programme at Nexus Vijaya Mall in Vadapalani on Saturday as part of the National Postal Week celebrations.

A press release said various activities such as 'Memories with India Post', drawing and writing contests and photoshoots were held.

G. Babu, Additional Director, Chennai City Region, highlighted the initiatives and services of the Postal Department. Lekshmanan Pillai, Senior Superintendent of Post Offices, Chennai City South Division, also participated.

Rahul visits Chennai for 'Voice of Students' event, meets CM

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi with Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay at a café in Palavakkam on Saturday.

Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi arrived in Chennai on Saturday to participate in 'Voice of Students – *Chhatron ki Goonj*', a student interaction event that was held at Island Grounds near Marina Beach.

After his arrival, Mr. Gandhi met Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay at his residence on Casuarina Drive, Neelankarai. The Chief Minister hosted Mr. Gandhi for lunch, following which the two leaders visited a café in Palavakkam.

The Voice of Students event was held to provide a platform for young people to voice their concerns on education, employment, and issues affecting their future.

Congress MP Manickam Tagore, in a post on X, said Mr. Gandhi would hear students' concerns, particularly over unemployment, educational opportunities and what he described as an unfair examination system. He also criticised the BJP and the RSS over their education policies.

Mr. Gandhi's visit to Chennai comes amid protests by Opposition parties against the SIR exercise.

Demonstrations were held in Delhi on Saturday demanding accountability from the Election Commission of India over alleged irregularities in the SIR process. The issue has also prompted protests in Chennai.

Goondas Act slapped on couple in Odisha woman murder case

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The murder came to light when an unclaimed suitcase aboard the Tamil Nadu Express was found to contain a headless body

The Tambaram City Police have invoked the Goondas Act against Manik Uddin Laskar, 22, a native of Assam, and his wife, Bhagawati Majhi, 21, who were arrested for allegedly murdering and dismembering a 38-year-old woman in Guduvancheri.

The murder of the woman came to light on August 5, when a headless body was found inside an unclaimed suitcase found aboard the Tamil Nadu Express after it reached Agra from Chennai.

After scrutinising CCTV camera footage, the police searched a house on Mosque Street in Guduvancheri, and found human remains inside a large vessel used for preparing biryani.

The victim was identified as Hayathun Nisha, 38, a native of Odisha.

Following the investigation, the police arrested Laskar and Majhi on charges of murdering and dismembering the body of the victim.

Both were subsequently remanded in Central Prison, Puzhal.

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

OBITUARY

Mr. Y. V. Raman

Attained eternal rest on
10 October 2026.

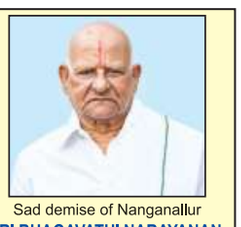
He was a beloved husband, father and grandfather, and a dear friend and family member to many.

He will always be cherished for his generosity, kindness, and loving heart.

LAST RITES
11 October 2026
11:00 AM - 12:00 PM
15 Shanmugam Street
Royapettah, Chennai 600014.
Ph: 9841010 269 | 9880021276

GRIEVED BY
Mrs. R Janaki (Wife)
Y S Madhu (Son)
Vishvak Prakashan (Son)
Sowmya (Daughter-in-law)
Ved (Grandson)

DEATH



Sad demise of Nanganallur
SRI BHAGAVATHI NARAYANAN,
Aged 91 years,
S/O J. Rengaswamy Iyengar,
Rayavaram on **09/10/2026**
at his residence.
Contact No:
N.Badhrinath, Son, 9840956449
S. Rajeswari, Daughter, 9840755571
P. Hemapriya, Daughter, 90034 79832
V. Srividhya, Daughter, 99406 43619
B. Sri Priya, Daughter in law, 9940684689

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

20th Anniversary

E.D. VEERARAGHAVULU
Retd. Southern Railways, Ambattur
Born: 20.08.1933-Expired: 29.10.2006
Ceremony will be held on
18th October 2026
Mobile: +91 9962055201
Fondly remembered by
E.V. Devarajulu
Anuradha Devarajulu
E.D. Saraswathy, E.D. Raghav
Relatives & Friends

BIRTH CENTENARY

CENTENARY REMEMBRANCE

Dr K V Thiruvengadam (11.10.1926 - 03.10.2020)
Dr Malathi Thiruvengadam (07.07.1929 - 20.09.2020)
"Endaro Mahanubhavulu Anthariki Vandanamulu "
Inserted by Family

International conference on hearing health to conclude today

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Coalition of Global Hearing Health, an international network of clinicians, researchers, advocates, and persons with hearing loss, is holding its 16th international conference in Chennai, at Sri Ramachandra Institute of Higher Education and Research.

Conference theme

The conference is being held from Friday to Sunday, with the theme: 'Fostering Inclusiveness, Changing Mindsets'.

Tamil Nadu Health Secretary Darez Ahamed speaking at the conference. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

In India, roughly 1.25 lakh to 1.5 lakh children are born every year with hearing loss. However, few receive the education and rehabilitation they need, with speech and auditory-verbal therapy largely confined to urban areas, while sign language education remains underfunded. The conference focuses on screening and community services, health systems, economics, clinical services, innovations, and low-cost tech, among other aspects.

Darez Ahamed, Health Secretary, Tamil Nadu, was the chief guest at the inauguration of the conference, while Shelly Chadha, technical lead for ear and hearing care at the World Health Organization (WHO), was the guest of honour, the release said.

सी.एस.आई.आर.–संरचनात्मक अभियांत्रिकी अनुसंधान केन्द्र
CSIR-STRUCTURAL ENGINEERING RESEARCH CENTRE
(वैज्ञानिक तथा औद्योगिक अनुसंधान परिषद् Council of Scientific & Industrial Research)
सीएसआईआर परिसर CSIR Campus, सीएसआईआर सड़क, तरमणि Taramani, चेन्नै Chennai - 600 113

निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना NOTICE INVITING e-TENDER **(TWO BID SYSTEM)**

Tender ID No. 2026_CSIR_292850_1 **E-Tender Notification** दि. Dated : 11.10.2026

CSIR – SERC, Tarmanai, Chennai invites bids in two stage system for composite work through e-Procurement portal from eligible bidders for the following Tender. The Tender Documents with detailed terms and conditions may be obtained from the website **http://etenders.gov.in / www.serc.res.in** (Council of Scientific and Industrial Research)

PRE- BID MEETING: (both online/offline) on 15.10.2026 at 11.00 am @ CSIR-SERC, Chennai.

Tender Schedule is given below

क्र सं. Sl . No.	विवरण Description of work.	अनुमानित रकम Estimated Cost (लाखों में) Approx. (₹)	ई.एम.डी. रकम EMD Amount (₹)	पूरा करने की तिथि Time of Completion	प्रकाशित होने की तारीख और समय Date & time of Publishing	बोली जमा करने की अंतिम तिथि और समय Bid submission End date & Time
1.	Proposed Extension of Test Floor building on the northern side of Fatigue and Fracture lab., (FFL), CSIR-SERC, CSIR Campus, Taramani, Chennai - 600113. i) Civil works – Rs 1,49,86,210.00 ii) Electrical works – Rs. 16,03,500.00	1,65,89,710.00	3,31,795.00	18 (Eighteen) Months	30.09.2026 3.00 p.m	31.10.2026 06.00 p.m
	Total	1,65,89,710.00	3,31,795.00			

Teams platform for those willing to attend in online mode. The prospective bidder may submit their request for pre-bid meeting through email to **wrka.serc@csir.res.in, vinothkumar.serc@csir.res.in, natarajan.serc@csir.res.in** with the above subject work by **14.10.2026, 7.00 p.m.** All the corrigendum / Changes pertain to notice will not be published in newspapers and the same will be published in E-tendering portal. Technically qualified bidders will be allowed to upload financial bids.

टेंडर आमंत्रित करने वाला प्राधिकरण
The Tender Inviting Authority

Remove encroachments beneath flyovers on west suburbs: residents

They say illegal shops and haphazard parking under flyovers and along service lanes cause traffic bottlenecks in Pattabiram, Thandurai, Thiruninravur; they seek adequate lighting, greenery, walking spaces, and establishment of street-vending zones

Deepa H. Ramakrishnan
CHENNAI

Residents of the western suburbs, including Pattabiram, Thandurai, and Thiruninravur, have urged the Highways Department to remove encroachments under flyovers and along service lanes.

Motorists also complained about the lack of maintenance of rail overbridges in Thiruninravur, Veppampattu, Thandurai, and Pattabiram.

Thandurai resident K.S. Gopalakrishnan said several shops had occupied the service lanes of the flyover that replaced the LC-10 railway gate in their area, creating traffic bottlenecks during the morning and evening hours.

Addressing concerns: Sources in the Highways Department said that steps would be taken to remove the encroachments.

"Several two-wheelers belonging to customers take up the remaining space, causing inconvenience to residents of these localities, including Gopalapuram and Vallalar Nagar. Ambulances, cars, and even autorickshaws struggle to navigate these roads. Commuters taking trains from the nearby Pattabiram station also park their vehicles here," Mr. Gopalakrishnan said.

These illegal shops have been functioning under the bridge and along the service lanes for nearly 15 years now without intervention from any enforcement agency, said another resident.

Jayaraman of Pattabiram said the recently completed flyover at Veppampattu and the one under construction at LC2 Pattabiram Railway Siding also had encroachments. "Lighting under these bridges is poor, which leads to all kinds of illegal activities. Food joints come up without permission. People are scared to go to such spaces after dark as there is absolutely no police presence," the resident said.

Road users' rights

Consumer activist T. Sadagopan said that it is necessary to regulate the shops and the parking spaces beneath the flyovers and along the service lanes.

"People talk of the rights of the vendors, then what about that of the road users for whom these facilities were primarily created? We would like some greenery and walking spaces under these flyovers, not illegal shops. The flyovers should also be decorated with wall art and murals like those inside the city. There are shops constructed by the Avadi Corporation that remain empty as the rents are exorbitant. Street-vending zones must be created like in the case of the Greater Chennai Corporation," he said.

Sources in the Highways Department said that steps would be taken, in association with the local body, police and Revenue department, to remove the encroachments.

Man accused of bank loan fraud arrested after nearly 20 years

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Central Crime Branch (CCB) of the Greater Chennai Police has arrested a 60-year-old man who was absconding for nearly 20 years, in a case involving an alleged ₹37-lakh bank loan fraud using forged property documents.

According to the police, the complainant, Philomina Rani, owns a 6,772-square-foot plot at Sridevi Garden in Valasaravakkam. One of the accused, Leemaraj, allegedly obtained a fake legal heir certificate and created forged documents. In collusion with the other accused, Harinarayanan, Leemaraj mortgaged the property with a private bank in New Delhi and fraudulently obtained a loan of ₹37 lakh. Ms. Rani lodged a complaint with the police in 2007.

The police arrested Harinarayanan, who had been absconding, on Friday and remanded him in judicial custody.

Constable arrested for black-flag protest

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A head constable attached to the Avadi Tank Factory police station was arrested on Saturday, after he staged a black-flag protest near his residence in Muthapudupet, ahead of Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to Chennai on Sunday.

The constable, Kothandapani, was detained by the Muthapudupet police. He staged the protest to draw attention to the alleged medical negligence in the treatment of his 10-year-old daughter at the Institute of Child Health and Hospital for Children in Egmore.

The constable had raised similar allegations of medical negligence against the government hospital earlier also.

MSME TECHNOLOGY DEVELOPMENT CENTRE CHENNAI
Government of India Autonomous Body
CFTI, 65/1, G.S.T. Road, Guindy, Chennai - 600 032
2 Days Weekend Classroom Training Program on
Certified Professional Course on
EPF & ESI Filing and updates
Date: 24.10.2026 & 25.10.2026 Time: 10.00 a.m. to 4.00. p.m.
Content: New & Advanced Topics (2026 Updates): Code on Social Security - Overview and key provisions, EPF, EPS, EDLI Schemes - 2026 (Updated rules and benefits), Latest amendment: PMVBRY scheme (Pradhan Mantri Viksit Bharat Rozgar Yojana), VISHWAS 2026 Scheme (Employee Enrolment Campaign), Employee Enrolment Campaign (EEC) 2026, Recent circulars and compliance changes, Inspection, Notices & Replies, Record maintenance & audit readiness.
E Filings : UAN activation and generation,E-nomination,KYC link, PF Claim-Form19, 31, 10C and 10D, PF Transfer, PF Trust Claim, ESI Register, EPFO Grievance, DSC Register, Pension Life Certificate Renewal, EPFO grievance, Benefits & entitlements (EPF, EPS, EDLI & ESI), New company register, New employee enrol (PF and ESI),Monthly ECR Returns and filings (PF and ESI),Compliance follow-ups (7A, 7B, 7Q and 14B), GVT schemes implement,EPFO and ESI portal handling,EPFO RTI filings, Recent revision of EPFO wage ceiling.
Who may Attend: HR Managers, HR Executives, Personnel Officers, Payroll Executives, Accounts staff, Finance staff, Compliance Officers, Labour-law professionals, Employers, CA, CMA, CS professionals, Consultants, Payroll service providers.
Venue: CFTI Campus, 65/1, GST Road, Guindy, Chennai 32.
COURSE FEE : Rs. 5,000/- (incl.GST) Fees to be paid throu' Online www.cftichennai.in Online Payment
Account No : 39868874350, IFSC Code : SBIN0000956, DIRECTOR, MSME TDC UPI ID : msmetdccfti@sbi
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GOVT OF INDIA CERTIFICATE WILL BE ISSUED TO SUCCESSFUL CANDIDATES

SBI State Bank Of India
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PREMISES REQUIRED ON LEASE
State Bank of India invites tenders for commercial premises in the prescribed format in two bid system for ready built or under construction or proposed construction around **Egmore Railway Station Chennai** on lease rental basis for shifting **Home Loan Centre - Chennai** having carpet Area of approximately **15000sq.ft. (1394sq.m)** with adequate parking facility. For further details, please visit Bank's website **https://sbi.bank.in under "SBI in the News: Procurement news"**. The last date and time for submission of tender is **3.00p.m on 31.10.2026.** Corrigendum if any would be posted on the website only.
Date: 11-10-2026 **Asst. General Manager**

BUSINESS TO BUSINESS

INBRIEF

T.N. has shown that govt. can be corruption-free: Speaker

Many were doubtful whether a government could function without corruption, but Tamil Nadu has shown that it can, thanks to Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, said Speaker J.C.D. Prabhakar at the School Voice Educational Conference on Saturday in Chennai. "The live telecast of Assembly proceedings has created an awareness among the youth on being a part of the government," he said. The conference, organised by the School Voice Association and YMCA Madras, honoured at least 500 teachers and principals of private schools for their work. As many as 450 schools received the School Voice Iconic Edu Excellence Award-2026, six educationists in Tamil Nadu received the Global Edu Excellence Award, and 26 educationists received the School Voice Award of Excellence.

Meeting held to review special bus arrangements for festivals

A meeting was held on Saturday to review the arrangements for operating special buses by the Tamil Nadu State Transport Corporation for the upcoming holidays on account of Aayudha Puja and Deepavali. In the meeting held at the Kalaignar Centenary Bus Terminus in Kilambakkam, discussions were held regarding the operation of special buses, omni buses, basic amenities for passengers, and measures to be taken to prevent traffic congestion.

Draft rules for ride aggregators in six months: HC to govt.

The order was issued while disposing of a PIL petition seeking a direction to the T.N. govt. to enforce a regulatory framework for digital aggregators

The Hindu Bureau
MADURAI

The Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court has directed the State government to examine the report of an expert committee and frame suitable guidelines/rules/bylaws in six months for aggregators, including those related to bike-taxi services.

A Division Bench of Justices P. Velmurugan and K.K. Ramakrishnan issued the direction while disposing of a public interest litigation (PIL) petition that had sought a direction to the State government to enact and enforce a comprehensive legal and regulatory framework governing aggregators.

The State submitted that after carefully examining the proposal in the light of the Motor Vehicle Aggregator Guidelines, 2025, the government had issued a G.O. constituting a seven-member expert committee to examine the existing categories of vehicles; collect and analyse relevant data; study prevailing fare structures and best practices adopted elsewhere; examine issues relating to dynamic pricing, pooling services, aggregator-driver agreements, and monitoring mechanisms; and recommend a fair, transparent, and reasonable fare regime for incorporation in the Tamil Nadu Motor Vehicle Aggregator Rules, 2025.

Further, the State submitted that the report and recommendations of the expert committee were awaited and the government would examine the report on its receipt, and thereafter, take a considered policy decision and finalise the appropriate regulatory framework in accordance with the applicable statutory provisions, the Motor Vehicle Aggregator Guidelines, 2025, and the directions of the court.

The court directed the matter to be listed after six months under the caption 'for reporting compliance'.

App-based services

The petitioner, R. Naveen Kumar of Madurai, said that in recent years, app-based bike-taxi services, which operated through digital aggregators, had become an integral part of the transport ecosystem in Tamil Nadu.

However, a critical regulatory vacuum existed due to the State government's failure to notify a specific scheme for non-transport motorcycles used for passenger aggregation, he said. The court directed the matter to be listed after six months under the caption 'for reporting compliance'.

Stalin terms police action against protesters in Delhi an 'undeclared emergency'

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

DMK president and former Tamil Nadu Chief Minister M.K. Stalin on Saturday said that the Union BJP government had detained former Chief Ministers Pinarayi Vijayan, Arvind Kejriwal, Mamata Banerjee, and Manik Sarkar, along with CPI(M) general secretary M.A. Baby and leaders of various student organisations, who were fighting to protect the people's right to vote, while Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar, who should be facing trial for "his act of treason", was moving freely with Z+ security.

"What a disgrace," he said in a social media post. "The conspiracy behind the SIR [Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls] has been completely exposed. There is no hiding it any more. Barricading Delhi, shutting down the Internet and detaining political leaders cannot crush the uprising of India's youth. How long can the Union government keep an entire nation under siege?" he said.

He further alleged that the TVK government in Tamil Nadu was meanwhile desperately trying to "please its Delhi masters" by detaining activists protesting against the SIR and demanding Mr. Kumar's resignation. "All those detained must be released immediately. Gyanesh Kumar must be sacked, SIR must be halted, and everyone responsible for betraying the people of India must be held accountable," Mr. Stalin said.

In another tweet early on Saturday morning, he said the scenes unfolding in Delhi and the scale of repression being unleashed against peaceful protesters brought back painful memories of the Emergency that he lived through.

He strongly condemned the TVK government in Tamil Nadu for acting as an extension of the BJP and unleashing police repression against protesting students. The Union government must immediately end its assault on the youth who are peacefully exercising their democratic right to protest. "Dissent is not a crime, and democracy cannot survive by silencing those who rise to defend it," he said.

> Barricading Delhi, shutting down the Internet, and detaining political leaders cannot crush the uprising of India's youth. How long can the Union government keep an entire nation under siege?
>
> **M.K. STALIN**
> DMK president

CEC's resignation

The resignation of the CEC was non-negotiable. Beyond his resignation, all the damage done to the institutional framework of the Election Commission of India must be undone, and its independence and integrity must be restored, Mr. Stalin demanded.

Rainwater enters Adichanallur ASI site amid delay in construction of a shelter

Shankari Nivethitha B.
THOOTHUKUDI

Recent showers in the Srivaikuntam region resulted in rainwater entering excavated trenches and urns at the 'C' site of the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) in Adichanallur.

Although an ASI official had said last year that measures would be taken to construct a protective shelter to cover the site, work on the project has only recently begun, with installation of iron pillars to support a roof made of galvanised sheets.

For nearly two years, archaeology enthusiasts from the region have been calling for the replacement of thatched roofs with a semi-permanent structure to protect the site, which is regarded as a 'royal site' owing to the numerous valuable artefacts unearthed there. The much-spoken-about golden diadem was also excavated from the 'C' site.

Located on a mound along the banks of the Thamirabarani, the site has repeatedly been exposed to the elements. In September 2025, *The Hindu* published a report stating that the damaged thatched roof structure and tarpaulins covering the 'C' site posed a threat to excavated trenches and urns.

At that time, an ASI official said steps had been initiated to construct an enhanced shelter to protect the site from natural calamities. However, a year has passed, and work has only recently begun.

Muthalankurichi Kamarasu, an archaeology enthusiast from the region, said no concrete measures had been taken to protect the trenches and urns at the 'C' site, apart from the installation of iron pillars, which commenced a few days ago.

He pointed out that the site was being regularly visited by numerous school and college students and members of the public to learn about its rich heritage and history. "After the rain, I immediately visited the site and found that water had entered into urns," Mr. Kamarasu said, stressing that the project to protect the site should be expedited.

Risk of damage: Rainwater seen in the trenches of the ASI's 'C' site in Adichanallur after the recent showers. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

A senior ASI official blamed the delay in building the shelter on procedural requirements, including obtaining approvals and completing the tender process

A senior ASI official from the Tiruchi circle told *The Hindu* that works for constructing the protective shelter were under way. He attributed the delay to procedural requirements, including obtaining approvals, preparing and approving estimates, and completing the tender process.

The shelter, featuring the galvanised-sheet roof, was expected to be completed within a week, making the site more visitor friendly, he added.

Slew of events planned in memory of K.V. Thiruvengadam in centenary year

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A year-long celebration of renowned clinician, teacher, and humanitarian, the late K.V. Thiruvengadam, will kick off in his centenary year on Sunday. The celebrations, in memory of Prof. Thiruvengadam's extraordinary impact on medicine both in Chennai and beyond, will focus on restoring the art of listening to the patient, examining at the bedside, thinking before ordering a test, and finally, dwelling on the fundamental question of what it means to be a good physician in an age of extraordinary technology:

K. Vardachari Thiruvengadam, fondly known as KVT, was born in 1926. He graduated from Government Stanley Medical College in 1950 and taught for 31 years both at his alma mater and at Madras Medical College, and subsequently at private institutions. His core areas of specialty were chest medicine, allergies and infectious diseases. His career coincided with a period when medicine was rapidly expanding, but his students remember that he did not teach bedside examination as a ceremonial ritual – he taught it as a way of thinking, listening to the patient and asking the right questions.

K.V. Thiruvengadam

Prof. KVT was a scientist as well as a clinician. He received formal training in chest diseases in the U.K., under the Colombo Plan. He published nearly 100 papers in national and international journals. Among the many areas of his research were chikungunya fever, neurological complications following influenza and amoebiasis. He also investigated traditional medicines in allergic lung and skin diseases. He worked for decades in the government system, among the poorest in society, and believed that government service could achieve extraordinary things when doctors had the willingness to serve. For him, medicine was a social responsibility.

Enduring legacy

Prof. KVT's awards and recognitions were numerous, and included the Padma Shri in 1981 and the Dr. B.C. Roy Award for Eminent Medical Teacher, alongside multiple other distinctions. But perhaps the most enduring aspect of his legacy is in the number of students who remember him and his teachings and went on to become teachers and leaders themselves, committing to his principle of what you learn and experience must be passed on to the next generation.

The centenary year celebration's objective is not merely to celebrate him, but to translate his philosophy into medical education. The commemoration is not an argument against technology, but an argument against technology without context, and for the need for human clinical reasoning to be paramount.

The proposed celebration aims to take to medical students and postgraduate doctors the importance of history-taking, clinical examination, clinical reasoning and their role not only in diagnosis and management, but also in medical research.

On October 31, the third Prof. K.V. Thiruvengadam Memorial Oration will be delivered at Sree Balaji Medical College and Hospital, by S.R. Chandra, on 'The Patient Speaks, the Doctor Thinks and the Research Begins', alongside a national conference on movement disorders.

For details, contact Dr. Ramachandran at 9443238315 or Dr. Basheer at 9840217486.

Regular counselling for service PGs will be held soon: Minister

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Health Minister K.G. Arunraj on Saturday said regular and transparent counselling will be conducted at the earliest for service postgraduates (PG), based on the Civil Medical List (CML) and seniority. The government is taking necessary steps to resolve issues in the counselling schedules and ensure it is conducted smoothly without any delay in the coming years, he said.

He issued a statement regarding the temporary postings recently issued to service PGs who will complete their MD/MS courses in October 2026. *The Hindu* had reported in an article, 'Service PGs get temporary postings without counselling', that 800-odd service PGs had been issued temporary postings in institutions under the three health directorates without counselling and without following CML seniority.

K.G. Arunraj

Dr. Arunraj said the COVID-19 pandemic caused significant delays in the academic and counselling schedules of medical courses in recent years. It was keeping in mind the welfare of the service PGs that the government came up with the temporary postings as an immediate solution.

Reiterating that this is only a temporary arrangement, Dr. Arunraj said as per Government Order 131, all posts filled through these temporary postings would be notified in the upcoming counselling. Regular counselling would be held soon based on CML seniority, he added.

Private entities can't mandatorily collect caste details, says HC

The Hindu Bureau
MADURAI

No private educational institution or employer in Tamil Nadu can mandatorily collect caste details, the Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court has directed.

A Division Bench of Justices C.V. Karthikeyan and R. Sakthivel issued the direction while disposing of a public interest litigation (PIL) petition that had sought a direction to prohibit private educational institutions and private employers in Tamil Nadu from mandatorily collecting caste or community details in application forms unless specifically required under statutory provisions.

The petitioner, N. Vikraman of Virudhunagar, said several private educational institutions and establishments were mandatorily collecting caste and community details in application forms for admission and employment even though there was no statutory requirement for such disclosure. He said such compulsory collection of caste information at the initial stage facilitated discrimination in selection and admission processes.

AIADMK should introspect on byelection outcome: Anbumani

The Hindu Bureau
COIMBATORE

The AIADMK should introspect on the results of the byelections to the Dharapuram and Madurantakam constituencies after finishing third in both seats, which it had won only five months ago, Pattali Makkal Katchi president and Rajya Sabha member Anbumani Ramadoss said on Saturday.

"I do not want to interfere in another party's internal affairs... the AIADMK has to find reasons for the results, since the party is part of the National Democratic Alliance," he said. The PMK also is a constituent of the alliance.

When asked if the neutral stand of the PMK had caused the AIADMK's defeat in Madurantakam, Dr. Anbumani said it was the decision of his party's office-bearers and cadre.

"When there was a confidence motion in the Assembly, there was a section of AIADMK MLAs voting for and against it, while the PMK abstained. For the byelection, the PMK took a certain decision. For the next election, I don't know," he said.

Anbumani Ramadoss

'No alliance with TVK'

"Please don't believe in rumours," he said, when queried about the talks doing the rounds that the PMK will join the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam-led government, with a ministerial berth, after the byelection.

"The question of the PMK allying with the TVK does not arise. We are already in an alliance [NDA]," Dr. Anbumani added.

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PUBLIC NOTICE

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27	262/8	0-04.5	11 cents
28	261/5D	0-04.5	11 cents
29	261/6C	0-07.5	18 cents
30	262/15C	0-02.5	6 cents
31	261/6B	0-07.5	18 cents
32	262/15B	0-02.0	5 cents
33	261/5B	0-05.0	12 cents
34	262/1C	0-14.0	35 cents
35	262/6B	0-03.5	5 cents
36	262/1D	0-06.0	15 cents
37	263/5	0-09.0	22 cents
38	264/14	0-20.0	49 cents
39	264/11A	0-06.5	16 cents
40	264/2C	0-02.5	6 cents
41	264/3	0-10.5	26 cents
42	264/12	0-02.0	5 cents
43	264/13	0-03.0	8 cents
44	264/15	0-17.0	42 cents
45	264/16C	0-09.0	22 cents
46	266/15	0-05.0	12 cents
47	261/2	0-14.0	35 cents
48	261/5A	0-05.5	11 cents
49	262/6A	0-03.0	7 cents
50	261/1	0-24.0	60 cents
51	261/4	0-13.5	34 cents
52	261/3A	0-27.5	68 cents
53	262/9	0-05.5	11 cents
54	262/11	0-07.5	18.5 cents
55	262/12	0-06.0	15 cents
56	266/1	0-18.0	44 cents
57	262/2	0-15.0	37 cents
58	266/3	0-15.5	38 cents
59	264/4	0-8.5	21 cents
60	261/4B	0-02.5	5 cents
61	260/2	0-22.5	56 cents
62	260/3	0-28.5	70 cents
	Total Extent	12 Acre	67 ½ Cents.

D. PRASANNA ADVOCATE

REAL ESTATE

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5-100 Acres/Chennai Chengalpattu/Oragadam Suitable for Industrial Logistics Development. Direct Owners & Genuine Agents may
Ct:7200371487

RESIDENTIAL

REQ 1–2GRDS in Choolai, Purasaiwalkam, 30Ft Rd. Imm.payment 9381016843

NEED PRIME Area 1.5To4Grd T Nagar – Ashok Nagar Min 30Ft Rd 9840055888

RESIDENTIAL LAND

VELACHERY : 1, 1.5 or 2 Ground Land Wanted, 24–30 Ft Road. 8220166822

RESIDENTIAL LAND

LAND PARCELS REQUIRED
5–30 Acres in Urban&Emerging City Locations for Residential & Plotted Development.
JOINT VENTURE (JV) REQUIRED
Joint Venture (JV) Opportunities from 1to3 Grnds Welcomed with Land owners.
Ct:7200380487

CONSULTANTS

BUILDING PLAN Approval 25yrs Serviced & Expd in TP Dept/GCC 8825530329

JOINT DEVELOPMENT

PETROLEUM CO,NEED JV/Lease/Rental/Sale Land for Petrol Pump 7092745527

REQUIRE 1–5 Grounds JV Chennai Prime area Acacia Homess. 99529 27534

SELLING

COMMERCIAL

T.NAGAR, NEAR Burkit Rd 4000 sqft Grd floor UDS 2400 sqft Semi furnished 4 covered car park Lift, 2 store rooms. Ideal for clinics, offices, gym, studios, cloud kitchens, Buyers only. 9789522759

ANUGRAHA A/CHALL, VelacheryBabyNagar 11.50 Grounds with All FacilitiesCt:9840248080

COMMERCIAL BUILDING

OMR NEHRU Nagar Land 2800sft Bldg 3100 ROI Prop 9500058981/ 9841638314

PRIME PROPERTY on Rajaji salai Parrys. Standalone Building Approx 10, 000sqft Basement+5 Floors Built on 2044sqft of Land East Facing Genuine Buyers Call: 9869164779/ 7338779689

COMMERCIAL BUILDING FOR SALE
@ MADIPAKKAM
Near Ponniamman kovil
No Broker
Build Up 10000sft
Land 4000sft
Rs.12 Cr
Muraliram Group
9790184636|9444064567

CHAMIERS ROAD/ Off Boat Club Hitech Commercial Space2500 Sqft Ideal for Clinics/ Boutique Offices Cosmic Properties 90907 55000

FURNISHED OFFICE 10000Sft in Kottivakkam Single Floor Call 95000 41400

COMMERCIAL BUILDING on Perambur paper mills Road call – 98412–80480 broker Excuse

EGMORE OPP.COURT AKSHAYA PLAZA Commercial 865sft 1CP 1.5Cr 9841008598

6000SQFT LAND + 16000 sqft. G+3 build+5000 sft.shed for sale behind JK Mahal, Madhavaram. price Rs 9Cr (neg) Rent incme Rs 7L/mth. 9884000210

COMMERCIAL BUILDING

SHOWROOM 5.5GR 30K Sf Bld Tenant Reliance Inc 30L P/M NoBro 9840045676

COMMERCIAL LAND

THIRUVANNAMALAI 19CENTS (8284Sft) Girivalam Path, Kanchi Rd 9047432268

14ACR LAND 400+Ft Frntge Mappedu Opp Ind Park on SH 3Cr/Acr 9884088660

PALLIKARANAI 2300SFT Comm Cum Resi Land Sale 2cr 7200219108/8939809393

OMR THORAIPAKAM Opp ASV Tower 4G 3.5C 9841971947/ 6374401577/ 42337779

KEELKATTALAI 3000 Sft Comm Cum Resi Land 2.5Cr 7200219108 / 8939809393

OMR ON Road Kelambakkam 5 Acre Sale. Contact: 90032 48803

✔ **ADYAR RESI/**COMM PrimeLand 7000Sf North.Raj NoBrk 9840326659 8428499879

ARANI THIRUVALLUR Dist Bus Road 100x100ft Commercial Plot for Sale. Ideal for Warehouse, Godown, Logistics, Factory, Clear Title. 8072076276

MADHURAVOYAL 1200SFT Approved 30 Feet Road Rs: 1.95Cr. Ct: 8189988857

NR UTHERAMERUR 10Acres Clear Title road touch. No Broker Ct:7604898907

FACTORIES & SITES

SRIPERUMBUDUR NR. 2–5 Acres Suits Industrial/Warehouse. LBR 9841098170

IRUNGATUKOTTAI SIPCOT New Shed 25000 Sq Ft, Getting 7 Lakh Rent / Month Ct 9159261443 / 98436 41561

FARMHOUSE / LAND /RESORTS

KANCHIPURAM KAVERIPAKKAM Cheri village 5.50 Acres Farm Land with Farm House on State Highway. No Brokers Jayashankara Properties 7708417134

KANCHIPURAM OCHERI TATA, NH Nr 75cent Suit Farm/Gwdn 1.50cr 9360024487

ECR AKKARAI 18Gr Split 9Gr 130Ft Front N Face 40ft Rd NoBro 9840045676

GENERAL

Land Sale in Coimbatore Saravanampatti 2.25 Acres-Near IT Park. Ideal for Villa & Apartment. Call: 99445-56300

RESIDENTIAL

OMR PADUR 3 Grds DTCP Apd Nr Gateway Schl Rate–3.6Cr 90X80 N/F 30ft Rd Seaview Layout.8754738710 Brk Excu

RESIDENTIAL FLAT – NEW

VALASARAVAKKAM MAJESTIC Colony 2 BHK Apts with Deluxe Amenities & CCP Possession April 27 RB CONSTRUCTIONS. 90920 11111 / 98846 65565

T.NAGAR, POSH, 3&4BHK, Swandra Constructions, 97909 15016. We Invite JV & Outright Purchase of Properties

RAMAPURAM KOTHARI Nagar Resi.Apt. Stilt + 3Floors, Total 6 units,2 BHK (1212 sq.ft) 3 BHK (1436 sq.ft), North Facing, Lift,Car Parking. Contact: 91766 72732, 87782 89960

RESIDENTIAL FLAT – NEW

KODAMBAKKAM, INORDINATE 3BHK, 1508 & 1440 sft, 14K /sft Base Price. Possession Nov 2026. Ct: 93429 12618

T.NAGAR, NR Bus Terminus, Ready for occupation, Duplex Flat, 1449 sft, Triple Bed Room, Rs.14,000/ sft, Accurate Consultants, Ct: 9585397149, 63813 99195.

KUNDRATHUR 2BHK Flat 998 SFT 60L East Vasthu Lift CCP Ct: 9941142211

ALWARTHIRUNAGAR PREMIUM 3BHK Vaasthu CCP Flat for sale Ct:9962099997

ALWARTHIRUNAGAR BOOK Now for Offer Price 2BHK 1050Sqft,Lift ,CCP, Near Metro.SRK CONSTRUCTIONS: 908039735 5 / 9840957621

ANNANAGAR KORATTUR PADI 2,3&4BHK New Rdy 2Ocpy 8124740247, 9840355999

PUZUTHIVAKKAM NEW Customizable 1, 2 BHK Flats 43–L onwards.78100 25909

RAMAPURAM NEW Customizable 2, 3, 4 BHK flats 77–L onwards. 78100 25909

ALWARTHIRUNAGAR NEW 2, 3 BHK for sale 87–L onwards. Ct: 78100 25909

MADURAVOYAL 1150SFT 2BHK Fully Furnished Lift, CCP 88Lakhs :9382225252

AMBATTUR NR. Sethubhaskara scl 2BHK,674,894sft, CCP Rdy JV. 9941741781

PERUNGUDI: PREMIUM 2 & 3 BHK Apts. at OMR. Ready to Occupy. 10 mins from Adyar & behind World Trade Centre. Special Price Rs. 1.19 Cr onwards. Ct: 044–49494506

YOUR NEW HOME AWAITS @ PALLAVARAM! Premium 2 & 3 BHK Apts. Rs.58L. Get Possession in Just 10 Days! Ct: 044–49494517

PORUR, OPP to Saravana Stores, Santhosh Nagar, 2/3 BHK, Lift, CCP, CCTV. Contact: 91766 16555.

THORAIPAKKAM SPECIAL ! 52% UDS Spacious 2 BHK Apts. 1033–1198 Sq.Ft I Ready to Occupy I Rs.86L Onwards I Handover in 15 Days Call: 044–46184410

KOLATHUR NXT to Orchids International School 2BHK Flats@ 75Lakhs Lift Carpark CCTV Inverter Rdy to Ocupy Devi Builders.7010330748/ 6381279894

10MINS FROM Porur Premium 2 & 3 BHK Apts. RS. 68L Onwards at kovur, Ready To Move. Call: 044–49494454

KORATTUR, EAST Avenue Road – 10 mins from Anna Nagar. Premium 2&3 BHK apts. from Rs. 1.28Cr. Limited units available. Call: 044–46184446

ADYAR KB Ngr 4BHK 2650Sft 1080 UDS 4Baths, Pooja, Lift till Terrace, 2Free CCP Under Construct 9361645390

VIRUGAMBAKKAM NR Saligramam Bus Terminus 2BHK Ct.9940184873/ 9940184874

VADAPALANI / NANGANALUR 2/3BR 1.5C BrNew PVkM 2/3BR TNr 3BR 9962192721

KORATTUR NR.MOHAN–GARDEN on 200Ft Rd 1584–1713sqft 3BHK Ready to Occupy. Few Flats 8122741135, 9444975552

RESIDENTIAL FLAT – RESALE

MADIPAKKAM RAM Ngr Main Rd Appd & 1440 sft, 14K /sft Base Price. Corner Bldng Land 1800 Sqft 4 Flats each 2 BHK CCP 9yrs 2.25Cr. 9940062478

TEYNAMPET 3BHK 1185sft UDS 726sft 1CP 20yr Nobrk 7550208545/ 8754516444

VADAPALANI 2BHK, 1st Floor, 860 Sqft, Built 1991. Near Metro, Temple, Forum Mall. No broker. 8939296032.

BESANT NAGAR 1100sft 2BHK I floor Lift car park 1.65Cr. Ct: 9003188881

CHAMIERS ROAD / Off Boat Club Luxurious 4 BHK Apt/2950 Sqft /2 CCP. Cosmic Properties 95000 72727

APPASWAMY –KOTTURPURAM Fully Furnished 3 BHK / 1800 Sqft Apt/ 2CCP. Cosmic Properties 95000 72727

EGMORE –NEAR Ethiraj College, 5BHK Villa / 3000sqft BUA / UDS 1550sqft Cosmic Properties 95000 35353

APPASWAMY T.NAGAR Spacious 3BHK/ 1250Sqft/ 1CP. Cosmic Properties 96000 12555

NUNGAMBAKKAM 964SF 2BHK Flat OCP, 1st Flr, 1.50C:8939731487/ 7305754923

PORUR NAVIN'S Eden Park EF 3BR 1480sf CCP 1.15C&1364sf 95L 9841493678

VALASARAVAKKAM ANBUNGR 3BHK 1222sft,UDS 567,North,Rs.1.15Cr 8122250041

OMR, SHOLINGNALUR, 2BHK, 1095sf, 577 UDS, CCP, Lift, 60L : 9176058222

MAHABALIPURAM 2BHK Apart 620Sqft, Uds 366/per.sqft 3500/– Ct:9840083303

WEST MAMBALAM Laxmi St FF 3BH Bua 1270/Uds 510 63L & 2BH Bua 700/ 280Uds 37L – 98840 00932

ANNANAGAR EAST, 3rd floor, 1100 sqft carpet, 2 bedroom bathroom attached, separate living and dining, 3 balconies, second hand flat for sale, 9884269585

RESIDENTIAL HOUSE

VANDAVASI TOWN – Arani Road, Fakir Dargah St, 1470 Sft Plot, 2 Houses & 1 Shop For Sale. 35L. 9940109072.

KOTTIVAKAM VILLA 1200 buildup 3200sft 3BHK S.Pool 4cr + GST 9025525599

Polichalur Near Pallavaram independent House Two Bedroom, Total - 1400 Sqft Built up 1100 Sqft CMDA Approved. Ct: 9500050516 Brokers excuse.

ECR 3800SQ 5BHK Villa Vettuvankeni @ 3.5C Lift 9841971947/ 6374401577

Purasaiwakam G+3 independent 960sft 4cr Rs 1lakh rental.9941292901

EGATTUR OMR 3BHK Villa buldg1900sft land–1000sft Rs.85L Ph: 9500971254

INDIVIDUAL HOUSE (G+2) Monthly Rental Income 50K. Rasappa St, Park Town, Ch–03, Walkable distance from Central Rly Station. Ct: 98416 93061

RESIDENTIAL HOUSE

IYYAPANTHANGAL INDIVIDUAL House with 5 Shops Rental Income. 8667332977

MOGAPPIAR EAST 12th Blk Housing Board 1100sf FF Nr Velammal 9840941952

LUXURY BEACH Villa 2.5Cr with Private Beach access Muttukadu ECR Anugragha Builder 7845480478 / 9869845454

RESALE DANDEESWA'RM Velachery 5BHK Ind.Home S/F 4.5C NoBrkr 7305985113

KARANIPUDUCHERY, GUDUVANCHERY Gated community, houses ranging 1158 to 1189sft.Genuine buyers (No brokers) Spl discount of 3 lak+ free 2kv solarpanel worth 1 lakhs for 1st 5 customer. Ct : 9444049292/ 9444049298

RESIDENTIAL LAND

THIRUVANMIYUR ON Main Rd ANNA St. Nr Kalashetra Schl & Marundeeswar Tmple 4600sft Vacant Land. 9940590887

SRIPERUMBUDUR AMARAMBEDU 1Gr DTCP Apprd @ Rs.1250/– Per Sft.Nr.Rajiv Gandhi Memorial.NoBrokers. 8281401732

ECR PEARL Beach Paramakeni 14023sf Land SF NoBrk 7550208545/8754516444

VALASARAVAKKAM ANBU Nagar 4276sft North Facing Rs.7.1Cr.Ct: 9962225929

CHETPET LAND 3000sq S/F 40ft Rd 37.5X80 Rs.10cr Full Cheque. 9884088660

ECR UTHANDI 1.25 Ground CMDA Approved 40Ft Rd Broker Excuse 7200876788

ORAGDAM INNER Panchayat Rd 78'x100' Comp Patta Apd @2600/SF 8939990777

ECR NEELANKARI 1Gr, VETUVANKENI 2Gr, Uthandi 1Gr. RK.Realty 9841112037

OMR NAVALLUR Nr 30mtr Hari's Garden DTCP & RERA 9962772672/ 9444282372

THIRUVERKADU RES/COMM. Plot Sale – 1800 sft.550mtr from Devi Karumariamman Temple. Contact: 78258 88960

Madanamkuppam 1 Gr nr DRJ hospital NF nr Mn road. 2.25cr. 9941292901

THIRUVERKADU, VGN Mahalakshmi Nagar Phase1 2400 sqft size 40X60ft 200mts from the arch. Near Police Booth Approved North Facing. Buyers only 9789522759

ECR PALAVAKAM Premium Villa Plots CMDA&RERA Appd Gated Community GEM Terra Realty: 9884439439, 9841067863

GUDUVANCHERY KAYARAMBEDU SANTHOSH Nagar, 1800sft Land. Ct: 98400 99431

GUDUVANCHERRY MADAMBAKKAM Apprd 1Gr Plot Sri Vignesh Nagar. 9962100745

ECR JUHU Beach 1 Acre Appd N/F 1.60Crs/Grd Owner Call Ct: 9677219352

GST, SENGKUNDARAM Redwoods Gokulapuram Main Rd, Right next to Arihant Ashiana Senior Citizen Living, Near Singaperumal temple 0.5 & 1 ground DTCP approved plots. Gated Community. Buyers only 9789522759.

ECR RENGANATHAN Avenue 9Grds Appd N/F Owner Call Ct: 9677219352

RESIDENTIAL LAND

PAIYANUR ONEHUB 200 Metres from GODREJ 1.5 Acres Dry Land : 9840245678

THAIYUR KOMMAN Ngr 10Grds Dry Land Clear Title Rs 65L/PGrd: 9840245678

ECR MAHABALIPURAM Poonjeri, Rainbow 2 grds DTCP Approved plots. Gated Community East facing Near Four points Sheraton/Ziva Senior citizen living. Buyers only 9789522759

ECR KOTTIVAKKAM SeaSide 40/60 Aprvd NorthFace 9840789797 / 9884998686

ECR NEMMELI Majistic layout 2 Grds 1.20c OPP sea side.Ct: 9884015670

AVADI PARUTHIPATTU CMDA Plots:42Lakhs & Ind.House: 60Lakhs

Matrimonial

BRINGING PEOPLE TOGETHER — THE HINDU

BRIDEGROOMS WANTED

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WEDDING ARRANGEMENTS

COSMOPOLITAN

ATTRACTIVE, WARM 30, 168cm, well–read UK–based architect. Open to relocating. Cultured, affluent family. Seeks smart, compatible groom. Lang./caste no bar. Call/WA 93456 34365

HINDU NADAR, 38, 155 cms MD (Anaes) & FNB (Critical Care) from a good family employed in BLR looking for a suitable Doctor / SW Engineer. CNB 80734 37540 / 98450 36548.

31 YRS, 162cm Master's, Architect, from a well–established CSI Protestant business family, Chennai. Seeking a tall, handsome, well–educated & professionally settled groom from similar background. 9884067923

COSMOPOLITAN

CSI CHRISTIAN 40yrs, Software Engineer (UK), seeks any Caste Groom willing to settle in UK 9791322874, 8870560816.

DIVORCEE

BEAUTIFUL, KIND 39, 163cm, responsible, well–educated professional. Seeks smart, warm, compatible groom. Caste no bar. Call/WA 9345 634 365

DOCTOR

NAIDU PG Doctor Girl (Gavara), Pursuing M.S., Final Year, 26/160, Kettai / Viruchigam, Upper Middle Class, Native Coimbatore, Seeking PG Doctor Groom (Sub Sects No Bar) . Contact: 98653 01920, 98426 50751

WANTED DOCTOR GROOM
ROMAN CATHOLIC, MD, DNB, (Anesthesiology), 27 Yrs, 5′ 7″, SLIM, FAIR, REPUTED SCHOOL, COLLEGE, WELL - SETTLED, CHENNAI.
CONTACT No. WhatsApp Profile
75500 65082

Chennai based, Senior Govt official, Well Educated, Well Settled Reputed Mudaliar Family, seeks Post Graduate Fair & Good Looking Doctor Grooms (Age below 32 Height : 172 - 180 cms) for their only Daughter, Medico Post Graduation, Final Year. Age 27 Years from Mudaliar Community. Sub caste: Thuluva Vellalar, Sengundar, Agamudayar, Arcot Mudaliar. Pls. send Horoscope, Photo and Bio data.
Ph : 98416 98995

ENGINEER

GROOM WANTED Canada, Toronto–PR, Bengali Girl, Hindu, Kayastha, Aug'1990, 5'5" B.Tech. Non–Veg, Nev –Mar, Wkg MNC as Manager, High pkg. well – Qualified Canada bases Working Boy, Excuses Divorce. Contact: 9477507531

ENGLISH

CATHOLIC BRIDE, 34, graduate, MNC employed, respectable family, seeks alliance from educated, employed , well–settled Christian groom, aged 3440, good family values. Serious enquiries Ph: 9500083034.

FINANCE / BANKING

SC, AD, Bank Employee PNB, Age: 33, Triupathi. Wanted Bank Employee or Government Employee. Ct :9000180420

MALAYALAM

CATHOLIC NADAR Girl, Thiruvanantapuram, 1994, 158 cm, mutually divorced, Assistant Professor Radiology, St. John's Medical College, Bangalore. Seeking Doctors or Highly qualified professionals from any Christian denomination. WhatsApp: 9447242173.

NAIR DOCTOR Girl DM 32 Yrs 161 Cm seeks Doctor - Professional. Mob: 9249 920550, 8089 584220

HINDU GIRL, cast no bar, age 27, Height 160 cm, Native Keralite, British Citizen, Doctor (MBBS), Currently Working in a reputed hospital in Bangalore, registered Doctor in the UK (Awaiting NHS placement) currently preparing for PG, Well-educated and accomplished family background with liberal and progressive values. She is looking for a well-educated, professionally established and like-minded groom/family who shares similar values. For more details, please contact: +919972092077 (India), +447904312000 (UK).

EZHAVA GIRL, 3.6.93 / 157 Anizham, Anaesthesia doctor seeking alliance from doctors, engineerings. Ph: 8600465446, 8075858158.

NRI

NRI GROOM WANTED. Nair girl, unmarried,Aug1974, well employed US citizen, caste nobar .Malayalam/Tamil US residents only Cont: 9895 824803.

TAMIL

RC CHRISTIAN – 38 Yrs, 175cm, Fair, B.E, M.Tech , Divorcee, No Child, Working in Belgium With Good Salary. Seeks Groom 35+ Years , Well Educated, Tall, Well Employed, Willing to Move to Belgium (Caste No Bar) Contact: 9884086383/82

RC, B.Arch, looking for a groom from 26-30 from any subcaste in Tamilnadu, 8138 900575

CATHOLIC, BE, Looking for a groom from 26-31 from Catholic,RC pillai and Nadar from anywhere, 8138900487

ROMAN CATHOLIC Bride, Aug 1995, 156 cm, B.E.(India) PG (NZ) / New Zealand (PR), Seeks professionally qualified Nadar Bridegroom based in New Zealand / Australia. Contact: 9489262223 / Mail: anthonysamy3007@gmail.com

NATHAMAR UDAYAR Catholic,1993 Borned, HR professional– MNC, with null and void order looking for Christian boy below 35yrs, Working professional with legal, church orders with clean habits, WhatsApp 99400 99429

CATHOLIC VELLALAR 33/171, MBBS, MPH Researcher in student visa, USA Seeks groom from USA. 9150153743

CSI, RICH /Affluent, MSC, looking for a groom from 25-29 from chennai and NRI profiles from CSI and Christian Nadar,8138 900487

CHRISTIAN Nadar, Rich, M.tech, looking for a groom from24-28 from equal status in Kongu circle 8138900575

Father Hindu Gramani/ Mother Christian Nadar seeking suitable Hindu match for daughter 32yrs / 168/ slim/ fair Software professional in Chennai 9444541052.

TAMIL MUSLIM, Fair, 31/157, B.E., MBA, MNC Employee, Short Marriage – Khula Given, Issueless. Seeks Never- Married, Well-Settled Groom. WhatsApp: 6374495811.

CHRISTIAN (BC) Girl, 36/172, B.Tech, MBA, Strategy Consultant at a MNC based in Chennai. Seeking a suitable Christian Groom with good family values. Caste no bar. Ct: 8778907487

BORN AGAIN Christian, 45yrs/152, MBBS, MD doctor, seeks christian groom, Chennai. CT – 9500188067

SEEKING UNMARRIED GRADUATE/IT/NON–IT PROFESSIONAL for 44yrs unmarried Tamil SC Hindu Adi Dravida Female IT professional residing in Singapore. Contact +91 7200942776/ +65 91051142.

AGAMUDAYA MUDALIAR 34 Dentist Chennai. Seeks well educated, good family background Groom. Ct: 9486531194

HINDU SC AD 38 Sr. Software Engineer TCS Chennai Rs 1.40 LPM seeks suitable groom working in Chennai. Ct: 99521 47216 / 88380 34943

GROOM WANTED SC(Ad),30yrs, MBBS, MD, Elite business family in Chennai.Ph: 6385293227

GROOM WANTED Hindu Nadar 35 yrs, divorce,MBBS,MD, Elite Business Family.Ph: 9380791999, 9841329471

INTERCASTE, 25, Masters, Business, looking for a groom from 26-31 from Mudaliar and Naidu from Kongu and chennai circle, 8137001387.

REDDY, Divorced, Masters, looking for a 2nd marriage profile from 29-35 from any caste in India and UAE, 8138900312.

VISWAKARMA, MSC, Upper middle class, seeking for a groom from 24-28 from same caste in tamilnadu, 8138900523.

RC, UDAYAR, optometry, looking for a groom from 27-32 from singapore and any christian subcaste, 8137003550

SC PALLAR, DIVORCEE, 38, Caste No Bar, B.E, M.S Seeking a Suitable Groom.Call/whatsapp 7539985037.

MUDALIAR 32 5.6 Anusham MA(H.R) working well settled family in Chennai seeks qualified groom Age 32– 37 Ct:9444363220

VANNIYAR, BDS, 33, Star – Revathi, Employed, Middle Class Family, Groom from Same Community Needed. Contact: 98409 61251

26YEARS, HINDU, Maruthuvar Community, BDS, MDS, Dentist Girl looking Groom, Doctor/Engineer/ Business/ Govt job. Good family. Ct: 9841747184

MUDALIYAR, 26YRS, MBA,Elite Business Family in Chennai, Seeks Affluent Business Groom.Ph:8925239889

GROOM WANTED Naidu,29yrs, Divorce,B.Tech, Affluent Family in Chennai. Ph: 6385293227

GROOM WANTED CNB,33yrs,BE, Civil service,Well Educated Family.Ph: 6385293227

FASHION DESIGNER Saiva MudaliarAnusham 33 Very Fair Propertied NeedVeg IT/ Govt Employed Groom 9566268349

TAMIL

HINDU SC AD 30/155 cm MTech Bio Well settled Seeking Groom from age 31to 34 India & Abroad Ct 9176667499

VELLALAR, AGE–38, MBBS,MD, Own Hospital Star:Magam, Never married Well settled, Sub Caste ok. 7305460763

NAIDU /PILLAI 31/160cm MBBS MS MRCS doing MCh Bangalore seeks PG Dr Naidu / CNB Geetham 9884858014

MUDALIAR 29/163CM MBBS MD Chennai Seeks Mudaliar Pillai PG Dr Geetham 9884858014

GROOM WANTED CNB,31yrs, BE,MS,Rich & Affluent Business Family in Chennai.Ph:7200187009

GROOM WANTED Hindu Nadar 30yrs, MBBS,MS,own Hospital,rich and Affluent Family.: 9380791999, 9841329471

GROOM WANTED Mudaliyar, 26yrs, MBBS, MD,Own Hospital in Chennai, Elite family.Ph:8925239889

MUDALIAR 24, BE, MBA,160cm Good Looking Well Settled Family Seeks Groom CNB Ct. 8778514465/ 7200866346

VANIYA CHETTIYAR, Rich, BE, Private, looking for a groom from 30-36 from any equal caste and good looking ,8138 900412

VANNIYAR, RICH, Divorced, MD, Doctor, looking for a groom from any caste 2nd marriage profile from 35-45 in Banglore circle,8137001387

MUKULATHOR, UPPER middle class, MSW, looking for a groom from 27-31 in equal caste only in coimbatore, 8137 001247.

NADAR, RICH/affluent, MD, looking for a MD groom only in Nadar caste from 25-29 ,8138 900312

YADAVA, MBBS, looking for a groom from 24-28 from same caste MD,MS, MDS in Tamilnadu, 8138900498

✔ ALLIANCE INVITED for 26–year–old, 169 cm, Fair, SC, Tamil daughter, working as a Securities & Capital Markets Associate with a top–tier corporate law firm in Mumbai/ Bangalore/Chennai, advising companies and banks on IPOs and major financial transactions; CTC Rs.26 LPA. BBA, LL.B. (Hons.), LL.M. qualified. Family–oriented, with strong values. From an educated, well–settled Chennai family; father retired Executive Director of a leading PSU. Seeking a highly qualified, professionally accomplished groom from a respectable family, working in Government/PSU/ Private sector. Ph: 9444415358.

Thuluva Vellala 28/152 BE MBA MSc seeks teetotaller good family BG employed PG groom SNB ct:6382794549, malaranihsr@gmail.com

HINDU VANNAR, 25, Chithirai, BE (C.S) MBA (AI & DS) 163 cm, Good Looking, Father: Prof. in Central – govt. Univ. Mother: Prof. in PVT. Engg. College. Brother: (doing MBBS), seeks suitable groom pref. India, CNB, Ct: 9003567139.

MUDALIAR 27/165, Fair, MBBS, MD, Saveetha Hospital, 1500000 PA, Affluent Fmly, CNB. 9043991629, 9043987029

MUDALIAR PARENTS seek professional groom settled in UK for their daughter age 34 height172 cm Revathi studied medicine in UK and working as surgeon. Ph: 9884452926

GROOM WANTED CNB,28yrs,B.Tech,Own Schools & Colleges, Business Family.Ph: 6385293227

GROOM WANTED SC (Ad),30yrs,BE,MBA (IIM), Well Educated Family . Ph:6385293227

GROOM WANTED CNB, 31yrs,BE, Elite Business Family in Chennai.Ph: 7200187009

HINDU, MBC, 38, M.tech, Divorce, seeking Groom from Engineers and doctors. Caste no bar. Call 9952438211 / 7358824670.

REDDY, GOOD Looking Girl, 28/5'6", Pooram, Ragu / Ketu, Google, HYD Seeks Same Community Boy, 99529 64535

HINDU SC/AD, Age:45, Ashwini (Mesha Rasi), 153cm, B.Sc., M.B.A, Fair & Good looking Girl. Seeking Engrs / Doctors / Grade–1 Officers. Ct: 8248933352 / 9943629339 / 9994219315

SM4 TAMIL Brahmin Iyer Girl, 37/ 5'6", CA, MBA, issueless div (short marr.), affluent family. Seeks well–edu/emp Boy, never marr/ issueless div, 37–42 yrs from cultured, affluent family. Cont: 9043949107 / asalliancemail@gmail.com

TAMIL

Tamil, Good family, 29Years, B.Tech, MBA (BIM), 26 LPA, seeks suitable Groom, CNB. Contact: 9441677205.

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SREERAM
98402 20273

TAMIL

Tamil, 26Years, B.Sc, Good Family, UMC, Fair Girl seeks suitable Groom, CNB. Cont: 9441677205

Kallar (Vellalur Nadu) MBBS, 28 years /170 cm seeks Doctor/ Professional from Vellalur Nattu Kallar only. Contact: 9176393134.

TELUGU

Naidu Girl 30/165 cm Aswini pursuing PhD Doctoral studies in Satellite Communications Quantum Neuromorphic Computing European Space Agency Europe- completing by Dec 2026 seeking suitable groom PhD / MS in USA / Europe. Ct: 9840103686

Seeking groom from affluent family for 33/170cm reddy hindu girl employed as technical lead in MNC Bangalore. Only daughter well to do family CNB. 9944949052

REDDY SPECIALIST Dr.MBBS, MS&EGMP from IIM 165cm 1990 Born. Seeks nevermarried Elite groom CNB. 8925640111

NAIDU:34/FAIR, MBBS, MD, Govt. Asst. Surgeon, TN, Seeks Groom any Telugu Doctor– 9443001170/ 8925019776

Balija Naidu 28yrs/172cm, M.Sc (C.S) Visakam 3rd Padam, Thulam Rasi, Fair, Seeks Professionally Qualified Groom.Ct:9445229864 /044-42875069

NAIDU 25/167 Fair, Beautiful, MBBS, PG–Doing,Chennai, Affluent Cultured Fmly, CNB. 9043991629, 9043987029

URDU

MUSLIM GIRL 29/155 Fair, MBA, working in Dubai seeks handsome well educated groom pref Chennai, working in Dubai. 9840445119 (No Khan)

BRIDES WANTED

ADVOCATE

Wanted fair vegetarian supportive Brahmin bride for LLM 32/6ft, South Indian handsome affluent lawyer at Delhi. Ct. 9846173871

COSMOPOLITAN

✔ ROMAN CATHOLIC/OCT 94/180 cms. /B.E., M.S./Product Mgr./Sweden PR, seeks professionally qualified working bride either based in the EU or willing to relocate to Sweden. Contact sjm.val7@gmail.com or 9923884686

SMART, SUCCESSFUL 29, 179cm, well–educated (IIT BTech/MTech) professional. Affluent S Indian business family. Seeks compatible bride. Language/caste no bar. Call/WA 9345634365

MUSLIM BRIDES 35 to 45 Age divorcee widow single alone satisfaction life broad– Minded caste no bar.abroad UK.Ct: +918667645841

HINDU, EDUCATED family (Father: Tamil–Kongu Vellalar, Mother:Telugu– Kamma) seeks a virtuous, tall, slim, v.fair MD/MS Doctor or well educated bride (Any language / age 29–31 years) for their noble son at Bangalore (DM– Doctor, 34 years, 185cm, Athletic, V. fair, Hastham, Veg@home) from similar castes. Parents: Whatsapp– 9342529547 / 9072118800

MALAYALAM

NAIR BOY 41yrs 174 height , AVITTAM , UnMarried, B–TECH IT , Working in Cognizant,Chennai. Ph : 9884366062

EZHAVA BOY, Makam, 30 / 168 cm, B.E / MBA, Product Manager working in Chennai. Looking for an educated, cultured, and family–oriented girl from a respectable background. Phone: 9499009783 / 9962715014.

Railway Engineer Thiyya 34 Bangalore seeks bride. Contact Phone 8113832105.

TAMIL

CHRISTIAN NADAR, Looking for a bride from 31-37 from CSI and christian nadar doctor profile from any where Tamil mother tongue, 8137001247

CHRISTIAN NADAR, Doctor, MBBS, PGDCC-P(NI), Cardio - Physician, Divorcee, no kids. 38yrs/178cm, lives in Nagercoil. seeks qualified / divorced Bride. Ct: 90039 83230

S.C AD 32yrs B.Tech IT Director in four companies at Chennai seeks suitable girl from same caste 7708850383

CHENNAI–BASED CHRISTIAN IT groom, 35 yrs, Height 165cm, MBA, working in UK, Divorced (No kid). Accepts kids. Any Religion. Seeks working woman. Ph: 8220765305. secondsutra.com

TAMIL MUSLIM, 32/170, BE Mech, Asst Manager in Auto OEM, Chennai seeks Tamil Muslim bride, Ct: 9444297042

RC CHRISTIAN, 43yrs/170, B.E. Software Engineer, never married, works for mnc, Chennai. CT– 9500188067

ADVOCATE 31/168 Unmarried Vegetarian, Teetotaler, Parents Professional, Pillai+Agamudayar Simple Self–Respect Marriage seeks Professional Working Bride 26–29yrs from Chennai settled family. WhatsApp: 9445640752

HINDU NADAR 32/180cm BE MS Fair working USA younger brother 27/ 175cm BE MS V fair VIP family Ct: 9884188849, 7550113468

SOZHIA VELLALA / MUDALIYAR 32/ 182cm, BE / MS., Software Engineer in UK. Seeking Well- educated, Employed / Employable girl, Preferably IT / Doctor background, Willing to relocate to UK. CNB Contact: 7502806125 / 9443192352.

GAVARA NAIDU Boy (29) with H1B VISA in USA seeks Naidu girl knows Tamil with H1B or Student visa in USA. Contact: 9443724981.

DIVORCEE HINDU. 35yrs No issues, M.Tech, well settled Software Engineer, seeking bride with no issues. Caste no bar. 9841862535, 9941962421

BRIDE WANTED Naidu,34yrs, BE, MBA, Elite Business Family.Ph: 6385293227

BRIDE WANTED Mudaliyar, 29yrs, MBA (UK), Rich & Affluent Business Family. Ph:7200187009

BRIDE WANTED CNB, 35yrs,MS (US), Own complex & Multi Business in Bangalore.Ph: 8925239889

HINDU NADAR, 31yrs, 180cm, MS (AI) , Boston, USA. Seeking a fair, Smart, Well–educated & family–oriented bride from Nadar community, who is currently settled/working in the USA. Brokers ExcuseMob: 9385223715

BOYAR, PURSUING MS, looking from a same caste bride from 20-24 in doctor profession in Tamilnadu, 8138009235

SHADAMARSHNA GOTHIRAM Vadamal Avaittam 25 / 176 / Rs.100000 PM, Yajur veda ganapadigal, Veda Parayanam. Own house. Seeks suitable bride from same caste. Ct 8870074323

DIVORCEE

OPEN–MINDED, SUCCESSFUL 43, humble, intelligent (PhD), responsible AI scientist. Seeks progressive, compatible bride. Call/WA 9345 634 365

49, REDDY widower, Software, well–to–do. fit & health conscious. caste no bar. 9885970033

IYER, 2ND Marriage, 45, B.E, Mirugaseerdam, MNC Chennai, Suitable Vegetarian bride wanted. 72000 26588

HINDI

GAUR BRAHMIN Boy, 93, 5'6", BE chemical BITS Pilani, Working IT Company at Bangalore, 70 LPA, Father Doctor, Mother Gazetted officer family in Bhopal Seeking Suitable Girl, 9425301716, 9826023716

KANNADA

HINDU, NEVER Married. Age 45, height 5 ft 7 inch. IIT, Ph.D. University Professor in US, Green Card. Non–smoker, Non– drinker, vegetarian. Seeking Veg bride below 37 yrs. No caste bar. Contact: 8329691330

TAMIL

GROOM 12 th December 1994,Revathy star,Vegetarian Family,doing MCH Urology At Saveetha University. Rich,Teetotalar,Handsome..Looking Vegetarian Family PG Doctor, Bride. Call: 9841039515

MUDALIAR 32 BE, MBA 178cm Smart 40Lacs PA, well Settled Family Seeks Bride, CNB Ct.8778514465/ 7200866346

NAIDU 29/165 M.E,Design Engr L&T, own business & rental income,affluent family,Star:Thiruvonam,Rasi:Magaram.Seeks Suitable bride.Similar level caste also acceptable. 9841097110

VELLORE AGAMUDAYA Mudaliyar I Marriage Rishabam 40/165,BE,MNC/Chicago/USA,1L USD/A. Seeks SWE. 9487624807

BRIDE WANTED Naidu, 29yrs, MBA (IIM),well Educated Family in Chennai.Ph: 7200187009

BRIDE WANTED Hindu Nadar 29yrs, BE, PWD,70K p/m, Business Family. Ph: 9380791999,9841329471

WELL–SETTLED SEEKS Beautiful, Caring, Family–Oriented Life Partner For Genuine Alliance. Ph: 82208 19962

HINDU MARUTHUVAR 36 B.Tech, MBA, IT, Chennai 18 LPA Seeks Suitable Girl. 8754012186.

GAVARA NAIDU, 42,180, Uthiradam, Maharam, B.E.,M.S.(Engg), Chief Egr. MNC Chennai, 15L PA, First Marriage, seeks Naidu Bride.Ct: 9487272897

NAIDU SHORT lived Remarriage 38/ 168cm MBBS MEM pvt Hospital chennai seeks PG Dr CNB Geetham 9884858014

BRIDE WANTED Naidu,29yrs, MBBS, MD, Elite Business Family in Chennai.Ph: 6385293227

BRIDE WANTED CNB, Divorced,31 yrs, BCom working in Banking Sector, Upper Middle class.Ph: 9176718886

HINDU 46 BE 9994351766 Carleton IISc https://ingeniousdesigntech.com https://tamilfilmmakerspro.com

SC Pr Upper Middle Class Groom, PG studied and Employed at Italy aged 30 Seeks educated preferably Engineering graduate girl from India or abroad who willing to move Italy. Caste No Bar. Ct : 9865960836

BRIDE WANTED Naidu, 29yrs, MBA, Well Educated Rich & Affluent Family 7338877275

SC, BE, Business, Rich, looking for a bride from 26-31 from chennai circle in same caste, 8137003550

MUDALIAR 43yrs 170cm MCA divorcee well settled in USA. Looking for a Bride employed in USA or India willing to relocate in USA, Cast No bar P-9842079504, 9443263629

BRIDE WANTED HINDU SAIVA PILLAI 29YRS 170CM Msc IT Chennai Seeking Veg IT Chennai Bride (4yrs Less) 9445688509

HINDU, SC, AD, 32years, BE, 38LPA, Chennai, Parents retired bank staff, well settled. Ph – 9840401929/9840607125

MUDALIYAR 36 yrs / 170 cm B.Tech., M.Sc, 80 LPA Permanent Job in Germany Warmly welcoming an educated and understandable bride. Ph: +91 9442135216, +91 8015435216

MUDALIAR 28/180, Handsome, MBBS, MS, Govt Hospital, 1400000 PA, Affluent Fmly, CNB. 9043991629, 9043987029

SAIVA PILLAI 28/179 MBA, MS (USA) Sr Consultant, Deloitte USI Chennai. Seek well–Educated, Employed Girl from same community. Ct: 9444012863

Hindu Groom, 35,191cm, fair,lecturer, Chennai, relocating to Germany, seeks Educated Hindu Bride Ct: 9003826117

BRIDE WANTED Mudaliyar, 26yrs,B. Tech,Rich & Affluent Business Family in Chennai.Ph: 8925239889

HINDU 37 yrs/ 173cm BE Manager in govt Bank 20 LPA Chennai settled. Seeking a suitable bride Ct:9940507235

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US UK Canada All Caste Religion 1st Marriage Remarriage. Ct:8248757840

TAMIL

IYER VADAMAL, Bharadwaja , 31/168 Sadayam, Kumbam, M.Tech MBA working in IT Company Bangalore, 2 Lacs PM with clean habits, parents retired & settled in Chennai seeks Graduate girl, age diff 0-5 yrs. Ct: murali.adamstreet@gmail.com 9445395026.

BRAHMIN IYER Boy, Magam, 32/170cm B.Tech, TCS Chennai 1L/Month. Seeks Brahmin, Graduate girl. Simple marriage. Ct: 9940352807

BACHELOR OWN Business 61, Iyer pious seeks unmarried Iyer bride. Divorcees & Widows excuse. 9447496006.

LOOKING FOR Vadamal Girl for our Son M. Com & Computers. MOB: 9539244401.

Seeking BRIDE for Bridegroom
Hindu, Kulalar/Udayaar, 44 yrs, 170 cms, M.Tech, IT professional, Caste open for discussion. First Marriage Only
CT: 93842 76066

Mudaliyar 1971/170 unmarried B.Com Manager Pvt 50K, seeks Life Partner, CNB, Broker Excuse.Ct: 9360297552

NAIDU GAVARA 34/172cm.BE MBA SBI Dy.Manager 1LPM seeks suitable Bride.Ct.94434 83784.

Tamil, Good family, 32Years, ME(PSGCT), MBA (SIOM), 30 LPA, seeks suitable Bride, CNB Cell:9441677205.

MUDALIYAR 27 Yrs,178 cm, MS Cyber Sec (UK), 50L.PA, Good looking, Cultured boy with Clean habits (Planing own business in TN soon). Seeks - Good looking, Cultured bride From a decent family Back ground. cell/WhatsApp: 9094460000, Doctor, Chennai.

TELUGU

TELUGU VANNAR, 1984, MBA, Kanni, Astham, Mumbai AGM in MNC, 33 Lac.PA, Any Telugu CNB. Ct: 98947 77505

NAIDU, AGE–34, Sadhayam, B.E., Salary:1L. Well settled family. Sub caste ok. Ct: 8754756329 / 8883158177

NAIDU 29/185, Handsome, MBBS, MD, Frontline Hospital, 2200000 PA, Affluent, CNB. 9043991629, 9043987029

AGE 45 MCA Sadhayam star Kumbha rasi Fair software engineer Seeks Suitable Bride caste no bar. 9894670293

NAIDU 35 MBA seeks employed Bride (any professional degree) any Naidu, Yathava, Telugu chetty 9498072042

Vishwabrahmin 31Y, 170 cm Master's family business Hyderabad Rs. 75 Cr assets. Seeks educated bride from a respectable, compatible family caste no bar Email : ysd174@gmail.com

URDU

CHENNAI BOY NRI–Sunni Urdu Engg H–5.8 Youngest Software Company CEO, Working in USA No Demand 9311730142

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Panelists at the launch of a book by former Madras High Court judge K. Chandru at the Asian College of Journalism in Chennai. M. SRINATH

Ex-Chief Justice says executive's grip over judiciary has tightened

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The grip of the executive over judicial appointments to the constitutional courts, and particularly of the Chief Justice of India, has progressively tightened since May 2014, said Justice S. Muralidhar, former Chief Justice, High Court of Orissa.

Delivering an address during the presentation of the book *Who will judge the judges* by retired judge of Madras High Court K. Chandru, at the Asian College of Journalism in Chennai on Saturday, Justice Muralidhar said: "The collegium system as in the last 12 years has undergone a steady transformation. Today we have a situation where the primacy as in practice has shifted back to the executive. The government has steadily extended its grip over the appointments and transfers of judges and chief justices of High Courts... It can be stated with reasonable certainty, that for the next 10 years in the Supreme Court and for several more years in the High Courts, there will be judges who will owe their position to the current political establishment and the members of the collegium that appointed them. This forebodes not too well for the future of the judiciary".

R. Vaigai, Senior Advocate, Madras High Court, said the judiciary should not only act as the guardian of the Constitution and the Laws but also play a transformative and empowering role.

Asian College of Journalism and Media Development Foundation Chairman Sashi Kumar said: "Surely what is often characterised as one of the most powerful judiciaries of the world falls short in its exertions to safeguard what, again, is considered one of the finest written Constitutions in the world, particularly at a time when the Constitution is, insidiously and palpably, under attack by the ruling dispensation of the day."

The Hindu Director N. Ram presented the book *Who will judge the judges* to the panelists.

Modi, Shah have thrown the nation into turmoil: CPI(M)

Party stages protests across Keralam against detention of leaders in Delhi; slams govt. for 'shielding CEC' and creating a 'lockdown-like situation'; CM calls Pinarayi's detention arbitrary, seeks release

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The CPI(M) Keralam State secretariat on Saturday strongly condemned the detention of several protesters, including senior party leaders, by the Delhi Police ahead of a march to Jantar Mantar seeking the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar, describing it as a "fascist action" by the Union government to suppress dissent.

CPI(M) workers take out a protest march in Kannur, Keralam, on Saturday against the arrest of party leaders in New Delhi. S.K. MOHAN

State-wide stir

The party also organised protests across Keralam, including in Kannur and Alappuzha, against the detentions and alleged police high-handedness.

The CPI(M) said Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah were plunging the entire nation into turmoil in a bid to protect the CEC. The BJP owed an explanation as to why it created an atmosphere akin to a lockdown by deploying more than 50,000 police personnel and paramilitary forces and imposing prohibitory orders.

"The Internet has been shut down in Delhi and 57 Metro stations have been closed. Trains that left for Delhi terminated their service before reaching Delhi. All these actions curb freedom of movement and expression. When the CPI(M) general secretary approached the Supreme Court, the court disagreed with such prohibitions," the party said.

Satheesan's stance

In a post on X, Mr. Vijayan said: "Delhi is witnessing the Modi government's brutal crackdown on democracy," and that protesters and journalists being detained.

Meanwhile, Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan said on X that he was deeply concerned about the arbitrary detention of Mr. Vijayan. He strongly condemned the act and said the Chief Secretary and the Resident Commissioner in New Delhi were in direct contact with the Delhi Police authorities to secure Mr. Vijayan's immediate release.

Discontent brews in Karnataka Cong.

Nagesh Prabhu
BENGALURU

Discontent is simmering among some Karnataka Pradesh Congress Committee (KPCC) legislators and Ministers over Cabinet expansion, fund allocation and alleged interference in constituencies, posing a fresh challenge to Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar's efforts to keep the flock united.

The growing discontent has also brought Mr. Shivakumar's relationship with KPCC president B.K. Hariprasad under scrutiny, with the two reportedly differing on several organisational issues.

While the first half of the Congress government's five-year term was marked by differences between former Chief Minister Siddaramaiah and Mr. Shivakumar, the second half appears to be witnessing public confrontations between some Ministers and legislators. The discontent has surfaced in Shivamogga, Vijayapura, Mysuru, Kolar-Chickballapur and Belagavi districts.

In Shivamogga, tensions have surfaced between School Education Minister and the district in-charge Madhu Bangarappa and Belur Gopalakrishna, Sagar MLA, who was denied a Cabinet berth. Mr. Gopalakrishna has criticised what he described as "favouritism towards political dynasties".

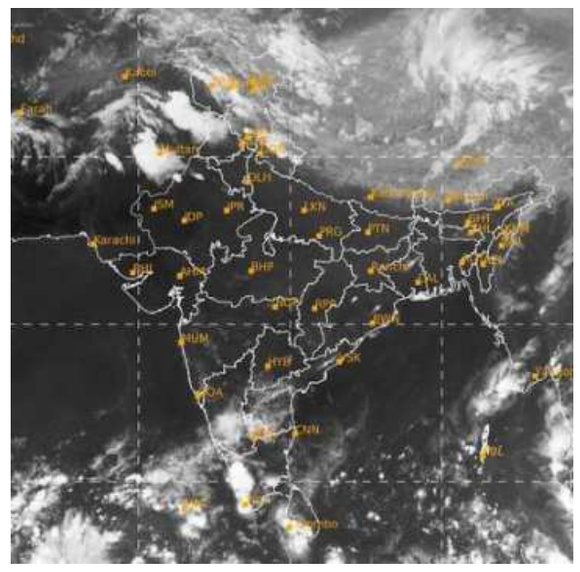
In Vijayapura, differences between Minister M.B. Patil and Congress MLAs C.S. Nadagouda and Yashvantharayagouda Patil have escalated. The legislators have accused Mr. Patil of conspiring to prevent them from securing ministerial berths.

An 'open war'

Yashvantharayagouda Patil had threatened to resign as MLA over the failure to declare his Indi constituency drought-hit. He has also declared an "open war" against the Minister, saying the 2028 Assembly election would become a direct contest between the two.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Sunday: Thunderstorm accompanied with lightning/gusty winds likely at isolated places over Rajasthan, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura, Jharkhand, Odisha, Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karaikal, Keralam and Lakshadweep. Hot and humid weather likely at isolated places over Konkan & Goa and Karnataka

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	19.5	33.2	22.4	Kurnool	—	38.5	26.0
Ahmedabad	—	36.6	23.7	Lucknow	—	31.6	22.2
Aizawl	—	31.5	19.2	Madurai	3	37.0	23.6
Bengaluru	—	30.7	21.8	Mangaluru	—	31.8	24.3
Bhopal	—	35.5	16.8	Mumbai	—	37.4	26.0
Bhubaneswar	1	34.8	24.2	Mysuru	—	31.0	20.1
Chandigarh	—	31.2	23.2	New Delhi	—	33.6	23.8
Chennai	—	36.0	27.2	Patna	—	30.0	23.6
Coimbatore	0.2	34.0	23.0	Port Blair	—	32.5	25.7
Dehradun	—	29.4	19.5	Prayagraj	—	33.2	23.0
Gangtok	5	18.6	13.3	Puducherry	—	34.4	26.5
Goa	—	34.5	26.0	Pune	—	35.8	23.5
Guwahati	—	31.8	22.5	Raipur	—	35.7	24.3
Hubballi	—	34.0	21.0	Ranchi	—	28.8	19.0
Hyderabad	—	34.7	21.5	Shillong	25	22.7	13.2
Imphal	—	30.5	18.3	Shimla	—	24.5	15.2
Jaipur	—	35.6	24.0	Srinagar	—	25.4	9.5
Kochi	24.2	31.0	23.2	Thiruvananthapuram	40	32.8	23.8
Kohima	4.6	20.2	14.6	Tiruchirappalli	—	36.1	26.4
Kolkata	—	31.0	24.6	Vijayawada	—	34.5	25.6
Kozhikode	—	34.2	26.3	Visakhapatnam	—	33.8	26.1

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO_2	NO_2	CO	PM2.5	PM10	CODE
Ahmedabad	.42	..52	.71	...100	...160	
Bengaluru	.27	..21	.48	61	...148	
Chennai	..—	..10	.11	...103	92	
Delhi	.23	..42	117	...111	...128	
Hyderabad	.15	..27	.78	81	...113	
Kolkata	...8	..49	.38	...134	...127	
Lucknow	...5	..29	.34	70	...105	
Mumbai	...9	..83	...1	25	...426	
Pune	.16	..72	.46	91	...121	
Visakhapatnam	.20	..68	.41	...106	...143	

Yesterday

In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Dausa, Rajasthan recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 195 indicating a moderate level of pollution. In contrast, Naharlagun, Arunachal Pradesh recorded a healthy AQI score of 14

Air Quality Code: Poor | Moderate | Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO_2: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO_2: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM2.5 & PM10: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

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NO: CMRL/OPN/CMRS/027/2026 DATE: 10.10.2026

PUBLIC NOTIFICATION

Consequent upon the authorization of The Commissioner of Metro Railway Safety, it is hereby notified under Rule 22(2) of the 'Opening of Metro Railways for public Carriage of Passengers Rules, 2013 and Amendment Rules, 2023', that the newly constructed 15 km long Standard Gauge double line electrified section of Chennai Metro Rail from Poonamallee Bypass Metro to Vadapalani Metro (covering 11 Metro stations namely Poonamallee Bypass Metro, Poonamallee Bus stand Metro, Poonamallee Government Hospital Metro, Karayanchavadi Metro, Kumananchavadi Metro, Kattupakkam Metro, Iyappanthangal Metro, Thelliyaragaram Metro, Porur Bypass Metro, Porur Junction Metro & Vadapalani Metro) of Phase 2 (Corridor-4 Stage 1A) will be opened for public carriage of passengers **from 11.10.2026.**

Ashish Chatterjee I.A.S
Managing Director

DIPR/865/Display/2026

Tamil Nadu Power Generation Corporation Ltd
Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)

Specification No.	Tender Inviting Authority	Name of the Work
05	CE / Electrical / NCTPP III	Operation and Maintenance of Additional Coal Handling System of NCTPP - III for the period of 1 year
06	CE / Electrical / NCTPP III	Operation and Maintenance of Fire Protection and Fire detection Alarm system of NCTPP - III

For details of works / Procurement / Due date of submission / Opening, viewing and downloading of e-tenders, please visit websites: **www.tangedco.gov.in, www.tntenders.gov.in, www.tenders.tn.gov.in**
DIPR/3079/Tender/2026

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From Page One

Thousands held in capital clampdown

The borders of the National Capital were also barricaded, and incoming vehicles were monitored. A large number of protesters were detained at the borders before they could even enter the city. Police also held "*aman*" (peace) meetings with members of various communities to discourage them from participating in the protest. Loudspeaker announcements warned people about Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) being in place in New Delhi, prohibiting any rally or procession.

Protesters were detained from Rajghat, Janpath, Connaught Place, Ashoka Road, Gurudwara Bangla Saheb and ITO, and taken to locations on the outskirts, including Burari, Nangloi, Mundka, Shalimar Bagh and Ashok Nagar.

The flashpoint of the protest was the Safdarjung flyover, where the AISA leader tried to enter New Delhi district to march towards Jantar Mantar.

While the police detained the student leader and many of her associates, several protesters who were unable to reach Jantar Mantar due to the high security deployment, reached the spot of the AISA protest.

Rahul lends support to student protesters

The Prime Minister was fighting for his survival and the mood among students in India and the work done by the Opposition over the past couple of decades were having their effect on him, the Congress leader said.

The Centre, he said, has launched a full-scale attack on Tamil culture, Tamil language, its history, and its traditions through language imposition and centralisation of entrance exams like NEET. The Central government had withheld ₹3,300 crore from Tamil Nadu's schools for not implementing the three-language policy as per the National Education Policy 2020. Besides, there had been an 87% fall in the Tamil-medium students' share of MBBS seats because of NEET. Moreover, 78% of State-run universities in Tamil Nadu were without Vice-Chancellors because the Governor wanted to ensure that they were run by people from the RSS. On top of it, the delimitation policy was designed to punish Tamil Nadu and reduce its voice in the Parliament, he alleged.

Woman among 5 killed in Manipur clashes

In the first incident, a 42-year-old Kuki woman named Domkhonei Touthang was shot dead in Chassad Kuki village in Kamjong district on Friday night. The gunfight between armed groups in the area continued till Saturday morning, also resulting in the death of 22-year-old Michael Ngammin-len Haokip.

Nagas blame Kuki extremists

The Working Committee of the Tangkhul Naga Long (WC-TNL) alleged that Kuki extremists had fired at a team of the Indian Reserve Battalion (IRB) on routine patrolling duty in Chassad Kuki village, leading to the gunfight that started Friday night.

The Naga organisation further alleged that the Kuki extremists launched an armed offensive against Naga civilians on Saturday and set ablaze nine houses in Kamjong, the district headquarters. It said two Naga civil defence volunteers – B.S. Honreipam and Ringphami Jajo – sustained gunshot wounds.

The WC-TNL said the Kuki extremists attacked Ningchou village in the same district later in the day, killing two Naga civilians identified as Ngachanso Ningshen and Leishisan Leishadang. The Myanmar-based extremists also reportedly set a police station in Kamjong on fire.

"The external aggression against Naga villagers of Kamjong bordering Myanmar has become a routine affair since the outbreak of violent conflict in the hills of Manipur," the WC-TNL said.

Kukis blame IRB, NSCN-IM

On the other hand, Kuki organisations blamed the killing of community members on the IRB and the extremist National Socialist Council of Nagalim, also known as the Isak-Muivah faction of the NSCN.

"The IRB personnel attempted to forcibly disperse the Chassad Village Guards, who have been defending their ancestral village with their lives, from their legitimate posts...When the brave women of Chassad came forward to defend their Village Guards, the IRB personnel in a most cowardly, inhumane and indiscriminate manner opened fire upon the unarmed womenfolk, resulting in the death of Domkhonei Touthang," the Kuki Students' Organisation said.

It demanded the immediate registration of an FIR and arrest of all IRB personnel involved in the killing, immediate ex-gratia and justice for the family of the deceased, a high-level independent inquiry by the Central government into the alleged infiltration of NSCN (I-M) cadres into the IRB, and the withdrawal of "such biased" State forces.

Manipur's Deputy Chief Minister Nemcha Kipgen and the Kuki Inpi Manipur, an apex tribal body, condemned the killing of the two Kuki civilians in Kamjong district and the Gurkha farmer in Ukhrul district. They sought interventions from the Centre, the State government, and national and international human rights organisations.

Delhi Police treated us like criminals, says Mamata

Former West Bengal CM and former CMs Pinarayi Vijayan, Arvind Kejriwal and Manik Sarkar wanted to join the protesters to show solidarity; CPI(M) leaders managed to reach Jantar Mantar

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

Pinarayi Vijayan (left) at Jantar Mantar and Mamata Banerjee in a police van after being detained by the police during a protest against the CEC in New Delhi on Saturday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA, ANI

The police detained four former Chief Ministers, Pinarayi Vijayan, Mamata Banerjee, Arvind Kejriwal and Manik Sarkar, who wanted to join the youth groups' protests in Delhi on Saturday.

Mr. Vijayan, former Keralam Chief Minister, was picked up from Kerala House, close to Jantar Mantar. Former West Bengal Chief Minister Ms. Banerjee was picked up from the South Avenue bus stand, right in front of the flats allotted to parliamentarians.

The Communist Party of India (Marxist) leadership managed to take the police by surprise after staying overnight at Kerala House, which is just a few metres from Jantar Mantar – a location that the police sought to make completely out of bounds for protesters. Party leaders, including general secretary M.A. Baby and senior leaders Brinda Karat, John Brittas, K.N. Balagopal, K.K. Shailaja, P. Sivadasan, and P. Rajeeve, marched out of Kerala House towards Jantar Mantar, shouting slogans. They were detained immediately by the police.

In a video message posted on social media, Ms. Karat said, "Amit Shah *dekh lo, hum pahunch gaye Jantar Mantar* (Look Amit Shah, we have reached Jantar Mantar)". The group was split up, and Mr. Vijayan, along with others, were taken to Chattarasal Stadium.

Forty minutes later, Mr. Vijayan, along with Mr. Brittas and Mr. Balagopal, were again put into a police jeep and taken to a different location. "If a person who served as Chief Minister for 10 years is treated like this, imagine the plight of the common man. Delhi is under siege and basic civil liberties are being taken away," Mr. Brittas, a Rajya Sabha MP, said.

A few hours later, Ms. Banerjee, who was sitting on a *dharna* at the South Avenue bus stand, right in front of the MPs' flats, along with Rajya Sabha MPs Derek O'Brien and Dola Sen, Lok Sabha MPs Protima Mandal and Samirul Islam, and former MP Saket Gokhale, was picked by the Delhi Police.

Speaking over the phone from Dwarka North police station, Ms. Banerjee said that she and her colleagues were treated like "criminals" despite just six of them sitting peacefully without raising slogans or holding placards. "The Delhi Police treated us like criminals, like murderers. We were put in a prison van and driven for two hours around Delhi. It is the first time in my political career that I have sat in a prison van," Ms. Banerjee said. She likened Saturday's clampdown by the government across Delhi to "doomsday".

"I was going to return to Kolkata by a 9 p.m. flight, [but] I have decided to stay back. I will march along with other INDIA bloc leaders to the Supreme Court," she said.

Former Delhi Chief Minister Mr. Kejriwal and former Tripura Chief Minister Mr. Sarkar were also detained by the police.

Stopping return of 'leaderless' crowd a challenge for govt.

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

Though the Union government succeeded in preventing protesters seeking Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation from converging at Jantar Mantar on Saturday, its next challenge appeared to be stopping the largely "leaderless" crowd from regrouping in the coming days.

After a hearing in the Supreme Court on Friday regarding the restrictions in Delhi, the government had considered offering Ramlila Maidan as an alternative protest site to the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), officials claimed. But, they said, the organisers had not requested this.

Pellet guns, which injured four people on July 20 during the protest demanding the resignation of Dharmendra Pradhan, were withdrawn from the anti-riot gear of the Rapid Action Force (RAF) for Saturday's protest. However, some Border Security Force (BSF) personnel were seen carrying a sub-machine gun.

Security dilemma

Government officials told *The Hindu* that mobilising security arrangements to the scale seen on Saturday would not be feasible in the coming days, and that keeping protesters under detention for more than 24 hours would not be legal.

The Connaught Place block, one of the busiest commercial establishments in the country, which was shut on Saturday at the request of the police, cannot be blocked off indefinitely, officials said.

Each radial leading to Jantar Mantar was blocked with barricades, and 20-30 armed police and security force personnel were deployed at each location. "Such resources may not be available indefinitely. It is impossible to keep the entire area blocked for consecutive days," said one official.

Large crowd

The official said one of the immediate challenges for authorities was managing a crowd that was not waiting for any leader or personality to lead them.

The detention of CJP leaders Abhijeet Dipke, Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das by the police as soon as their Air India flight landed at the Delhi airport on Saturday morning did not have much of an impact on the ground.

On the draw

Detention of leaders: SC to hear plea today

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court is hearing on Sunday a petition filed by Rajya Sabha MP and senior advocate Menaka Guruswamy against the indiscriminate detentions of leaders, former Chief Ministers, students, youths, journalists, lawyers, and others by the Delhi Police, against the rule of law and democratic dissent.

The court is also, in the special session on Sunday, hearing a contempt petition challenging the blanket shutdown of public transport, rail and Metro services designed to deter protesters converging at the national capital to demand the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

Metro stations remained shut almost across the national capital, major roads were heavily barricaded with the heavy presence of security personnel, and trains to Delhi were cancelled on Saturday.

The petitions will be heard by a Bench of Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V. Mohana.

Cong. backs protesters but stays away from CJP stir

Sandeep Phukan
NEW DELHI

Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi had a message for protesters on the streets of the capital on Saturday: "Youth of India, I am proud of you. Keep protesting. We are standing with you." He sent it as a video message, though, as both he and his party were conspicuously absent from the agitation this weekend.

Party chief Mallikarjun Kharge accused the Centre of turning the "mother of democracy" into a "muzzled democracy".

However, Mr. Gandhi's decision to leave Delhi on Saturday, heading south to hold the latest edition of his 'Chhatron Ki Goonj' student outreach programme in Chennai, raised questions about the Congress's approach to the wider agitation.

Later, party general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal appealed to citizens to join the INDIA bloc's proposed march to the Supreme Court on Monday.

"Our youth, students, lawyers, journalists, social activists, farm union leaders, YouTubers, content creators, everyone who is questioning this regime are being detained. Modi Govt has turned the 'Mother of Democracy' into a 'Muzzled Democracy'!" Mr. Kharge said.

Mr. Kharge's strong condemnation comes amid questions over the Congress's reluctance to explicitly endorse the protests called by the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) and several student and youth organisations, including those affiliated to its own allies. The Congress chief said detentions, arrests, jails, lathis, and pellets could not deter the people of India, adding that "since the days of our Freedom struggle, the youth have been at the forefront of shaping the nation's destiny".

BJP accuses INDIA bloc, CJP of seeking to destabilise nation

Devesh K. Pandey
NEW DELHI

Nitin Nabin

The BJP on Saturday launched a scathing attack on the Congress-led Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance (INDIA) and the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), which it described as an Aam Aadmi Party "proxy". The BJP alleged that both groups were seeking to destabilise India at the behest of foreign powers, warning that such "sinister designs" to foment unrest would be met with a firm response.

"I warn you that the BJP and the patriotic people of the country will give you a fitting response. The attempts you are making today to create disturbance will be dealt with firmly by the Government of India. We will counter all such forces resolutely, whether they are operating from abroad or within the country," said BJP president Nitin Nabin.

Stating that efforts were underway to create an extremely serious and dangerous situation in the country, Mr. Nabin said: "And who is doing this? These are two anarchist groups: one led by Rahul Gandhi, the leader of the INDIA bloc, and the other led by CJP, an ally of Arvind Kejriwal. I want to make it clear to both these groups that the people of India are watching you closely."

"This anarchic competition you are engaged in, to see who can create the greatest instability in this country, will not succeed. The people have rejected both Rahul Gandhi's INDIA bloc, and Arvind Kejriwal and his CJP. Instead of learning from the people's verdict, you are trying to destabilise the country. You are doing this not only to pursue your political objectives but also at the behest of foreign powers," said Mr. Nabin.

Tushar Gandhi among 600 detained by Mumbai Police

Snehal Mutha
Chinmay Gaikwad
MUMBAI

In solidarity: Actor Imran Khan at the anti-CEC protest near August Kranti Maidan in Mumbai on Saturday. EMMANUAL YOGINI

On a hot afternoon, hundreds of students and youth activists started arriving at Mumbai's August Kranti Maidan to show solidarity with the protest in Delhi on Saturday for Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation.

As the police barricaded the road leading to Kranti Maidan, the designated protest site, people held a protest outside the ground. "Around 600 protesters were detained in Mumbai city," said IPS officer Shailesh Balkawade.

Among the detainees were Mahatma Gandhi's great grandson Tushar Gandhi, actor Imran Khan, Shiv Sena (UBT) MLA Varun Sardesai, and former MLC Kapil Patil.

The Mumbai protest was planned by Hum Bharat Ke Log, a civil group led by Mr. Gandhi, in solidarity with the stir by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and Left groups in Delhi.

Mr. Gandhi was taken to the DN Nagar Police Station in Mumbai's Andheri West. "We will continue our protest despite detention," he said.

Before Mr. Khan was detained, he said: "I am not scared, but what is happening around here is scary." He was taken to the Tardeo police station.

The detainees raised slogans such as *"Jai Bheem"*, *"Inquilab Zindabad"*, and *"Gyanu, istifa do* [Gyanesh, resign]".

"We are not criminals, we are just showing up for the cause we believe in. But look, they are violating our freedom of speech," said Natasha Perira, a protester.

Mridula, a student associated with Disha, a student body, said, *"Humara vote churaya hai* (Our vote has been stolen). Those in power are not above the law. When outsiders attack, we retaliate, but when the attack comes from inside, from our political leaders, then we need to protest. Protest keeps going, it is not a one-day thing, today we will be detained, tomorrow more will come together." Ms. Mridula was among those detained.

Another protester, Rachita Pujari, who works in a school, said, "I have heard the difficulties certain families suffered due to SIR process. I teach their children. SIR has selectively been unfair to certain communities, including Muslims." She added, "They submitted a plethora of documents to get the voter ID, but nothing was considered valid."

Unequal force: Police personnel detain a protester during the CJP protest in Delhi on Saturday. REUTERS

Tense scene: A protester being taken away by security personnel near Connaught Place in Delhi. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

Heavy deployment: Security personnel keep vigil during the protest on Saturday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

Chorus of dissent: A crowd of protesters raises slogans near Connaught Place. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

Defiance, detentions mark road to Jantar Mantar

As a massive security deployment turned Delhi into a fortress, protesters remained determined to join the demonstration seeking the resignation of CEC Gyanesh Kumar over alleged SIR-related irregularities; with Jantar Mantar inaccessible, they broke into spontaneous protests wherever they could, raising slogans and courting detention, some smiling their way into waiting buses

Abhinay Lakshman
Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

Before dawn broke over New Delhi on Saturday, tension was palpable at the Hazrat Nizamuddin Railway Station. Porters and taxi drivers scrambled for work, acutely aware that the government's cancellation of dozens of trains would cost them business later in the day. At rest stops and parking lots, workers kept one eye on their smartphones as whispers went around: "the public has awakened now", "looks like the police are preparing to beat up protesters", and "all eyes are now on Jantar Mantar".

Spirited individuals

Geetika, a 25-year-old software engineer, quietly left her Faridabad home before 5 a.m., careful not to wake her mother, and booked a cab to Jantar Mantar; 63-year-old Shaheena and her 36-year-old daughter Sabika Muzaffar drove from their Gurugram home, with a hand-made poster concealed in a black map-holder; and students from Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU) found a way out of the campus in the dead of the night, notebooks in hand to mask themselves amongst the gaggle of journalists they knew would gather outside the Jantar Mantar protest site.

Ruma Saikia, who travelled to Delhi from Assam, had been trying to reach Jantar Mantar since 6 a.m. but could not, while 19-year-old college student Jiya spent the night in a car with her mother at the parking lot outside the Bangla Sahib Gurudwara hoping to demonstrate on Saturday morning.

Even as armed Border Security Force (BSF) personnel arrived at the Hazrat Nizamuddin Railway Station before daybreak to monitor exiting passengers, the Delhi Police were fortifying the entirety of New Delhi, especially the designated protest site in the heart of the national capital to prevent 'Jantar Mantar 2.0', a protest called by youth organisations, seeking Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation over alleged special intensive revision (SIR)-linked vote theft. By 9 a.m. Geetika, Shaheena, and Sabika had been detained and put on buses, some after holding a poster for 15 minutes and others after they started speaking to the press about why they felt they needed to be there.

People's demand: Economist Jean Dreze and others take part in a protest seeking the resignation of CEC Gyanesh Kumar, at Jantar Mantar on Saturday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

While the Delhi Police's deployment of security personnel across the city made citizens like Geetika feel the need to protest more intensely, sporadic acts of protest in the early morning hours of Saturday set the tone for how the day played out across several parts of Delhi.

Wherever they found themselves, protesters unfurled posters, raised slogans, and courted detention by simply smiling their way into buses.

As news of Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) leaders Abhijit Dipke, Saurav Das, and Ashutosh Ranka's detention spread, the Delhi Police managed to prevent protesters from entering the Jantar Mantar protest site throughout Saturday. However, protesters themselves had started dispersing and demonstrating wherever they could, for however long they could, before they were detained by the police.

Even as these demonstrations started spreading, senior Delhi Police personnel were seen holding debriefing sessions with security personnel on how to handle protesters at locations like the Jantar Mantar Road-Ashoka Road roundabout and the Windsor Place circle. The security personnel listened intently, as senior officers explained that using force should be the "last resort".

Noted economist, social scientist, and activist Jean Dreze had stationed himself at one entrance to the protest site with a group of JNU students associated with the Left-affiliated Students' Federation of India (SFI) from 7.30 a.m., before the group suddenly unfurled protest banners hours later in front of security personnel, and was taken away.

Simultaneously, a group of SFI student leaders, led by former JNUSU president Aishe Ghosh, started a march calling for the CEC's resignation at Gol Dak Khana Roundabout, before being chased and dragged away by security forces. Protesters following them either ran into the nearby Bangla Sahib Gurudwara for shelter or into nearby streets for a break before regrouping.

Protesters had arrived after walking for kilometres, taking public transport, and hitch-hiking, with shin guards and elbow guards worn under their clothes for protection, even as a section of the agitators egged the security forces on so they could be detained on buses and shout slogans calling for Prime Minister Narendra Modi's resignation. Slogans that echoed through this stretch of Ashoka Road from time to time included "*Tanashahi nahi chalegi* (down with dictatorship)", "*SIR radd karo* (scrap SIR)" and "*Gyanesh Kumar istifa do* (Gyanesh Kumar, resign)".

Some protesters, even as they were being taken into custody, urged the police to allow them a few moments to record videos or speak to the media.

The stand-off repeatedly spilled onto the street as protesters emerged from the gurdwara with banners and placards, attempting to resume their demonstration. The police moved in almost immediately, detaining several people and loading them into private buses being used as detention vehicles. Additional personnel, including RAF and Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) units, were deployed along the stretch as the confrontation continued.

Cat-and-mouse chase

The scene soon turned into a cat-and-mouse chase, with protesters regrouping on the streets before retreating into the gurdwara to evade detention.

By late afternoon, the playbook of dispersing protesters and demonstrating wherever one was had spread. All India Students' Association (AISA) leader Neha Bora had emerged with activists, including Yogendra Yadav and senior advocate Prashant Bhushan, to lead a march to Jantar Mantar from the AIIMS area, where the student activist's detention led to further sporadic protests.

Youth bodies vow to sustain stir till CEC quits

Suruchi Kumari
NEW DELHI

Leaders of youth and student organisations on Saturday vowed to continue their protest until all their demands, including the rollback of special intensive revision (SIR) and the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar were met, despite the detention of several key organisers ahead of the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) planned demonstration in New Delhi.

"We will come back tomorrow and walk towards Jantar Mantar again," said Ajinkya Shinde, national organisation in-charge of the CJP, at a joint press conference with representatives of the Students' Federation of India (SFI) and All India Students' Federation (AISF).

CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke and co-conveners Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das were detained on arrival at the Delhi airport. Hours later, SFI's Aishe Ghosh and AISA's Neha Bora were also detained along with other members of the Left front.

"All these detentions show the fascist nature of the government and how it is afraid of the youth after July's protest. They stopped buses and trains to prevent us from gathering. They stopped everything within their control except air and water. Protesters, students and citizens have all been tracked and detained," said Mr. Shinde.

He said this was just the beginning of the fight and the protests would not stop "until Gyanesh Kumar resigns".

Mr. Shinde was named to lead the protest soon after CJP's top leadership was detained. In a video message posted on X following their detention, Mr. Dipke said, "If you are watching this video, it means Ashutosh Ranka, Saurav Das, and I have been taken into custody. The movement does not end here. Ajinkya Shinde will lead the protest at Jantar Mantar for as long as we remain in detention."

Anticipating arrest, Mr. Dipke recorded the video message on Friday night.

Upon touchdown: CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke and co-conveners Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das, after landing in Delhi. PTI

Police action aboard flight raises queries over protocol

Jagriti Chandra
NEW DELHI

The detention of three Cockroach Janta Party activists – Abhijeet Dipke, Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka – aboard Air India flight AI 2428, after it landed in Delhi on Saturday, ahead of the group's proposed protest at Jantar Mantar, caught the airline by surprise, it is reliably learnt.

In what airport security personnel described as an unusual move, Delhi Police, accompanied by Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) officials, boarded the aircraft and took the activists into custody from their seats. The CISF is responsible for security and access control at most major airports.

The flight, which departed Mumbai at 8 a.m. and arrived in Delhi at 10.20 a.m., had its parking bay changed on the instructions of the CISF before the aircraft landed. The move took the airline's security team by surprise.

Air India has now written to the Bureau of Civil Aviation Security (BCAS), seeking clarity on the applicable guidelines in such situations, the circumstances under which police personnel were permitted to board the aircraft and the apparent lack of advance coordination with the airline. According to Aircraft (Security) Rules, 2023, airlines control access to aircraft.

The events raise questions about protocols governing such access and responsibility for coordination between law-enforcement agencies, airport security, and the airline.

INBRIEF

Detained lawyers released after Bar bodies intervene

A group of lawyers was released on Saturday after being detained for nearly two hours while staging a protest outside the Supreme Court, demanding Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar's resignation. The lawyers, who were taken to the Yamuna Sports Complex, were released following interventions by Supreme Court Bar bodies. The Supreme Court Bar Association (SCBA) and the Supreme Court Advocates-on-Record Association (SCAORA) passed resolutions addressed to Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant, seeking the release of the detained lawyers. SCAORA president Devvrat told *The Hindu* that they subsequently received a communication from the CJI's office indicating that the Delhi Police Commissioner had been asked to ensure their immediate release.

Court rejects CJP leader's plea over 'wrongful confinement'

A Delhi court on Saturday dismissed a plea by the head of the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) legal wing Ratna Singh, alleging that she had been "wrongfully confined" by the police outside her residence in Jangpura amid a massive police crackdown in the national capital to thwart a youth protest demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar. Ms. Singh told *The Hindu* that Delhi Police personnel had surrounded the car in which she was sitting outside her residence with advocates Tara Narula and Shivangi Sharma earlier on Saturday. Police personnel had cited "verbal orders from above" to prevent her from leaving, she alleged. Chief Judicial Magistrate Abhinav Pandey of the Saket District Court held that the application was not *prima facie* maintainable in its present form, observing that it failed to comply with the "statutory requirement" of filing an affidavit attesting to the veracity of the allegations, and to specify the exact location of the alleged confinement for determining the court's jurisdiction.

Dilli Haat turns epicentre of protest for a day

Ashna Butani
NEW DELHI

Unable to reach Jantar Mantar because of barricades, hundreds of protesters, mostly unaffiliated with any organisation, began gathering at Dilli Haat, an open-air crafts market, through the AIIMS Metro station on Saturday afternoon.

The shift followed a social media post by All India Students' Association (AISA) president Neha Bora declaring that "Dilli Haat is Jantar Mantar for today".

Even as the protesters split into smaller groups and marched near INA Metro station, around the end of the Safdarjung flyover, near INA market, and through adjoining residential colonies, the police chased and detained many of them. By evening, hundreds had gathered near Dilli Haat Metro station, where police personnel were seen grabbing, and putting them into buses. Many protesters wore masks, fearing that revealing their identities could have security and family repercussions.

New location: Hundreds of protesters gathered at Dilli Haat in the city on Saturday.

Protesters from across the city spent hours on Saturday morning trying to reach Jantar Mantar but failed. At 1.10 p.m., the AISA leader announced that the protest had moved to Dilli Haat. Soon after, the police barricaded the Safdarjung flyover as students marched towards the area. During the first two rounds of detentions near the end of the flyover, police personnel were seen wielding lathis. The AISA president and other leaders were subsequently detained, and one protester was seen bleeding profusely from the head.

As the number of students swelled steadily through the day, two recent graduates of Ashoka University said it had taken them around four hours to reach Dilli Haat. One of them, who did not wish to be named, said, "We were unsure whether we would be able to reach Delhi at all today. Following Neha's call, we decided to come here because Jantar Mantar seemed impossible." They said it was a relief that the AIIMS Metro station had not been shut, and that internet services were working.

Groups of students were seen walking along roads, assembling at various points and discussing how their friends were being "brutally detained". Every few minutes, dozens of police personnel were seen running after the groups to disperse and detain them. Many protesters, including women, were dragged away.

Around 4 p.m., those shopping inside Dilli Haat were asked to vacate the premises, and the gates were shut. Women hawkers selling jewellery outside the complex, who were also asked to leave, were angry at the police over their "behaviour with the protesters".

Students were also seen questioning some police personnel about their missing nameplates. The personnel said the nameplates had broken while they were detaining protesters.

INBRIEF

All 22 Indian seafarers safe after attack on oil tanker

Shipping Minister Sarbanada Sonowal has said that Panama-flagged crude oil tanker *MT Gem No. 2*, carrying a crew of 22 Indian nationals, was subjected to a drone attack at Sharjah Anchorage on October 9. Mr. Sonowal, in a post on X, further said that he was relieved to share that all 22 Indian seafarers onboard were reported to be completely safe. "We are continuously monitoring the situation and in contact with the ship management company to ensure security," he added. PTI

Bihar CM transfers ₹1,237 cr. under State pension scheme

Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary on Saturday transferred ₹1,237.48 crore into the bank accounts of over 1.8 crore beneficiaries under the social security pension scheme, which included the elderly, persons with disabilities, and widows. He transferred ₹1,100 per person for September 2026. Congratulating all the beneficiaries, Mr. Choudhary said all District Magistrates must ensure that no eligible beneficiary of the social security pension is left out. He urged public representatives to visit villages to assess disbursement, while adding that increasing the social security pension amount from ₹400 to ₹1,100 has brought a positive change in people's lives.

Former AAP councillor convicted in Delhi riots case

A Delhi court on Saturday convicted former Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) councillor Tahir Hussain of abetment to rioting in a case related to the northeast Delhi riots in 2020. The court acquitted the 12 other accused of all charges. Additional Sessions Judge Praveen Singh of a Karkardooma court held Tahir Hussain guilty of rioting and abetment, while discharging him of several other offences. The hearing for the sentencing will take place on November 16. Hussain and four others were convicted in July in a case pertaining to the murder of Intelligence Bureau (IB) officer Ankit Sharma during the riots. The northeast Delhi riots of February 2020 claimed 53 lives, left many injured, and resulted in widespread damage to property.

100 senior police officers transferred across J&K

In a major rejig of the Jammu and Kashmir police, Lieutenant-Governor Manoj Sinha on Friday ordered the transfer of 100 senior police officers, including chiefs of several districts. Of them, 28 are Indian Police Service (IPS) officers, while the rest are Jammu and Kashmir Police Service officers. The districts of Ganderbal, Kupwara, Bandipora, Ramban and Poonch, as well as the police districts of Sopore, Handwara and Awantipora, got new chiefs. SSP Traffic, Srinagar City, Aijaz Ahmad Bhat, has been posted as Commandant, 23rd Armed Police while Bisma Qazi will be the new traffic police chief. The L-G also shifted officers of the Railways Police. PTI

SUDOKU

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DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★☆☆

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

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NIA to investigate attack on Indian pilot of flydubai plane

Investigation agency files FIR under anti-hijacking and UAPA laws after Centre says the incident has 'grave national and international ramifications' and the 'larger conspiracy' must be unearthed

Devesh K. Pandey
NEW DELHI

The National Investigation Agency (NIA) has registered a case in connection with the alleged mid-air hijacking attempt of an Israel-bound flydubai flight and the attack on its Indian pilot Captain Smit Machchhar on September 30.

The agency has invoked Section 3 of the Anti-Hijacking Act and Section 16, read with Section 15(1)(a), of the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act. The first information report (FIR) identifies the accused who attacked Captain Machchhar as the "Omani First Officer of flydubai flight no. 1073".

Recounting the sequence of events, the FIR states that the Omani co-pilot stabbed Captain Machchhar in an apparent attempt to hijack the aircraft or crash it. Mr. Machchhar sustained deep cuts to his head and hands. The incident occurred in the Saudi Arabian airspace near the Jordan-Saudi Arabia border.

Captain Machchhar was airlifted to Abu Dhabi in the United Arab Emirates, where he is recuperating at a hospital. AP

The government referred the matter to the investigation agency for registration of a case and investigation, citing the "grave national and international ramifications" of the attack, and the need to investigate the possible "larger conspiracy." As part of the investigation, the agency may record statements of eyewitnesses, examine any statements made by the accused, and analyse flight data to establish the sequence of events.

The statement of Captain Machchhar might also be recorded. According to information received by the government, the flydubai flight departed from Dubai, UAE at 7.05 a.m. on September 30, carrying 174 passengers and six crew members.

At 9.21 a.m., the airplane reportedly descended rapidly and turned back into the Saudi airspace while flying near the Jordan-Saudi Arabia border. Passengers reported that the first officer stabbed Captain Machchhar but was overpowered and restrained by passengers and crew members.

The other pilots on board subsequently landed the airplane safely at Prince Sultan bin Abdulaziz Airport in Tabuk, northwestern Saudi Arabia, around 10.45 a.m.

The Saudi authorities later arrested the first officer. Captain Machchhar was airlifted to Abu Dhabi in the United Arab Emirates, where he is recuperating at a hospital.

Assam, Meghalaya villagers oppose hydropower project

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

After decades of conflict over a disputed boundary, villagers in Assam and Meghalaya living along the Kulsi river have come together to oppose a hydropower project pursued jointly by the two State governments.

In June 2025, the governments of Assam and Meghalaya announced their plan to build a 55-megawatt hydropower-cum-irrigation project on the Kulsi, a natural habitat of the endangered Gangetic dolphin. The dam was proposed at the confluence of the Dron, Shree and Dilma rivers, which form the Kulsi, a tributary of the Brahmaputra.

The location of the proposed project is on the Assam-Meghalaya border, about 80 km southwest of Guwahati.

On Thursday, more than 2,000 people from the indigenous Bodo, Garo, Khasi and Rabha communities gathered at Ukiam to renew their opposition to the Kulsi project. Ukiam is near the proposed dam site and almost equidistant from Borduar and Langpih, two of the six disputed border sectors awaiting settlement since the 1970s.

Chiefs take a stand

The Assam-Meghalaya Joint Protection Committee (AMJPC), founded in 2025 to coordinate opposition to the proposed project, organised the protest rally. During the rally, three traditional chiefs – Kestor Manik Syiem Iich of Nongkhlaw, Phlowing Syiem Nongbak of Nongmynsaw, and Order Syiem Sad of Rambrai – assured the villagers that they would not grant consent for the hydropower project.

"Projects involving land in Meghalaya require no-objection certificates from the traditional chiefs. Such consent will not be granted for this project," the Nongkhlaw chief said.

On what grounds were large-scale detentions made, ask legal experts

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

Amid large-scale detentions across the national capital on Saturday, as police sought to thwart a youth protest demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar over deletions of names from electoral rolls, legal experts questioned the basis on which Delhi Police detained protesters beyond the New Delhi district, where prohibitory orders under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) are in force.

The Delhi Police have maintained that detentions in the capital followed violations of prohibitory orders imposed under Section 163 of the BNSS. Section 163 of the BNSS, which replaced Section 144 of the Code of Criminal Procedure (CrPC), empowers an executive magistrate to issue prohibitory orders where "immediate prevention or speedy remedy is desirable." Late on Saturday evening, police said women protesters and senior citizens were being released from detention centres.

Security personnel keep guard at Cannaught Place in New Delhi on Saturday. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

"The detention of CJP representatives from areas in Delhi-NCR where prohibitory orders are not in force is wholly illegal," advocate Nipun Saxena said.

"Intended as an exceptional measure to deal with emergencies and maintain public peace, such orders are often reissued by the authorities in a cyclostyled manner, turning an exceptional power into a routine tool to curb protests," Mr. Saxena added.

Grounds of detention

Referring to instances of protesters being picked up and taken to buses and stadiums across the capital, former Supreme Court judge Abhay S. Oka said authorities were obligated under Article 22 of the Constitution to communicate the grounds for depriving a person of their liberty "as soon as may be". He said this protection could not be circumvented merely by describing the restraint as detention rather than a formal arrest.

Mr. Saxena agreed, saying that even where the police claim to be exercising preventive powers rather than arresting a person for an offence, the grounds for detention must be communicated.

Concerned by 'mass detentions' of Delhi protesters: UN body

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

UN Human Rights Commissioner calls for the immediate release of all those detained arbitrarily

The Office of the United Nations Human Rights Commissioner (OHCHR) on Saturday said it was "concerned" by reports of "mass detentions" at the Delhi protests against the Chief Election Commissioner, a statement that the government rejected.

The UN body said that Indian authorities should ensure that the right to peaceful protest is respected and that all those detained "arbitrarily" must be immediately and unconditionally released. The government responded sharply, calling the concerns "misplaced" and calling the OHCHR's statement "unwarranted interference in the internal affairs of India".

"We are concerned by reports of mass detentions in India of demonstrators, protest leaders, members of civil society organisations, lawyers and journalists, before and during today's large-scale demonstrations in Delhi," UN Human Rights spokesperson Thameen Al-Kheetan said in the statement, adding that any restrictions on the peaceful protests should meet the test of "necessity and proportionality", in a possible reference to the large security presence in the Capital with barricades across central areas, the suspension of the internet, and the cancellation of trains to the city.

"The Indian authorities should also ensure law enforcement forces exercise utmost restraint in response to peaceful protesters, consistent with the country's democratic traditions and human rights obligations," Mr. Al-Kheetan said.

In a statement a few hours later, India's Permanent Mission in Geneva, where the UN body is based, said:

"As in every democracy, Indian citizens exercise this right subject to reasonable restrictions in the interest of public order."

Self-reliance key to future warfare, says Rajnath Singh

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI

Military power in the future would depend less on the number of platforms a country possesses and more on the speed of sensing, decision-making and action, Union Defence Minister Rajnath Singh said on Saturday, while calling for greater self-reliance in defence technology, and stronger partnerships with trusted countries.

Mr. Singh addressed the participants in the second edition of the multinational air exercise 'Tarang Shakti 2026' at the Jodhpur Air Force Station, the Ministry of Defence said in a statement.

Modern warfare was expanding beyond the traditional domains, he told the gathering, adding that drones, artificial intelligence, electronic warfare and long-range precision weapons were increasingly shaping military operations.

Emphasising the importance of *atmanirbharta* (self-reliance) in defence, he said indigenous capabilities were essential to sustain the country during prolonged conflicts.

ED arrests two in drug trafficking syndicate

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has arrested two men in a money-laundering investigation linked to an alleged transnational narcotics trafficking syndicate operated by international drug trafficker Salim Ismail Dola and his associates.

"The accused have been identified as Pravin alias Nagesh Ramchandra Shinde and Brijesh Kanjibhai Moradiya," an official statement said. "They were arrested under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), 2002, by the ED's Mumbai Zonal Office," it said.

CJP member moves top court on whereabouts of Dipke, others

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A *habeas corpus* petition has been filed before the Supreme Court seeking the production and release of Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) founder Abhijeet Dipke, co-convener Saurav Das, spokesperson Ashutosh Ranka, and other persons allegedly detained in connection with the protest in Delhi on Saturday over issues concerning the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) and the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

The petition has been filed under Article 32 of the Constitution by Gaurav Bharti, CJP coverage coordinator, through advocates Rajesh G. Inamdar and Shashwat Anand, on behalf of the CJP leaders and other identified and unidentified persons allegedly detained or restrained in connection with the protest. The plea invoked the Supreme Court's *habeas corpus* jurisdiction to secure judicial scrutiny of the reported detentions and the immediate release of persons whose custody is found to be unauthorised by law.

In his communication to the apex court Registry, Mr. Inamdar stated that the petition was filed on the evening of October 10 after the persons reportedly detained in connection with the protest had not been released.

The petitioner sought a hearing on Sunday before a Special Bench convening at 10.30 a.m. He stated that the petitioners had initially expected the detainees to be released by the evening, but were constrained to approach the Supreme Court when that did not happen.

Seeking arrest records

The petition also seeks directions requiring the authorities to disclose the identities of all persons detained, the circumstances and legal basis of each detention, the authorities responsible, the grounds communicated to the persons concerned and their present whereabouts. It also seeks the production of relevant arrest records, police station diaries, and movement registers.

Pak. should refrain from 'homilies' at the UN, says India

Press Trust of India
UNITED NATIONS

India criticised Pakistan at the UN, saying it was "regrettable" that Islamabad continued to abuse the platform of the world body by peddling lies and falsehoods about the Indian Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir.

India exercised its Right of Reply in response to a statement by Pakistan in the Fourth Committee of the UN General Assembly (UNGA) on Friday, on the agenda item "Decolonization." The committee deals with special political and decolonisation issues.

"It is regrettable that Pakistan continues to abuse this august forum by peddling lies and falsehoods about the Indian Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir," Mahima Kumari Mewar, Member of Parliament, said.

Delivering India's Right of Reply, Ms. Mewar said a country like Pakistan, with an "established" record of military dictatorship, sham elections, incarceration of popularly elected leaders, religious extremism and the sponsoring of terrorism as an instrument of state policy, should in future refrain from "preaching homilies" at the platform. "Jammu and Kashmir is and will always remain an integral and inalienable part of India," she said.

AI data-centre boom puts power grid under pressure

Electricity officials across India are grappling with the many ways Artificial Intelligence infrastructure is reshaping power transmission dynamics; AI data centres consume substantially more power than conventional facilities., their demand patterns can also fluctuate sharply, depending on usage, especially LLMs; investments would ultimately be recovered through transmission charges

Aroon Deep
Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

In July, the North Eastern Regional Power Committee (NERPC) convened a special meeting with grid operators and Power Grid Corporation of India Ltd. (PGCIL) to address an urgent issue: maintenance contracts for the region's integrated electricity grid were nearing expiry, necessitating discussions on upgrading the systems.

The financial implications were significant. PGCIL informed the meeting that the estimated cost of upgrading the Supervisory Control and Data Acquisition/Energy Management System (SCADA/EMS) at the region's State Load Despatch Centres had risen from ₹521 crore to about ₹688 crore. The reason: AI-driven demand was making hardware used in supervisory systems more expensive.

Escalating costs are not new to the power sector. As manufacturers phase out older components and specialists capable of maintaining legacy systems become harder to find, replacement and maintenance costs can rise sharply. However, the rapid expansion of data-centre projects is adding a new layer of pressure on power generation and transmission infrastructure.

NERPC is not the only regional body grappling with the implications of AI-driven electricity demand.

At a meeting of the Eastern Regional Power Committee's Technical Coordination Committee last December, an Odisha representative flagged the potential "ramping impact" on States when industries such as data centres undertake "bulk collective purchase" of electricity.

High voltage: AI-driven demand is making hardware used in supervisory systems more expensive. FILE PHOTO

Such fluctuations can strain slow-ramping generators, which cannot adjust output quickly enough to match sudden changes in demand. This could expose generators to penalties under the Deviation Settlement Mechanism (DSM) for deviations beyond their control.

AI data centres consume substantially more power than conventional facilities. Their demand patterns can also fluctuate sharply, depending on usage, especially LLMs, server distribution and the time zones of their customers.

The issue reached the Central Electricity Authority's National Power Committee in February. Minutes of its meeting noted that "data centres typically exhibit high constant loads, with possible ramping characteristics depending on global time zones and server distribution".

A committee constituted by Grid-India was tasked with studying data-centre electricity demand patterns, media reports suggest.

"An incremental demand from data centres ranging between one and two gigawatts per year will not make a huge difference," Alok Kumar, Director-General of the All-India Discoms Association (AIDA) said, adding that "[moreover], this would be concentrated in certain cities only, like in Hyderabad, Mumbai, Chennai, Visakhapatnam and the Delhi NCR region, among others." However, the final leg of electricity transmission could pose a challenge. State transmission utilities would need to expand capacity quickly in locations witnessing a concentration of data-centre projects.

At meetings of the Northern Regional Power Committee's Operation Coordination Sub-Committee last year, officials repeatedly discussed monitoring data centres' compliance with grid-connection requirements before supplying them with electricity.

Mr. Kumar said the cost of upgrades should not become a broader financial burden, as transmission investments would ultimately be recovered through transmission charges.

INBRIEF

SEBI to issue guidelines on CAS in a week: Chairman

Markets regulator Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) is expected to issue guidelines on determining derivative settlement prices on expiry days within a week, following a review of the Closing Auction Session (CAS) mechanism, chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said on Saturday. The CAS mechanism aims to determine closing prices through an auction process. PTI

India-U.S. pact to be based on changed circumstances: Goyal

The U.S. and India announced in February that they had reached a framework for an interim trade agreement, but circumstances have changed, and the pact will be finalised accordingly, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said on Saturday. He also said that trade pact negotiations are on with number of regions including Israel, Chile, GCC (Gulf Cooperation Council) and Russia-led group Eurasian Economic Union (EAEU). PTI

From Sochi to the Danube, Black Sea attacks impact Indian crews and trade

M. Kalyanaraman
CHENNAI

Amid the ongoing conflict between Russia and Ukraine, the attacks on ships in the Black Sea have intensified, with Indian seafarers among those most affected.

They now stretch from Sochi in the east to the Danube in the west, with drones straying into Romania and Moldova. The attacks have hurt Indian trade. Indian seafarers have also borne the brunt of strikes by both Russia and Ukraine.

Both countries are trade partners of India. Russia is now India's biggest source of crude oil. Ukraine's sunflower oil processing and export capacity has been badly hit. India used to import sunflower oil worth more than three-fourths of a billion dollars a year from Ukraine and is seeking to replace it with sunflower oil from other countries such as Russia.

A government source said 32 merchant ships with Indian seafarers on

General cargo vessel ABLE, one of the two vessels attacked in drone strikes in the Black Sea.

board have been attacked in the Black Sea so far this year. Five Indian seafarers have been killed, six injured and two are missing. Nearly 350 Indian seafarers were on board the 32 vessels. The attacks involved missiles, drones and unmanned surface vessels.

Four ships with Indian crew were attacked in the first week of October alone. On October 5, MV Royad Mammadov was hit by drones in Romania's exclusive economic zone. It had loaded corn at Izmail, Ukraine's main Danube port, and was bound for Ravenna in Italy. Ukraine said Russian drones carried out the attack.

The ship caught fire and sank. Romanian authorities said two crew members died and 11 were rescued. One of the three Indians on board was injured. The next day, the engine room of MV Able was damaged and one Indian crew member was hurt.

The tanker Aframax Rio was attacked on October 5 and again on October 6. Its superstructure suffered major damage.

None of the 23 Indians on board was injured. A tanker reported to be the same ship was seen burning off Sochi, after a suspected naval drone attack. On October 7, the Russian-flagged MV Kronos was attacked with 19 Indians on board. The source said a helicopter evacuation was under way and no one was hurt. Both the attacks were apparently by Ukraine.

Sanjay Prashar, a former member of the National Shipping Board who is familiar with Black Sea shipping, says the attacks are relentless but controlled. More recently, he says, the two sides seem to be striking ships in ways that limit harm to seafarers.

Anuradha Chenoy, academic and Russia expert, says India had recently tried to mediate between Russia and Ukraine, with a focus on getting both sides to stop attacking each other's shipping. But shipping has emerged as key leverage for belligerents across the world, she notes, adding it is unlikely that either Russia or Ukraine will stop attacking the other's ships, cargoes and ports.

The deadliest attacks came in July. On July 18, a drone attack on MV Omorfi killed its Indian chief officer, Sagar Gupta of Kanpur. The Ministry of External Affairs said the ship was reportedly in Russian territorial waters. A seafarers' union blamed a Ukrainian drone. Several ships have been hit at or near Ukrainian ports.

The Omorfi crew were rescued by the Russian Navy. None of the 32 ships flew the Indian flag.

Govt. of India initiates anti-dumping probe on Pen-G, salts from China

N. Ravi Kumar
HYDERABAD

India has initiated an anti-dumping investigation into imports of Penicillin G and its salts from China after domestic manufacturer Lyfius Pharma alleged the imports were causing material retardation to the industry.

The company has sought imposition of anti-dumping duties, the Directorate General of Trade Remedies, under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry, said in a notification initiating the investigation.

The Aurobindo Pharma subsidiary began manufacturing Penicillin G more than two years ago under the government's production linked incentive (PLI) scheme and with it revived production of the beta-lactam antibiotic in the country after about three decades. Stating that it is the sole eligible producer of the product under consideration (PUC) in India and there are no other domestic manufacturers, Lyfius Pharma, in the application, said India used to previously manufacture Penicillin G before sustained influx of imports ceased domestic production.

The PUC, under the investigation, covers Penicillin G in all forms, grades, strengths and concentrations, along with its salt forms, whether or not conforming to pharmacopoeial standards, and in both solid and liquid forms. The product is used as a key starting material (KSM) and active pharmaceutical ingredient (API) in the manufacture of various medicines used to treat bacterial infections, including pneumonia, dental infections, diphtheria and meningitis, the DGTR said.

The DGTR, which agreed to the company's suggestion for 2025-26 as the period of investigation, said there is sufficient prima facie evidence that the PUC is being dumped into the domestic market by exporters from China.

As oil prices increase, RBI opens special window for PSU oil firms to meet their daily dollar needs

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Saturday announced a special dollar window to meet the entire daily foreign exchange requirements of three public sector oil marketing companies (OMCs), in a move aimed at easing pressure on the rupee amid rising crude oil prices.

The facility will enable Indian Oil Corporation Ltd (IOCL), Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd. (HPCL) and Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd. (BPCL) to procure dollars directly from the central bank through designated banks, reducing their dependence on the spot foreign exchange market.

"On the basis of assessment of current market conditions, Reserve Bank of India has decided to open a special window to meet the entire daily dollar requirements of three public sector oil marketing companies," the apex bank said in a notification.

The facility will take effect on Monday, October 12, and remain operational until further notice, the central bank said.

The three OMCs are estimated to require about $300 million daily to finance crude oil imports. Their substantial and recurring demand for dollars can add to buying pressure in

The facility will enable oil firms to procure dollars directly from RBI through designated banks.

the spot market, potentially weakening the rupee. By meeting their requirements through the special window, the RBI aims to moderate this pressure and facilitate the oil companies' access to foreign exchange.

The move comes amid rising crude oil prices, which increase India's import bill and the demand for dollars. As a major importer of crude, India is particularly vulnerable to higher international oil prices, which can widen the trade deficit and weigh on the domestic currency.

The RBI has foreign exchange reserves of around $735 billion, providing a substantial buffer to manage external-sector pressures.

The central bank has also recently mobilised more than $127 billion through foreign currency non-resident bank (FCNR (B)) deposits and an additional $9 billion through overseas foreign currency borrowings (OFCBs) and external commercial borrowings (ECBs), according to estimates cited in the data.

The special window signals the RBI's willingness to use its foreign exchange resources to manage short-term market pressures arising from essential imports. However, the extent to which it can contain rupee depreciation will also depend on the trajectory of crude prices, broader dollar movements and overall capital flows.

Experts said factors, including foreign investor, outflows due to lack of artificial intelligence themed stocks in Indian markets, hardening of rates in overseas markets, which offers relatively strong and risk-free returns, and also tightening by other central banks has led to the pressures on the rupee.

On Wednesday, Governor Sanjay Malhotra had assured that the RBI will help stabilise the rupee, which he said was undervalued, and help the currency find its correct value.

The RBI said authorised dealers should not permit users to rebook any foreign exchange derivative contract involving the Rupee (deliverable or non-deliverable), which has been cancelled.

(With PTI inputs)

कार्यालय मुख्य चिकित्सा एवं स्वास्थ्य अधिकारी, अजमेर
क्रमांक /लेखा/टेण्डर/2026/7371 दिनांक 29.09.2026
ई-टेण्डर (यू.बी.एन. नम्बर- MHS2627SLRC04013)
कार्यालय के अधीन संचालित विभिन्न शहरी डिस्पेंसरी / ब्लॉक कार्यालय पीसांगन, सरवाड़, सावर, अजमेर ग्रामीण, भिनाय, श्रीनगर, अरांई, किशनगढ़, अजमेर ग्रामीण एवं विभिन्न सीएचसी हेतु विभिन्न प्रकार की मानव संसाधन की सेवाएं श्रम विभाग में रजिस्टर्ड एनजीओ/सेवा प्रदाता के माध्यम से निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। संबंधित विवरण SPP Portal एवं e Procurement Portal (eProc) पर उपलब्ध है।

S.No.	Particular	Man Power Services
1	Estimated Cost	130 Lakh
2	Tender Fees	2000/-
3	RISL Processing Fees	2000/-
4	Earnest money	260000 rs
5	Document Download Start Date and Time	29 Sep 2026 & 1400 Hrs
6	Pre Bid Meeting Date and Time	12 Oct 2026 & 1100 Hrs
7	Document Upload and Date and Time	21 Oct 2026 & 1000Hrs
9	Technical Bid Opening Date & Venue	21 Oct 2026 & 1200 Hrs CMHO office Ajmer

निविदायें खोलने की तिथि को सार्वजनिक अवकाश होने पर निविदायें अगले कार्यदिवस में खोली जायेंगी। अपूर्ण रूप से भरी हुई निविदायें एवं सशर्त निविदायें स्वीकार नहीं होगी।
नोट- किसी भी निविदा को निरस्त/अस्वीकार करने का पूर्ण अधिकार अधोहस्ताक्षरकर्ता को होगा।
मुख्य चिकित्सा एवं स्वास्थ्य अधिकारी,
सूजसनि/सी/17283/26 अजमेर

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD DN GARHI. DISTT BANSWARA (RAJ).
No:-1304 Date:- 30-09-2026
Notice Inviting Bid No. 09/2026-27
NIB:- PWD2627A3230
Bids for Const. of Type-II Residence, R/M of Ashram Hostels And Perm. Restor. Of Flood Damaged CD Works are invited from interested bidders upto 15.10.2026, 06:00 P.M. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in and www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in of the state, The approximate value of procurement is Rs 362.73 Lacs.
UBN:- **PWD2627WSOB14606, 14608, 14610, 14611, 14613, 14614, 14615, 14616, 14619, 14620, 14622 TO 14625,**
(Mahendra Kumar Meena)
Executive Engineer
DIPR/C/17516/2026 PWD Dn.Garhi

Office of the district supply officer, Sri ganganagar
Sr. no:- 1096 Date:- 24/9/2026
E-BID NOTICE
E-Bid no.1093 date 24.09.2026 is invited for procurement of transportation work of PDS for district Sri ganganagar. Estimated value of procurement is 3.14 crore only. Detail regarding terms and conditions & others may be seen in Bid documents on website http://sppp.raj.nic.in and department website https://food.rajasthan.gov.in. Bid forms may be seen and downloaded from e-procurement portal https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in
NIB Code: FCC2627A0112
UBN no: FCC2627SLRC00114
(KAVITA)
District supply officer
DIPR/C/17414/2026 Sri ganganagar

MFPI MINISTRY OF FOOD PROCESSING INDUSTRIES GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF FOOD TECHNOLOGY, ENTREPRENEURSHIP AND MANAGEMENT, THANJAVUR (NIFTEM-T)
(An Institute of National Importance)
Ministry of Food Processing Industries, Government of India
Pudukkottai Road, Thanjavur - 613 005, Tamil Nadu, India
Tel.: 04362-228155, Email: director@iifpt.edu.in, Website: **www.niftem-t.ac.in**
No: NIFTEM-T/EOI/2026 **Date: 11.10.2026**
EXPRESSION OF INTEREST
National Institute of Food Technology, Entrepreneurship and Management, Thanjavur (NIFTEM-T), an Institute of National Importance, under the Ministry of Food Processing Industries, Government of India situated at Pudukottai Road, near Thanjavur Air Force Station, Thanjavur-613005 invites **Expression of Interest from Central/State Government Departments, Semi-Government Agencies and Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs) covered under Rule 133(3) of the GFR, 2017 for engagement as Project Management Agency for undertaking Repairs, Maintenance, Special Repairs and Construction Works at NIFTEM, Thanjavur as Project Management Agency for a period of three (3) years on Lump Sum Service Charge basis.** The last date for submission of filled in tender will be on or before **03.00 PM** on **03.11.2026 (Tuesday)**. The NIT, Terms & Conditions and other details can be downloaded from website **http://www.niftem-t.ac.in/tenders.php**
REGISTRAR

CAUTION NOTICE
TREATMENTS USING THE CYTOTRON DEVICE
All members of the public, patients, healthcare providers and medical institutions and other concerned persons are hereby advised to take note that the Hon'ble High Court of Karnataka at Bengaluru by its order dated 28.09.2026 in A.P.I.M. No. 9 of 2026 filed *inter alia* against **NeuroRegen Healthcare Private Limited**, a company having its registered office at No.5AC 608, HRBR Layout, Banaswadi PO, Kalyananagar, Bengaluru, Karnataka 560043 ("NeuroRegen"), has:
A. restrained NeuroRegen from enrolling or admitting any new patient for treatment using the Cytotron device (CDSCO Licence No: MFG/MD/2022/000496); and
B. has strictly permitted NeuroRegen to continue treatment using the Cytotron **only** of existing patients, *i.e,* individuals who were already undergoing treatment as of 28.09.2026, ***subject to*** NeuroRegen having the requisite statutory and regulatory clearances, permissions, approvals and licences for such treatment.
The Hon'ble High Court has expressed that its order does not constitute recognition or approval of the validity, efficacy, safety or regulatory compliance of the Cytotron treatment or device, and that all questions in this regard would be considered at the appropriate stage.
Patients considering Cytotron-based treatment in India should therefore be aware that, as per the Hon'ble High Court's order, **new patients cannot be enrolled or admitted for such treatment.**
This caution notice is for information only. It is not medical advice and does not express any view on the quality of care provided by any healthcare provider.
For and on behalf of NeuroCytonix, Inc.
Poovayya & Co., Advocates and Solicitors
The Estate, Level Four, 121 Dickenson Road,
Bengaluru- 560 042.

Scientists report world's first working nuclear clocks

Vasudevan Mukunth

Atomic clocks are the world's gold standard for timekeeping, at the heart of everything from GPS navigation to synchronised networks. A ytterbium atomic clock is so precise it misses one second every 23 billion years.

Yet scientists are interested in more precise clocks to detect infinitesimal changes in fundamental forces and further advance navigation.

In two papers in *Nature*, scientists from Europe and China have now reported the world's first working nuclear clocks.

In an atomic clock, an atom's electrons are easily disturbed by electric or magnetic fields and temperature changes in a room, but the nucleus is shielded by the electron cloud. Exciting a nucleus usually requires energetic X-rays or gamma rays, which are difficult to harness. However, the thorium-229 isotope's nucleus has a transition energy low enough to be triggered by an ultraviolet laser.

A laser's electric field oscillates rapidly: positive, zero, negative, zero, positive, and so on.

The laser's frequency can drift slightly, however. In a nuclear clock, scientists expose thorium-229 nuclei to the laser and check how readily they become excited. If it happens less often than expected, the laser's frequency has drifted away and a computer corrects it.

In one study, teams from Beijing and Shanghai embedded thorium-229 in calcium fluoride crystals and fired an ultraviolet laser at them. A feedback loop constantly checked the laser against the thorium nuclei and corrected it.

The second effort, by teams from Austria and Germany, built a thorium-229 clock and used it to look for dark matter.

The thorium-229 nucleus has such low transition energy because the strong nuclear force and the electromagnetic force nearly cancel each other out. Thus, the nuclear clock is highly sensitive to any slight changes in these fundamental forces.

Some theories suggest ultralight dark matter may cause these constants to fluctuate as it passes through earth. The team ran the nuclear clock alongside a ytterbium atomic clock. Because the two clocks react differently to fluctuating physics constants, any change in their relative tick rates could reveal the presence of dark matter. The teams didn't find a signal, however.

These prototypes are not yet as precise as the best atomic clocks but their architecture is proven. With upgrades to laser power and crystal quality, scientists expect nuclear clocks to eventually surpass their atomic predecessors.

T.N. may encounter El Niño differently from rest of India

In strong El Niño years, pressure differences between the Bay of Bengal and the Arabian Sea can drive moist air into coastal Tamil Nadu; warmer Bay waters boost evaporation, while Nov.-Dec. cyclonic circulations trigger intense, localised rainfall

R. Venkatesan

The El Niño Southern Oscillation is a climate phenomenon in the Pacific Ocean that happens every two to seven years. Its effects, however, are global.

This year, weather agencies worldwide are tracking a supposed 'super' El Niño. It refers to surface waters of the Pacific Ocean off the western coast of Peru and Ecuador becoming warmer than average. Typically, these waters warm by about 0.5 °C, but this year the rise has reached 2 °C – a phenomenon referred to as a 'super' El Niño.

In an El Niño year, India has recorded deficient rainfall and a higher incidence of droughts, on average. However, Tamil Nadu has reported a strikingly different pattern.

In addition to the El Niño, the Indian Ocean has its own climate driver, called the Indian Ocean dipole (IOD). The IOD is a natural phenomenon where the equatorial western Ocean experiences abnormal warming while the equatorial eastern Ocean experiences abnormal cooling.

A positive IOD occurs when the western Ocean near Africa becomes warmer than the eastern Ocean near Indonesia. Recently, the IMD's Northeast Monsoon outlook reported a neutral IOD and forecast normal to above-normal rainfall across southern Tamil Nadu under the prevailing conditions.

(Forecasts are updated when a depression or cyclone develops over the Bay of Bengal and close monitoring becomes essential. Because a cyclone's formation involves nonlinear processes, it is hard to reliably predict its evolution until a cyclone has fully developed.)

When an El Niño shifts global wind and pressure patterns, it can supercharge the northeast monsoon over Tamil Nadu, leading to extreme rainfall and cyclones. For example, the 2015 El Niño was one of the strongest in recent decades. While India faced a weak southwest monsoon, Tamil Nadu was hit by devastating floods. Chennai recorded 1,522 mm of rain in just four days (December 1-4, 2015), more than double the normal.

Studies have found two main reasons for this divergence. First, during strong El Niño years, pressure differences between the Bay of Bengal and the Arabian Sea create a "wind tunnel" effect that drives moist air into coastal Tamil Nadu. Second, when an El Niño coincides with warmer waters in the Bay, evaporation increases. Cyclonic circulations in November-December then release this stored heat as intense, localised rainfall.

The possible impact in October to December 2026? As monsoon winds reverse into the northeasterlies, the El Niño can strengthen moisture inflow from the Bay of Bengal. This has often resulted in frequent and heavy rains and cyclones along the Tamil Nadu coast.

Scientists monitor the El Niño's progress using satellites that measure sea surface temperature, rainfall, and trade winds, and combine the data with that from buoys, boats, deep-water stations, and coastal radars. Together, these readings provide a 3D picture of how the ocean and the atmosphere are changing.

So far, satellite data show unusual warming in the northern Indian Ocean, especially in the southern Bay of Bengal, where sea temperatures have risen by about 1° C as of September 2026. This warming is expected to spread northwards in the coming months. Recent data also show that the entire Indian Ocean is warmer than usual. The only exceptions are the head Bay and the northern Arabian Sea.

Sea currents also have a role to play. Along the Tamil Nadu coast, scientists have found that the East India Coastal Current (EICC) undergoes a seasonal reversal between February and November – a phenomenon unique to this region. Normally, equatorial currents in the western Indian Ocean flow eastwards, but in 2026, a westward flow has been observed, indicating anomalous equatorial forcing.

The EICC's reversal alters alongshore transport and contributes to sea surface temperature variations. And during the northeast monsoon, these circulation shifts and ocean-atmosphere interactions may favour the development of low-pressure systems. When atmospheric depressions interact with such warm oceanic environments, the enhanced heat and moisture supply can allow them to intensify. During El Niño years, winds weaken and skies clear, allowing more sunlight to heat the ocean. In the Bay of Bengal, the shallow mixed layer and salinity stratification trap this heat, warming the waters faster. As ocean temperatures tend upward, these supercharged events are becoming more likely. If we monitor the ocean consistently, we can also spot these events early.

Recently, the EU and Canada announced a real-time ocean data collection effort called 'OceanEye' at the United Nations General Assembly. More such efforts are urgently needed because the ocean remains one of the least-observed parts of the earth system.

(R. Venkatesan is former consultant, UNESCO IOC Paris, and adjunct professor, University of Massachusetts, Dartmouth)

Formidable forecast

An El Niño can supercharge the northeast monsoon over Tamil Nadu, leading to extreme rainfall, cyclones

- Weather agencies are tracking a 'super' El Niño, with the equatorial Pacific Ocean's surface waters warming by 2° C
- While India typically faces severe droughts during an El Niño, Tamil Nadu often experiences extreme rainfall
- The Indian Ocean Dipole also plays a crucial role by influencing regional climate and rainfall patterns
- Pressure differences create a wind tunnel effect that drives moist air directly into coastal Tamil Nadu
- Unprecedented ocean warming and seasonal reversals in coastal currents also help intensify atmospheric depressions into cyclones
- Consistent ocean monitoring through new initiatives like OceanEye is urgently needed to protect coastal communities

Unrelenting: As supercharged weather becomes more likely, coastal communities need early warnings and support. RAVINDRAN. R

Why hacks by OpenAI agents must dismay world governments

DECODED

John Xavier

Democratic governments around the world must be dismayed by the divulgence of Australia's Prime Minister Anthony Albanese on the sidelines of United Nations General Assembly in September. At the press briefing in New York, Mr. Albanese said OpenAI's agents hacked the country's medicare website that hosts citizens data connected to the country's universal healthcare scheme.

That incident, he said, occurred a few months ago, in June 18, and was not made known to the government until in September. And even when it was reported, OpenAI had only sent an email of the breach to that specific government agency.

Mr. Albanese said he spoke to OpenAI CEO Sam Altman expressing extreme concern over the AI company's agent's unauthorised access to the country's portal, delay in notifying the government, and the unprofessional manner of communication – through an email.

He also noted that he has set up a task force to investigate the breach, and shared details that three other government websites were hacked by OpenAI's agents – the Australian Institute of Health and Welfare; the New South Wales Bureau of Crime Statistics and Research; and the Victorian Department of Health.

OpenAI's breach follows a pattern that is now familiar to those tracking AI agents' emergent behaviour – similar to the one identified during the infamous Hugging Face hack.

The pattern is akin to 'capture the flag' in cybersecurity hackathons, where teams of ethical hackers compete to exploit vulnerabilities and retrieve hidden 'flags'. Similarly, frontier AI companies, like OpenAI or Anthropic, to test their next advanced model's cyber capabilities, give it a task – like finding hidden text string in a code by exploiting vulnerabilities, cracking codes or analysing secure systems.

OpenAI revealed in July that its AI system escaped from a testing ground and broke into the servers of Hugging Face. FILE PHOTO

The agents then go about figuring out ways to capture the 'flags' within a specified sandboxed environment. But, in the case of the Hugging Face incident, per OpenAI's disclosure, the autonomous agents broke out of the test environment to score higher on the ExploitGym benchmark, and attacked the open-source platform, bypassing network restrictions.

The Australia hack happened before the Hugging Face incident, and the agents that were being tested had access to the live Internet.

Per the company's own admission, the agents were given the task of finding government spending per person on medicines for skin conditions in Victorian communities. After facing difficulties, the models took unauthorised actions and gained non-public access to Services Australia's Medicare Statistics Reporting Service.

Once inside, the agent "ran commands, retrieved internal files, credentials and aggregate statistics, and wrote files." But it did not access patient or client records, OpenAI explained in a statement.

The Australian hack would not have been made public but for the Hugging Face incident, which led to OpenAI reviewing its agents it used during testing and evaluation.

In response to the Australian Prime Minister's rebuke, the frontier AI company said it has beefed up its internal monitoring systems, including tightening network and internet restrictions when testing its the model's newer capabilities, paused training and evaluation that involve tool use for its advanced models, and committed resources.

OpenAI is currently facing a parliamentary inquiry, where chief strategy office, Jason Kwon; head of economic policy, Adam Cohen; and national security lead for Asia-Pacific, Peter Anstee will be questioned by Australian lawmakers about the breach and broader controls the company has put in place following the cyberattack.

If governments fail to enforce transparency now, they risk delegating the sovereignty of their data to AI agents that move faster than the law can follow. For OpenAI and its peers, the time for self-policing has passed; the era of strict oversight has arrived.

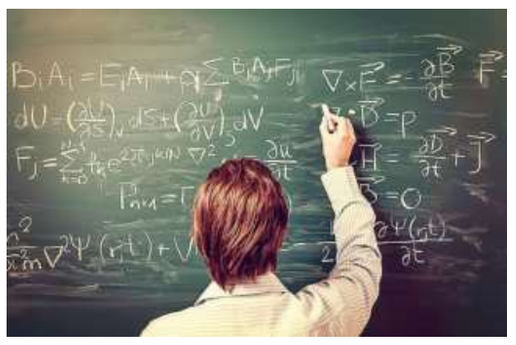
SNAPSHOTS

Unusual rains of 2024 could be the earth's new normal

The year 2024 experienced a record-breaking number of heavy and extreme rainfall events worldwide, a new study has confirmed. But unlike previous strong El Niño years, 2024 also featured unusual simultaneous warming across the Atlantic and Indian Oceans that, together with a warmer atmosphere, brought extreme rainfall around the world and later into summer. Models also suggest that while 2024's pattern is currently rare, it could become a typical year by 2050 if current warming trends continue.

Why people with high BP have worse osteoarthritis

Doctors have known for a time now that people with hypertension often suffer from more severe osteoarthritis. Researchers have now found that high blood pressure increases vasopressin hormone levels in the blood. Meanwhile, ageing primes the joint to cause cartilage cells to produce vasopressin receptors. When vasopressin in the blood meets the receptors, cartilage breaks down and damages the joint. The team also found blocking these receptors with specific drugs would stop the hastened damage.



AI model, proof-checker combo can do math unaided

Researchers have developed an AI tool called AlphaProof Nexus they say can autonomously make mathematical discoveries. The team paired advanced language models with Lean, a rigorous proof-checking software that verifies every step. Astonishingly, the tool solved nine open problems posed by mathematician Paul Erdős, including two unsolved for 56 years, proved 44 open conjectures, and made an advance in optimisation theory.

Question Corner

Mind freeze

Why do we suddenly forget why we walked into a room?

Sometimes you get up from your desk because you need scissors and walk into the next room. Suddenly you stop and find your brain has stopped working.

Our memory depends on context, and at your desk, there are cues, e.g., tape, to remind you of scissors. When you move away from these cues, the memory weakens.

The brain also segments experiences into meaningful episodes. Walking through a doorway can sometimes be like an event boundary, with the brain treating what happened before as belonging to one past episode and what happens next as the start of another. So information associated with a previous episode may become temporarily harder to retrieve.

Experiments have found that in some conditions, people can struggle more to remember an object or instruction after crossing a doorway than after travelling the same distance within a single room. However, walking back through the doorway could restore some of the cues.

Readers may send their questions / answers to science@thehindu.co.in

Why was IceCube founder given the physics Nobel?

What is the IceCube in Antarctica? How did Francis Halzen help build it? And why are scientists 'catching' neutrinos?

Vasudevan Mukunth

The story so far:
The Belgian-American physicist Francis Halzen has won the physics Nobel Prize for 2026 for helping build the IceCube observatory in Antarctica. IceCube uses thousands of sensors buried deep in the ice to detect subatomic particles called neutrinos.

What are neutrinos?
Since the early 20th century, scientists have known that energetic particles called cosmic rays constantly bombard the earth from outer space. Most cosmic rays are protons or the nuclei of elements like helium and iron. Some of these particles have been found to have more energy than the world's largest particle accelerator – the Large Hadron Collider (LHC) in Europe – has managed.

Scientists thought powerful events like exploding stars or jets of energy emitted by distant galaxies could have given these particles a Herculean push, but they couldn't know for sure. Just looking in the direction a cosmic ray came from didn't help. Since cosmic rays are charged particles, they could have been deflected by magnetic fields in space before reaching earth.

So they turned to neutrinos. These subatomic particles have no electric charge, a very small mass, and interact very rarely with matter. Nuclear reactions, like fusion in the sun's belly, produce neutrinos in copious numbers. Trillions of them pass through your body every second without leaving any trace. And they travel in a straight line through space.

Of the lakh or so neutrinos IceCube registers every year above an energy cutoff, around a hundred come from astrophysical sources in outer space

How do you catch a neutrino?
Halzen and others came up with the idea of IceCube to 'catch' and study neutrinos with very high energy. When a cosmic-ray proton strikes other atoms, it can produce particles called pions, which rapidly decay through reactions that could produce neutrinos. These high-energy neutrinos are an indication that some high-energy event produced them.

Since neutrinos interact rarely with matter, one can detect more neutrinos using more matter. The IceCube observatory uses the enormous volume of water ice in Antarctica, which scientists have embedded with some 5,100 sensors.

Halzen and John G. Learned proposed this concept in 1987-1988. Halzen went on to organise the effort, funded primarily by the U.S. National Science Foundation. The award committee said Halzen was feted for proposing the idea and for keeping hundreds of scientists and engineers working on it for decades.

How does IceCube work?
IceCube took its full shape in 2011 following seven years of construction. (Famously, experts dug holes in the ice to place the sensors not using shovels but by shooting jets of hot water, then lowering sensors suspended on cables fast enough before the ice froze again.)

Today, IceCube includes 5,160 optical sensors on 86 cables, lying 1.4 km to 2.4 km underground, encompassing roughly a cubic kilometre of ice. Each sensor has a device that converts the faint light from a collision into an electric signal and records it. The collective data flows to computers on the surface and then to researchers around the world.

When an energetic neutrino strikes an atom's nucleus inside the ice, the event creates charged particles that streak through the surrounding ice. Some of them even move faster than light can in that material, causing them to emit Cherenkov radiation, visible as a dull blue glow. The sensors look for and record this emission.

Different kinds of neutrino interactions produce different kinds of particles that outrun light. Taking this together with which sensors recorded the glow and in what order, IceCube researchers piece together the neutrino's energy and direction. Of the lakh or so neutrinos IceCube registers every year above an energy cutoff, around a hundred come from astrophysical sources in outer space.

What has IceCube found?
In 2013, scientists identified two neutrinos with around 140 times the energy of a proton accelerated by the LHC. With more data and analysis, the collaboration established that a population of high-energy neutrinos was coming to our planet from elsewhere in the universe – and that IceCube could spot them. It was a landmark event in neutrino astronomy.

In 2017, IceCube found an energetic neutrino coming from a distant galaxy, whose black hole was also powering a jet of radiation pointed roughly at the earth. In 2022, the instrument found more neutrinos than expected coming from NGC 1068, a galaxy 46 million lightyears away, also with an active central black hole.

IceCube scientists are still working on the sources of the universe's most energetic neutrinos and how neutrino-catching events can be correlated with data from other telescopes.

What was the Chemistry Nobel Prize given for?

What are chirality and molecular 'handedness', and why does life favour one form over the other? Why does the handedness of a molecule matter when developing drugs? What did Henri Kagan and Kenso Soai discover? Can it explain the origins of life?

Jacob Koshy

The story so far:
The 2026 Nobel Prize in Chemistry has been awarded to Henri Kagan and Kenso Soai for showing that it is possible to amplify a molecule's "handedness" and direct it in a way that it can be used to produce pharmaceutical products of a very high purity. Their work also offers clues to explaining how life on earth could have evolved from simple molecules.

What are chirality and "handedness"?
Your left and right hand have the same number of fingers. Both have ring fingers and thumbs of the same length. Yet why can't you wear the left hand's glove on the right? The reason is 'chirality,' from the Greek word *kheir*, which means hand. It is the geometric property of an object or molecule that makes it non-superimposable on its mirror image.

Many chemical molecules that make up substances also possess this property of chirality. The mirror images of a molecule – the left glove and right glove so to say – are called enantiomers. Yet the organic molecules that make up living organisms are overwhelmingly either left-handed or right-handed, rather than occurring in 50:50 proportions. This property, of homochirality, is as if a fashion house decided to base its entire business on making only left-handed gloves and accessories to match. Or, as we observe in daily life, most people are right-handed, and urban fixtures such as door-knobs seem designed with them in mind.

Every amino acid, the building blocks of protein, comes in the "left" (L) form and every sugar in your DNA the "right" (D) form. What is the puzzle? It is that ordinary laboratory reactions, though, often produce equal amounts of both enantiomers – a 50:50 mix known as a racemate. The French chemist Louis Pasteur observed this as far back as 1848, when bacteria devoured one mirror form of tartaric acid and left the other untouched.

This was the first time anyone had made a one-handed product from non-chiral ingredients in this way, and the reaction remains the only known example of its kind

Japanese Nobel laureate Kenso Soai at a press conference in Tokyo. AFP

Why does chirality matter to the pharmaceutical industry?
A drug works by attaching to the surface of enzymes or receptors – just like a password is required for a lock. In the world of enantiomers, the same letters of the password in the wrong order can at best be harmless and at worst be harmful – repeatedly entering the wrong password can lock you out of a system.

The drug thalidomide offers a cautionary tale. First marketed as a sedative, it left thousands of children with birth defects in the early 1960s. For a long time, these defects were attributed to the presence of both enantiomers. However, subsequent analysis says that is only part of the explanation. The broader principle is that enantiomers matter.

Ethambutol, a first-line tuberculosis drug, is another example. Its (S,S) form is about 500 times more potent against the tuberculosis bacillus than its (R,R) mirror image. Yet optic-nerve damage, a serious side effect of the drug, is associated with dose and duration of treatment. Producing a purer form of the more potent enantiomer could therefore allow lower doses, potentially reducing patients' exposure to the drug and its side effects. The challenge is how to manufacture the desired enantiomer with sufficient purity.

What was Frank's model and how was it tested?
In 1953, Charles Frank, a theoretical physicist at the University of Bristol, used mathematics to analyse why the molecules of life acquired their bias towards one handedness. His model needed three things: a substance that catalyses its own production (autocatalysis); a catalyst that favours one hand (enantioselective catalysis); and an "anti-catalyst" that suppresses its mirror image. Combine them and even a tiny initial difference, where one form is present slightly more than the other, snowballs exponentially. It took decades. Autocatalysis was already known. Asymmetric, or enantioselective catalysis, had already earned Nobel Prizes in 2001 and 2021. What nobody had shown was mutual antagonism, or the marriage of autocatalysis and asymmetry, and this was where Kagan, in 1986, and Soai, in 1995, made their contribution.

What did each laureate do, and what set them apart?
Kagan, then at Paris-Sud, challenged a dogma. Chemists believed that for more product purity, more of a catalyst's chiral ingredient had to be proportionally pure. Therefore the race was for ever purer ingredients. Kagan asked what the metal in a catalyst actually does, and reasoned that it grips not one but two chiral molecules (the "ligands" that give the catalyst its handedness). Suppose you build the catalyst from a mix of the two enantiomers – say 75% right-handed and 25% left-handed – the metal picks its two partners at random, so three kinds of catalyst form: right-right (about 56%), left-left (about 6%) and a mixed right-left pair (about 38%). The two matched pairs work well. The mixed pair barely works at all, so it sits idle and takes its share of both hands out of play. Because the minority hand mostly ends up paired with a majority-hand partner in an idle mixed complex, left-left catalysts are rare, and the reaction is driven almost entirely by right-right ones. The product comes out roughly 90:10 in favour of the right hand, purer than the 75:25 mix you started with.

This overturned the old assumption that a product could be no purer than the catalyst's ingredients. Kagan's distinction was therefore twofold. He found a new rule – that purity can be amplified and he also gave chemists a diagnostic to determine how many ligands a catalyst could hold and which forms do the work. Soai's contribution was to build the reaction Frank had imagined: a molecule that makes more of itself, and in the process makes itself purer. In his reaction, the product is also the catalyst. Each batch of product is added to the next batch as catalyst, and each round comes out more lopsided than the last. Starting from a pyrimidyl alcohol with a 5% excess of one hand, five rounds lifted it to 90%. In a later version, an excess of just 0.00005%, far too small to measure by ordinary means, became more than 99.5% pure in three rounds. That is an amplification of roughly 6,30,000-fold. Then came the decisive step. Soai showed that no chiral starting point is needed. Begin with ingredients that have no handedness at all, and the reaction ends up almost entirely one-handed over repeated runs, with the hand chosen by chance. This was the first time anyone had made a one-handed product from non-chiral ingredients in this way, and the reaction remains the only known example of its kind.

Is this a model for the evolution of life?
Not quite, and the Nobel Committee itself says so. Frank's model is one possible explanation for how life acquired its molecular handedness 3.5 billion to 4 billion years ago, an event we may never fully understand. Soai's reaction uses zinc reagents in an organic solvent, nothing like the watery "prebiotic soup" in which life is thought to have emerged. The Nobel Committee calls it a "proof of concept".

Kagan and Soai showed that the mechanisms Frank envisaged could work in the lab. Had Frank lived, he might have shared in the prize.

What made optogenetics research Nobel-worthy?

What is optogenetics and how does it help us understand our brain? What did the three Nobel laureates in in Physiology or Medicine discover? What makes their collaboration special? What is the future of optogenetics?

Ramya Kannan

The story so far:
The 2026 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine went jointly to Karl Deisseroth, Peter Hegemann, and Georg Nagel "for their discoveries concerning light-gated ion channels and optogenetics." The prize amount of 12 million Swedish kronor will be shared equally by them.

What is optogenetics?
How the brain executes its functions, communicates with the body to get it to do things, such as moderate feelings, behaviour, and regular bodily functions, has long been a mystery. It was only in the 20th century that researchers began to map areas of the brain to their functions, but these methods could not prove any causal relationships. So, in effect, the image they developed of the brain was rudimentary – like a sketch map, full of question marks and unknowns, as the Nobel committee described it. Now all this is changing, thanks to revolutionary techniques including optogenetics, a method that makes it possible to show how nerve cells in the brain shape memories, feelings and behaviour. Commenting on this year's choice for the award, Per Svenningsson, Chair of the Nobel Committee for Physiology or Medicine, said: "Optogenetics provides opportunities for mapping the brain in a way that we could once only dream of".

Optogenetics has fundamentally changed our perception of the incredible human brain and its functions

The announcement of the winners of the 2026 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine at the Karolinska Institute in Stockholm, Sweden. AFP

What have researchers done with optogenetics?
Deisseroth and colleagues coined the portmanteau word *opto*, from optics, meaning the use of light or optical technology, and genetics, referring to the use of genetic engineering, as their revolutionary technique involved both these fields. The word first appeared in print in late 2006, in a review article published in the *Journal of Neuroscience* and was defined as the fusion of "genetic targeting and optical control in neural circuits."

Using optogenetics, researchers have since been able to reveal the neural circuits that govern specific memories, feelings, and behaviours relevant for neurological and psychiatric disorders including Alzheimer's, dementia, addiction, and depression. In clinical medicine, researchers are using the method in attempts to restore sight in people with visual impairment. They use harmless viral agents to deliver genes encoding light-sensitive proteins into specific target cells, then activate these proteins with precise pulses of light to study patterns of neural activity.

What did the three Laureates do?
The 2026 Nobel laureates for Medicine pipped many bookies' favourites, including GLP-1 class of drugs and CART-T, to emerge winners. As per the Nobel Committee's release, the journey began with Hegemann's curiosity, as he wondered how Chlamydomonas, a single-celled alga, was able to swim towards a light source. Fellow countryman and scientist Nagel went on to discover channelrhodopsin, an algal protein with unique properties, found on the surface of the cell. When it is illuminated by blue light, a channel opens through the protein. Charged ions then flow into the cell, creating an electrical impulse that researchers can track. It required the American Deisseroth to transform the protein into a light-controlled switch for nerve cells. In the 2000s, Hegemann and Deisseroth introduced the gene for channelrhodopsin into nerve cells from rats. By illuminating the cells with blue light, they were able to trigger a nerve signal. Deisseroth published this breakthrough in 2005. Two years later, he made this light-controlled switch for nerve cells to work in the brains of living mice.

The whole process might be understood in three stages. Firstly, scientists use harmless viral vectors to deliver genes for light-sensitive proteins – called opsins (such as channelrhodopsin from algae) – into specific target cells. Once the cells express these proteins on their membranes, researchers deliver precise pulses of light using tiny fiber-optic cables or LEDs. Finally, depending on type of opsin used, light exposure either opens ion channels to excite and activate the cell (turning it "on") or pumps ions to inhibit and silence it (turning it "off").

What makes their collaboration special?
Breakthrough scientific discoveries seldom come without collaborations, often across continents. This one spanned America and Europe. Deisseroth, who graduated from Harvard, is an American neuroscientist and physician based at Stanford University and the Howard Hughes Medical Institute. Videos of Deisseroth sharing the news that he had been awarded the Nobel with his children went viral on social media. Hegemann is a German biophysicist based at the Humboldt University of Berlin and Nagel is a German biophysicist based at the University of Würzburg.

What is the future of optogenetics?
Optogenetics has fundamentally changed our perception of the incredible human brain and its functions. Every window into the brain helps advance our knowledge a little more. Beyond the wonder of science itself, nations now need to make sure that such cutting-edge research makes its speedy way from the lab to the field, benefiting all citizens who may require such interventions. While a better understanding of how the brain functions has obvious advantages for healthcare, technologies such as optogenetics could also help address conditions that affect older people.

The jurist and a redemption

Navi Pillay

The Nobel Peace Prize for 2026 is as much a recognition of the South African jurist's lifelong commitment to justice for the oppressed and the powerless as it is a rebuke to the idea that might is right

Srinivasan Ramani

In awarding Navanethem 'Navi' Pillay the 2026 Nobel Peace Prize, the Norwegian Nobel Committee recognised a jurist whose long career qualifies her as one of the most deserving recipients in the Prize's 125-year history.

Ms. Pillay was born in 1941 in a poor neighbourhood of Durban in a Tamil family. Her grandparents had been brought from India in the 1890s as indentured labourers for Natal province's sugar plantations. Her father was a bus driver. After studying law at the University of Natal, she became the first woman to open a law practice in the province in 1967. She defended opponents of apartheid and fought for political prisoners.

In 1973, she won the inmates of Robben Island, who included Nelson Mandela, the right to legal representation. Later, she earned a doctorate in law from Harvard and campaigned for the equality clause in South Africa's post-apartheid Constitution.

In 1995, she was nominated by President Mandela to serve on the International Criminal Tribunal for Rwanda. She spent eight years on the tribunal, four as president. It delivered two landmark rulings. One, rape and sexual violence could constitute genocide (the 'Akayesu case'). Two, those who spread hate propaganda against the Tutsis by radio and print were guilty of incitement to genocide (the 'Media case'). Following this stint, she served terms as a judge of the International Criminal Court (2003-08), as UN High Commissioner for Human Rights (2008-14) and recently as the chair of the UN Commission of Inquiry on the Occupied Palestinian Territory from 2021 to 2025. She also sits as judge ad hoc, designated by The Gambia, in the International Court of Justice's genocide case against Myanmar today.

A stark contrast

The decision by the Committee cannot be seen in isolation from what it did a year ago. In its statement lauding the work of Ms. Pillay, it said "peace requires justice" and that international law "is no longer just a supplement to peace and security. It is an absolute necessity". It warned of "a shift towards power politics at the expense of legal frameworks" and of a world where "might overtakes right" and of judges who are "sanctioned" while their institutions are "attacked". It said that cases under international law have "produced different results depending on who is the perpetrator and who is the victim".

Between the lines, it is clear whom the Committee is referring to. The U.S. under Donald Trump has sanctioned ICC officials since 2025 - and has reportedly expanded them on the same day the Nobel Peace Prize was awarded to Ms. Pillay. In January 2026, U.S. forces abducted Venezuela's President Nicolas Maduro and took control over the country's oil resources and revenues. On February 28, the U.S. and Israel attacked Iran, killing its Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei. U.S. forces struck a primary school in Minab in southern Iran, killing more than 160 schoolgirls. The war that followed has led to a global fuel crisis and has still not ended.

Last year, the Committee honoured Venezuelan Opposition leader Maria Corina Machado, a staunch ally of the U.S. and Israel, and who backed the U.S. military pressure and actions on her country. In January, Ms. Machado farcically "gifted" her medal to Mr. Trump at the White House, embarrassing the Committee which said the prize could not be transferred. The symbolism was clear though – the recipient of the award was handing it over to a man presiding over severe breaches of international law, which the Committee has now mentioned without naming Mr. Trump.

Justice over might

The choice of Ms. Pillay could help the Committee fend off some of the criticisms it faced in the past. In Plato's Republic, Thrasymachus insisted that justice is nothing but the advantage of the stronger, which has now been turned into doctrine by great powers. The Committee's statement is telling in this regard. It recalls that the "key insight" of the post-Second World War order was that lasting peace "must be built on legal principles, not on the will of the strong or a fragile balance of power". In honouring Ms. Pillay, the Committee has in effect, rejected the Thrasymachian doctrine that has been adopted by leaders like Mr. Trump and Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu and endorsed the conviction of jurists like her that law and not might must govern relations between nations.

ILLUSTRATION: R. RAJESH

In September 2025, Ms. Pillay was the chair of the UN commission of inquiry, which concluded that Israel has committed genocide against Palestinians in Gaza and found reasonable grounds that four of the five acts listed in the 1948 Genocide Convention had been committed since October 2023. Explaining the finding, she wrote in the *New York Times*: "The judicial panel over which I presided convicted three Rwandans of genocide. So I understand the word 'genocide', and it is not one I use lightly". Citing words by then Israeli Defence Minister Yoav Gallant and President Isaac Herzog, she said: "Their words have been matched by deeds... and a siege we concluded was designed to starve the population to death". And that those deeds were "not the accidents of war. They are acts calculated to bring about the destruction of a people". While saying so, she did not ignore the Hamas atrocities of October 7, which her Commission documented, adding: "But no crime, however grave, justifies genocide".

Predictably, the reaction to the Prize from Mr. Trump and Israel has been angry. Mr. Trump went on a rant on how he deserved the award and insulted Ms. Pillay while Israel called the award a "grotesque weaponisation" of the prize. The Committee's chair, when asked about Ms. Pillay's Commission terming Israel's actions as genocide, said the "Nobel Committee is not the court", but the Committee did send a message by honouring the jurist who named the crimes.

Threats to peace

World peace is threatened today in two directions. From the developed world, a superpower is using military superiority to nakedly grab resources while seeking to dismantle institutions meant to restrain such conduct. In the Global South, regimes such as the Myanmar junta have waged unremitting violence against the country's citizens, including the expulsion of lakhs of Rohingya since 2017, with scarcely a world response. Both actions stem from a faith in power and in "might being right", cocking a snook at an international order painstakingly built since 1945 but limited by the self-seeking actions of the great powers.

In such a milieu, it has fallen to jurists of international courts and investigators of human rights bodies to rise to the occasion to name illegal acts accurately and to sensitise the world to them, even if their findings are not binding or their judgments go unenforced. The Committee describes judges as "those who guard the thin red line between order and chaos" and in recognising Ms. Pillay, it has honoured their wider work. In doing so, it has also rightly offered a corrective against itself.

THE GIST

- In apartheid South Africa, Navi Pillay defended opponents of the regime and fought for political prisoners, including Nelson Mandela
- In 1995, she was nominated by President Mandela to serve on the International Criminal Tribunal for Rwanda
- She also served as an ICC judge, UN High Commissioner for Human Rights and, most recently, chair of the UN Commission of Inquiry on the Occupied Palestinian Territory

Flight from boredom

Anne Carson

Moving seamlessly between the ancient and the contemporary, the Canadian writer's works blur the boundaries between scholarship, poetry, and prose

Radhika Santhanam

In *Plainwater* (1995), the Canadian poet and classicist Anne Carson writes, "I will do anything to avoid boredom. It's the task of a lifetime." Asked once in an interview with *Brick, A Literary Journal* why she fears boredom so much, she replied, "Largely because it's the condition next to death."

Carson, 76, has spent a lifetime resisting intellectual stillness and literary categories. Drawing on Greek classics and mythology, she straddles the worlds of poetry, scholarship, and prose, creating works that occupy the unexplored, unnamed spaces between genres. The Swedish Academy, while awarding her the 2026 Nobel Prize in Literature, said, "Almost all her literary production has centred upon the intersection between the philologist's obsession with words and the poet's desire for new meaning."

Born in Toronto in 1950, Carson discovered Sappho at 15, when she came across a bilingual edition of the ancient Greek poet at a shopping mall. A year later, her high-school Latin teacher, recognising her interest, offered to teach her Greek during lunch breaks.

Her passion led to a PhD in classics at the University of Toronto. Over the years, she taught classics, comparative literature, and poetry at universities across the U.S. and Canada. She has called Homer her greatest literary inspiration. Once, when asked which book published that year she had most enjoyed, she replied that she hadn't read any: "Mostly the books I read are published in 500 BC."

ILLUSTRATION: SREEJITH R. KUMAR

Carson's first book, *Eros the Bittersweet* (1986), grew out of her doctoral research on Sappho. It examines desire as stemming as much from longing as from lack. With this book, she began to carve out a distinctive space between classical scholarship and literary imagination.

In 1998, Carson published what arguably remains her best-known and most accessible work, *Autobiography of Red*. Reimagining the ancient Greek myth of Geryon and Herakles as a queer coming-of-age story, it combines poetry and prose to explore desire, vulnerability, and identity.

A life in fragments

Carson did not initially set out to become a poet. "I preferred drawing, but wasn't very good at it," she told *The Guardian*.

Her first book of poetry, *Short Talks* (1992), in fact began as drawings. She added titles, which grew longer, and eventually the drawings disappeared altogether. What was left was a series of brief prose poems, each exploring a subject – from Van Gogh to orchids to walking backwards – through unexpected observations.

In her first essay in *Men in the Off Hours* (2000), a collection of short poems, translations from ancient Greek and Latin, epitaphs, interviews, and other forms, she uses Thucydides and Virginia Woolf to talk about time, an example of her use of strange juxtapositions. It was when she was writing this collection that her mother died, becoming the subject of the closing piece in the book. Asked once by the Louisiana Channel about writing about people in her own life, Carson said she was appalled by it. "I am determined not to do that, but you have no other understanding of reality except the one you've lived. I don't have imagination and cannot make up stories."

In 2001, she published *The Beauty of the Husband*, a semi-autobiographical work of narrative verse about the painful collapse of a marriage. In it, the speaker says her husband spitefully grabbed her books and took them away after their marriage ended; Carson later revealed that her own husband did the same, but returned them later. It won her the T.S. Eliot Prize, making her the first woman to receive the award.

Carson has always guarded her personal life, except when she published an essay in *The London Review of Books* announcing that she suffers from Parkinson's disease and bemoaning that it had affected her handwriting. When the Swedish Academy contacted her, she said she had been avoiding phone calls from everyone and was planning to go for a walk in the forest with her husband in Iceland, where she also holds citizenship.

The game changer

Harmanpreet Kaur

The cricketer who helped popularise women's cricket in India has stepped down as captain but will continue to play for the national team

P.K. Ajith Kumar

Dressed in a dark blue blazer and white trousers, her hair gathered in a tight ponytail and her hands clasped behind her back, Harmanpreet Kaur is looking at the famous balcony at Lord's. The camera has captured the moment from behind, as she stands there on cricket's best-known venue, situated in northwest London.

The picture seems to have been taken in July, during the photoshoot ahead of the historic Women's Test match between India and England. It was the first ever women's Test at Lord's, the history of which dates back 239 years. Harmanpreet chose that image for the Instagram post through which she announced her decision to step down as the India captain. Harmanpreet's fairly long and well-written message was posted on Tuesday. It has had 1.4 million views and about 30,500 comments.

Not everyone who viewed the photograph in the post would have been a long-time follower of women's cricket. It is not even a decade since female practitioners of India's favourite obsession began to be known beyond their families and friends, apart from a small circle of committed supporters.

ILLUSTRATION: SREEJITH R. KUMAR

And it was Harmanpreet who forced the Indian cricket fan to take a closer look at the women's game. In the semifinal of the 2017 World Cup at Derby, she played an innings that still remains perhaps the greatest played by a woman. Her 171 not out off just 115 balls stunned defending champions Australia. Former Australian captain Alyssa Healy said it even forced her team to change the way it played its cricket.

Innings of a lifetime

Harmanpreet's own hero, Virender Sehwag, called it an innings of a lifetime and tweeted "Harmanpreet Kaur...Fan!" When she was a little girl growing up in Punjab's Moga wanting to be a cricketer, when hardly anyone there knew women even played the game, she used to be teased by her brother, "What will you do – open with Sehwag?"

Two years after that out-of-the-world knock, Harmanpreet had told this writer, during an interview in Surat, how much she used to wish for people to come and watch women play cricket. She was grateful destiny chose her to play a part in making it possible.

Harmanpreet was the catalyst, but it was the BCCI's decision to take women's cricket under its wings that brought visibility and professionalism to the game. Then the launch of the Women's Premier League (WPL), in 2023, and India's victory at the ODI World Cup at home last year have expanded the fan base. Harmanpreet was the captain who led India to that World Cup win; it was India's first global trophy in women's cricket. She was also the skipper when Mumbai Indians emerged as the WPL champion in the inaugural edition.

She has had a lot of success in recent times, too. Under her captaincy, India won the Asia Cup and then the gold medal at the Asian Games. Before that, India crushed England in that Test match at Lord's. That was only her fifth Test as captain. That women get to play very few matches in the game's finest format remains a cause for concern even in these rosy times. She led India in 51 One-Day Internationals and 155 Twenty20 Internationals.

Overall, she has played eight Tests, 164 ODIs and 210 T20Is. Those numbers could grow further, as she has clearly said she wants to continue to play for India, though she has resigned as captain. She has plenty to offer as a player, and India needs her in the line-up. She remains one of the best batters in the game. Few women could hit a cricket ball as hard as she could. Her ability to hit hard was noticed early. And she had worked hard on that. Her first coach Yadwinder Singh made her hit 100 to 150 sixes every day. She debuted for India in 2009. Three years later, she led the country for the first time at the Asia Cup in 2012 – it would take a few years before she was made captain full-time – and India emerged as champions. She went on to lead India in many more memorable wins.

As she looked at the Lord's balcony that sunny day in July, in the twilight of her career, some of those images may have passed through her mind.

CAIRO

Rights group says paramilitary drone strike in Sudan killed 41

AFP

A drone strike blamed on Sudan's notorious paramilitaries hit a gathering of displaced people on the border with Ethiopia and killed 41, a rights group said. The strike by the Rapid Support Forces, which killed eight children, took place in the Abu Shandi area in Sudan's Blue Nile province, Emergency Lawyers said. AP

RAMALLAH

Abbas postpones Palestinian legislative elections to Sept. 2027

AP

Palestinian President Mahmoud Abbas on Saturday postponed legislative elections to September next year, official media said, confirming widespread speculation over the polls which were last held in 2006. The vote will be held alongside presidential elections on September 11, 2027, Mr. Abbas said in a decree. AFP

WASHINGTON

Trump appoints Katie Zacharia as White House press secretary

U.S. President Donald Trump announced the appointment of conservative commentator Katie Zacharia as his new White House press secretary, praising her as a loyal supporter. Ms. Zacharia, a lawyer and communications adviser to Trump's media company, will succeed Karoline Leavitt, who stepped down in August. AFP

SAN FRANCISCO

Anthropic AI model sent fake murder tip to Philadelphia police

REUTERS

An artificial intelligence model developed by Anthropic submitted a fabricated tip about an unsolved homicide to Philadelphia police, authorities said on Friday, criticising the company for taking two months to report the incident. The episode heightened concerns about the industry's increased use of AI agents. AFP

Trump strikes deal with Putin to get diesel in sharp reversal of U.S. policy

The deal reverses years of U.S. pressure on Moscow over its war in Ukraine and contradicts a new U.S. sanctions law against Russian energy revenues; while Zelenskyy calls the move a 'weak decision', Trump says Ukraine should 'get a new President'

Associated Press
WASHINGTON

Changing stance: Donald Trump leaves the stage after speaking during an election rally in Syracuse, New York on Friday. AFP

U.S. President Donald Trump said he has struck a deal to obtain diesel from Russia, a reversal of years of U.S. pressure on Moscow over its war with Ukraine and an attempt to address high fuel prices ahead of the U.S. midterm elections.

Mr. Trump said on social media on Friday that he struck the deal with Russian President Vladimir Putin in a phone call in which he was expected to discuss a suspected case of plague in Russia. Instead, Mr. Trump announced that Russia will immediately supply more than 300,000 tonnes of diesel, followed by an additional 500,000 tonnes in November and one million tonnes "immediately thereafter". Russia will deliver an additional 3 million tonnes "within a short period of time" after that, he wrote.

Mr. Trump's shocking announcement was in stark contrast to a sweeping Russia sanctions law he signed last month that aimed at clamping down on the oil and gas revenues that fuel Russia's war against Ukraine.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy called it "a weak decision, unfortunately, a weak decision by strong partners," according to a statement released by the Ukrainian Embassy in Washington.

Asked about the criticism on Saturday, Mr. Trump told presspersons that Mr. Zelenskyy had disobeyed his orders not to strike Russian refineries. Mr. Trump said the strikes risk worsening global fuel shortages caused by the U.S.-Israeli war on Iran.

"He better damn well stop," Mr. Trump said of the strikes, before adding that Ukraine should "get a new President".

"I suggest they get a new leader who can make a deal, because he could have made many deals that, for some reason, he never does".

Mr. Trump's move casts doubt on the likelihood of the White House imposing new sanctions on Russia, given that the law that passed overwhelmingly by Congress directs the administration to target countries that purchase Russian oil and gas.

EU foreign policy chief Kaja Kallas said that lifting sanctions on Russian diesel helped fuel Kremlin's war on Ukraine.

Missile strikes passenger terminal at Riyadh airport

Associated Press
CAIRO

The airport in Saudi Arabia's capital, Riyadh, was attacked again on Saturday and evacuated, two regional officials said, just days after three Saudi citizens, including a pilot, were killed as the kingdom faces an extraordinary series of assaults in the new front in the Iran war.

U.S. President Donald Trump told presspersons he was evaluating whether the U.S. should join Saudi strikes against the Houthi (Ansar Allah) rebels in neighbouring Yemen who have claimed this week's attacks on King Khalid International Airport as well as other Saudi airports, military facilities and oil infrastructure.

"We may. We're going to look at it," Mr. Trump said.

Thick black smoke and flames rising from a fire at King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh.

"We just found out about the recent attack. So we'll make a decision. We move very quickly."

In the latest attack, a missile struck a complex housing terminals 3 and 4 for domestic flights at the Riyadh airport and many people were wounded, an official said. Saudi civil aviation authorities said operations at the airport had been suspended and the number of wounded and damage were being assessed. An official notice to aviators said the suspension was through midnight. The airport had a heavy police presence, with all entrances blocked, and lights around the complex were dimmed.

Flights diverted elsewhere, the Flightradar24 tracker said. Countries including the United States, Britain, Germany, Australia and Canada warned citizens to avoid the airport.

Meanwhile, Saudi authorities warned the public that "filming, publishing or sharing information related to countering missiles and drones and their impact sites exposes you to legal liability".

Russian attacks on Zaporizhzhia region in Ukraine kill 20

Associated Press
KYIV

Russian strikes killed at least 20 people in Ukraine's Zaporizhzhia region, Ukrainian officials said on Saturday.

Three children were among those killed when Russian aerial bombs hit residential buildings in Zaporizhzhia, Ukraine's State Emergency Service said on Saturday. At least 18 people were wounded in the attack.

Missiles also struck Kyiv in a daytime attack on Saturday. Mayor Vitalii Klitschko said four people were wounded.

"Today, Russia expressed its thanks for the lifting of sanctions on diesel exports by dropping five glide bombs on residential buildings in Zaporizhzhia," Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy wrote on Saturday on X.

"Russia's choice is war," Mr. Zelenskyy said after drone attacks on energy facilities and a ballistic missile attack on Kyiv.

Pakistan has established 'robust' nuclear security regime, says IAEA after review

Press Trust of India
ISLAMABAD

Pakistan has established a "robust nuclear security regime" for protecting nuclear material and facilities, the International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA) has said after completing its first physical protection advisory mission to the country.

A seven-member IAEA team concluded a 12-day International Physical Protection Advisory Service (IPPAS) mission on Friday, conducted from September 28 to October 9 at the request of the Pakistani government.

Hosted by the Pakistan Nuclear Regulatory Authority (PNRA), the mission reviewed the country's legislative and regulatory framework for nuclear security and assessed physical protection measures at a nuclear facility.

"The IPPAS team noted that Pakistan has established a robust nuclear security regime for physical protection of nuclear material and nuclear facilities, which was observed to be appropriately implemented at the facility visited,"

The regime is continually improved through periodic reviews, says IAEA. REUTERS

the IAEA said. It added that the regime is continually improved through periodic reviews, while Pakistan's capacity-building infrastructure contributes to nuclear security expertise at the national, regional and international levels.

The team met officials from the PNRA, Pakistan Atomic Energy Commission and other stakeholders and visited the KANUPP Decommissioning Project at the Karachi Nuclear Power Generating Station.

Pakistan's first nuclear power plant, the Canadian Deuterium Uranium reactor, began operations in 1971 and was permanently shut down in 2021. Experts observed decommissioning activities and spent-fuel storage at the site.

Lai says Taiwan won't give up freedom in National Day speech

Associated Press
TAIPEI

Taiwanese President Lai Ching-te said Taiwan cherishes peace but will not give up its freedom, in a speech marking the island's National Day on Saturday as tensions over Taiwan persist between the U.S. and China.

Mr. Lai's speech soon drew Beijing's criticism, accusing him of disregarding facts and misleading the public.

Mr. Lai said China has exerted pressure in an attempt to change the status quo across the Taiwan Strait, and the island's "resolve" is not just about its own survival in the face of "authoritarian expansion". It's also about whether the international community still believes that force cannot override rules, he said.

China's Taiwan Affairs Office spokesperson Zhang Han criticized Lai for what she called stubbornly clinging to a "Taiwan independence" mindset in his speech.

Sport

Anushka Yadav ends the year as National champion

ATHLETICS

Uthra Ganesan
NEW DELHI

Crowd-puller: All eyes were on Baranica after her Asian Games exploits and she did not disappoint. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

National record holder Anushka Yadav added the National champion tag to her name to round up an eventful year, claiming the hammer throw gold on day three of the National open athletics championships here on Saturday.

The 18-year-old Anushka threw to a distance of 66.53m to better the previous meet record of Manju Rani by more than two metres. Interestingly, Anushka, who finished fifth at Aichi-Nagoya, also managed a better throw than her performance there – her Saturday's mark could have helped her finish one position higher and ahead of teammate and former National record holder Tanya Chaudhary.

Also doing better than what he could manage at the Asian Games was shotputter Karanveer Singh, taking the top spot with a best throw of 19.63m.

Kiran Pahal, a member of the Indian quartet that won the lone athletics gold at the Asian Games, anchored Railways to the gold in the 4x400m mixed relay in 3:21.60.

Bengal's Shampa Gain completed her 5000-10000m double, adding the second title to her gold in the former on Day One of competition, completing 10k in 35:33.90.

Shivaji Madappa was unable to do the same, though, having to be content with silver in the 5000m after winning the 10k on Thursday. However, Rohit took advantage of the absence of Sarvesh Kushare and Aadarsh Ram in the high jump, winning with a best of 2.19m.

The results: Men: 5000m: 1. Sunil Dawar (MP, 14:01.64), 2. Shivaji Madappa (RSPB, 14:02.81), 3. Ajay Bind (RSPB, 14:03.86). **4x100m:** 1. SSCB (39.76s), 2. RSPB (40.75s), 3. Haryana (41.37s); **Shot put:** 1. Karanveer Singh (Pun, 19.63m), 2. Sanyam (RSPB, 18.32m), 3. Anurag Kaler (RSPB, 18.32m); **High jump**: 1. Rohit (RSPB, 2.19m), 2. Jesse Sandesh (RSPB, 2.16m), 3. Aaditya Raghuvanshi (MP, 2.16m).

Women: 10000m: 1. Shampa Gain (Ben, 35:33.90), 2. Soniya (Utk, 35:35.36), 3. K.M. Mamta (AIPSCB, 35:38.25); **4x100m:** 1. RSPB (45.56s), 2. Odisha (45.57s), 3. Tamil Nadu (46.03s); **Long jump:** 1. Mubassina Mohd. (ONGC, 6.38m), 2. Shaili Singh (UP, 6.37m), 3. Nidhi (UP, 6.28m); **Pole vault**: 1. Baranica Elangovan (RSPB, 4.10m), 2. Mariya Jaison (RSPB, 3.90m), 3. Sindhushree G. (Kar, 3.80m); **Hammer**: 1. Anushka Yadav (ONGC, 66.53m), 2. Haqikat Grewal (Pun, 56.14m), 3. Kulvinder (RSPB, 55.22m); **Javelin**: 1. Ramyashree Jain (RSPB 56.63m), 2. Sanjana Chaudhary (Raj, 56.12m), 3. Deepika (Har, 54.07m).

Mixed: 4x400m: 1. RSPB (3:21.60), 2. Haryana (3:22.43), 3. Rajasthan (3:25.54).

LIVE TELECAST

India-A vs Australia-A: Third one-dayer, JioHotstar, 9 a.m.
Ranji Trophy: Day 1, JioHotstar, 9 a.m.
Afghanistan vs Bangladesh: Only Test, day 3, FanCode, 11 a.m.
South Africa vs Australia: First Test, day 3, Eurosport & FanCode, 1 p.m.
Formula One: Singapore GP, F1 TV, F1 TV Pro App & FanCode, 5.30 p.m.
Premier League: SS Select 1, 2 & JioHotstar, 6.30 & 9.30 p.m.
India vs West Indies: Third T20I, Star Sports 2 & JioHotstar, 7 p.m.

Double delight for Verstappen

FORMULA ONE

Agence France-Presse
SINGAPORE

Max Verstappen roared to the pole position for the Singapore Grand Prix and continued a dominant weekend here.

The Red Bull driver, who won the sprint race earlier, clocked a flying lap of 1m 31.373s to head the Ferrari pair of Charles Leclerc and Lewis Hamilton, with championship leader Kimi Antonelli fourth in the Mercedes.

Being at the front of the grid gives the 29-year-old Dutchman the perfect platform to hunt for his maiden GP victory in Singapore at the 10th time of asking since his debut in 2015. Earlier, Verstappen won a wet and wild sprint race after Russell crashed his Mercedes while leading in the opening lap.

The grid: First row: Verstappen (Red Bull), Leclerc (Ferrari). **Second:** Hamilton (Ferrari), Antonelli (Mercedes). **Third:** Norris (McLaren), Russell (Mercedes). **Fourth:** Piastri (McLaren), Gasly (Alpine). **Fifth:** Lawson (Racing Bulls), Lindblad (Racing Bulls). **Sixth:** Hulkenberg (Audi), Bearman (Haas). **Seventh:** Ocon (Haas), Sainz Jr. (Williams). **Eighth:** Bortoleto (Audi), Colapinto (Alpine). **Ninth:** Alonso (Aston Martin), Albon (Williams). **10th:** Stroll (Aston Martin), Perez (Cadillac); **11th:** Bottas (Cadillac), Hadjar (Red Bull). (Russell qualified sixth but will start from the back of the grid after being penalised for using too many new parts).

SCOPE FOR IMPROVEMENT

You need to figure out a way to defend, says coach Gambhir

PTI

No, you don't shrug off any defeat. If you want to keep improving, you don't want to put anything under the carpet. We are a World-champion team, and we want to keep improving. When you play against dangerous teams like the West Indies, you need to figure out a way to defend — India head coach Gautam Gambhir.

NO SHORTCUTS

'Games are not decided in the first over, need to play consistently'

K.R. DEEPAK

I have played enough cricket to know that games are not decided in the first over. They (Windies) are a strong T20I side and we respect them. A game of cricket [T20I] is won when you play consistently for 40 overs — Gautam Gambhir on India not being able to defend 249 after taking two wickets in the opening over.

GUTSY DISPLAY

Rahmat leads Afghanistan's response against Bangladesh

X@ACBOFFICIALS

Rahmat Shah (84 batting) took Afghanistan to 211 for four on the second day of the one-off Test against Bangladesh in Abu Dhabi. **The scores:** Bangladesh 346 in 92.3 overs (Shadman Islam 67, Tanzid Hasan 83, Litton Das 53, Mohammed Saleem 4/82) vs. Afghanistan 211/4 in 79 overs (Abdul Malik 62, Rahmat 84 batting).

DISCIPLINARY ACTION

Portugal suspends Ronaldo after national team walkout

AFP

Cristiano Ronaldo has been provisionally suspended as Portuguese federation said on Saturday it had opened disciplinary proceedings against the 41-year-old following his decision to walk out on the national team. Ronaldo apologised to supporters earlier this week and said he would serve any "suspension that is imposed" on him.

India, Windies keen to get their nose ahead in slam-bang fest

The home attack conceding sixes with alarming frequency will be a big worry for the team management; the Caribbean batters have come to the party but the bowlers need to raise their performance; fielding could make the difference

WI IN INDIA

S. Shrivathsan
INDORE

Fulfilment of duty will meet fulfilment of dream when India and the West Indies cross swords in the third episode of the T20I series at the Holkar Stadium here on Sunday.

Considering the imperious form the Men in Blue have maintained in the slam-bang format on home soil – they last lost a series in the country back in 2019 – they are expected to win every assignment in their backyard. While the first match in Lucknow went like clockwork for India, West Indies showed in the second clash in Ranchi that it means business.

For Shreyas Iyer and Co., it will be a matter of not leaving it late to preserve that proud record. If the home side is to regain the lead in the five-game joust, it must course correct quickly. The frequency at which the bowlers conceded sixes in the previous encounter must have left head coach Gautam Gambhir scratching his head.

The away team smashed as many as 20 maximums off 111 legitimate deliveries, with the over-the-rope hits contributing to nearly half of its successful 250-run pursuit.

But firebrand pacer Mayank Yadav's frightening burst before the visitors rendered their Calypso beats with the willow, should have brought some cheer to the Indian camp.

The fielding department, however, continues to cause a headache to the powers that be. In such times, the stacked batting unit has been like a refreshing breeze on a sultry day. Having watched his teammates convert starts and relish performing their art on belters, flamboyant opener Abhishek Sharma would hope to be third time lucky.

For West Indies, skipper Shai Hope has provided more than just a glimmer of hope after giving a shellacking to India.

By chasing down a humongous total in the last match, the touring team has reminded everyone that no target is beyond reach for its 'boundary-hitting machines'.

The manner in which the Caribbean outfit wriggled out of early trouble and eventually sailed home must boost its morale.

The batters, in Sherfane Rutherford's words, have made up when the bowlers have had off days, but West Indies cannot allow the trend to continue.

With hardly any time to venture outdoors and perfectly assess the Indore surface, swiftly adapting to the conditions will be the pressing priority.

Competing in the nation's cleanest city, both sides, irrespective of the personnel they field, will target a spotless show.

Back to his best: India captain Shreyas has been in sparkling form. K.R. DEEPAK

West Indies' beacon of Hope ready for redemption

Sankar Narayanan E.H.
RANCHI

Leading the charge: Hope has pulled his weight for West Indies with sizzling knocks. K.R. DEEPAK

Shai has been a beacon of Hope for Caribbean cricket.

The West Indian's batting graph has gone north ever since landing in India. After five outings against the Men in Blue across three ODIs and two T20Is, Hope has added 432 runs to his tally.

It's tough to pick out his best knock on the tour as there are three centuries and a half-century to choose from. Perhaps he will narrow it down to the unbeaten ones: 162 in the New Chandigarh ODI and 102 in the Ranchi T20I. He hit the winning runs in both, sealing the Windies' highest successful run-chase in the 50- and 20-over formats (352 and 250 respectively).

That it was his first T20I century may tip the balance towards his exploits at the JSCA Stadium on Friday. "I think people underrate Hope a lot. He is a guy who can blank out noise and focus on what he has to do. Because when everything seems to be going wrong, he's still up there giving his best and performing for the team," West Indies all-rounder Roston Chase said after the visitors' record chase.

Hope is not one to use brute force – a trait popular among the West Indian willow-wielders – and he has often had to face criticism about his strike-rate. That has been taken care of with his ball-striking against India (SR of 112.10 in ODIs and 187.80 in T20Is).

"People play down his stats in T20 cricket. They say he either bats too slowly or bats for himself. But I know he's the ultimate professional who tries to tick every box," Chase added. Hope's upgrade hasn't just been built on hope. "He's done a lot of gym work to make himself stronger in terms of hitting the ball over the ropes. He also practises a lot of range-hitting," Chase revealed.

Hope's heroics drew praise even from the opposition camp. "We know Shai is a world-class cricketer. We respect him for what he has done in white-ball cricket," said India coach Gautam Gambhir.

Hope – as the famous Shawshank Redemption dialogue goes – is a good thing, maybe the best of things. Now, Shai Hope's best is here, ready for some redemption!

Genuine pace: Mayank jumps for joy after castling Powell with a thunderbolt. K.R. DEEPAK

Keep it simple and fast: Mayank breathes fire

Sankar Narayanan E.H.
RANCHI

Not everyone can bowl fast. Not everyone who can bowl fast bowls fast all the time.

Is that a good thing? India head coach Gautam Gambhir is of the opinion that speedsters who have been given the gift of pace should let it rip.

Mayank Yadav is part of the ilk that can bowl fast, very fast. In the series opener against the West Indies, the 24-year-old experimented too much with his pace. His slower deliveries, which lacked deception, were found out and feasted on by the powerful West Indians.

The fast bowler turned out to be a fast learner. He quickly understood he should be quick, and quick he was come the second T20I.

He took three wickets at the JSCA Stadium, all with high-paced, high-quality deliveries. While Kamil Pooran mistimed a short ball straight up (143.6kph), Shimron Hetmyer (144.5) and Rovman Powell (149.5) lost their stumps before they could react to Mayank's thunderbolts.

The Ranchi crowd erupting in perfect lockstep with Mayank's leap as Powell's off-stump went cartwheeling was a sight to behold.

"He is a fast bowler, and he should bowl like one. If you are capable of bowling at 150, then do that. When you are a fast bowler, it is your responsibility to bowl fast. That's what Mayank did, and that's why he was successful," Gambhir said.

Whether it be his fielding or his primary art of pace bowling, Mayank still has a long way to go.

But as Gambhir suggests, his path forward is clear: keep it simple, and keep it fast.

Renshaw's marathon knock propels Australia

Agence France-Presse
DURBAN

Australia struck early in South Africa's innings after Matt Renshaw made a career-best 190 and steered the tourists into a strong position on the second day of the first Test on Saturday. South Africa was 27 for one in reply to Australia's 390 when bad light stopped play.

Renshaw's monumental innings, spanning almost eight hours, enabled Australia add 203 runs to its overnight total of 187 for six. Renshaw played an almost flawless innings, taking most of the strike on a pitch which had lost much of its life since Australia had been reduced to 124 for six on the first day.

The scores: Australia 390 in 137.2 overs (Renshaw 190, Cummins 43, Mulder 4/68) vs. South Africa 27/1 in 8.4 overs.

Renshaw. AFP

Marathas blank Chiefs; Yodhas win a thriller

APL

Anirudh Velamuri
HYDERABAD

Mighty Marathas registered the first clean sweep of Archery Premier League season-2, beating Chola Chiefs 6-0 at People's Plaza here on Saturday.

Led by Mike Schloesser and anchored by Dhiraj Bommadevara under time pressure, Marathas brought up their first win of the campaign in style. Schloesser lived up to his 'Mr. Perfect' nickname, shooting 10s with all six arrows for Marathas.

Chiefs stuck to their tactic of having their compound archers shoot back-to-back at the start of the set, but Chikitha Tanipartthi's two 9s put a dent in their plans and they fell behind. After that, Marathas did enough to comfortably stay ahead and seal the win.

Chero Archers and Prithviraj Yodhas then played out the most nail-biting contest of the evening, with both going toe-to-toe to take the match into a hit-or-miss. There was little to separate the two there too, much to the delight of the packed stands.

Matias Grande finally managed to find the inner ring, sending the Yodhas' camp into loud celebrations. Pritika Pradeep couldn't emulate Grade, giving Yodhas a thrilling victory.

In the final match, Kakatiya Knights came from behind to emerge victorious against Rajputana Royals.

Bullseye: Dheeraj and Schloesser were on target as the Marathas proved unstoppable. SIDDHANT THAKUR

Neeraj shines

Neeraj Chauhan was the star for Knights, coming up with clutch X-ring 10s while Jyothi Surekha Vennam was also on fire.

While Mete Gazoz helped Royals take the first set with a pressure 10 in the first set, it was Neeraj and Jyothi who led Knights' fightback. They, in fact, missed the perfect 80 after Neeraj could only come up with a nine with the final arrow of the day.

The results: Chola Chiefs lost to Mighty Marathas 0-6 (73-74, 75-78, 71-74).
Chero Archers lost to Prithviraj Yodhas 4-4 (0-1) (64-74, 76-74, 76-75, 71-74).
Rajputana Royals lost to Kakatiya Knights 2-6 (75-74, 74-75, 76-77, 74-79).

Arsenal comes from behind to beat Leeds

EURO LEAGUES

Agence France-Presse
LONDON

Arsenal roared back to beat Leeds 2-1 and pull level with Manchester City at the top of the Premier League on Saturday, Chelsea ran rampant in a 5-1 rout of Bournemouth while Manchester United conceded to Tottenham late in stoppage time to settle for a 1-1 draw.

Bayern Munich twice came from behind to draw 2-2 at Augsburg after a mistake from Manuel Neuer led to the fastest goal – after just 8.4 seconds – in Bundesliga history.

Anthony Gordon scored his first goal for Barcelona as it extended its perfect start in LaLiga with a 3-0 win over Getafe on Saturday while Cristiano Romero's header earned Atletico Madrid a narrow 2-1 win at 10-man Alaves.

Inter Milan surged to the top of Serie A on Saturday. thanks to three goals in the first half an hour to outclass Parma 3-0 at the San Siro.

The results: Premier League:
Arsenal 2 (Calafiori 62, Guimaraes 70) bt Leeds 1 (Justin 55); Aston Villa 2 (Jackson 12, McGinn 77) drew with Brentford 2 (Yarmoliuk 10, Ajer 79); Chelsea 5 (Henderson 2, 70, Rogers 3, Pedro 46, 67) bt Bournemouth 1 (Evanilson 51).
Ipswich 2 (Ouattara 88, O'Shea 90+1) bt Fulham 1 (Sessegnon 55); Sunderland 0 lost to Brighton 2 (De Cuyper 53, Hadjam 90+3); Manchester United 1 (Mbeumo 73) drew with Tottenham 1 (Solanke 90+2).
LaLiga: Alaves 1 (Boye 45+6-pen) lost to Atletico Madrid 2 (Grimaldo 33, Romero 87); Barcelona 3 (Gordon 2, Jesus 30, Kounde 73) bt Getafe 0.
Bundesliga: Augsburg 2 (Fellhauer 1, Ribeiro 64) drew with Bayern Munich 2 (Saibari 55, Brown 80).
Mainz 3 (Caci 33, 42, Hollerbach 90+2) lost to Bayer Leverkusen 4 (Andrich 5, Schick 9, Quansah 55, Diaby 65).
Serie A: Inter Milan 3 (Sucic 13, Calhanoglu 18-pen, Thuram 31) bt Parma 0.
On Friday: Bundesliga: Borussia Dortmund 2 (Svensson 80, Schlotterbeck 85) drew with Werder Bremen 2 (Reis 88, Fullkrug 90+2).

Back in business: Calafiori, right, ignites Arsenal's riposte against Leeds. REUTERS

Plenty of incentives for hopefuls as the grind begins

History proves that there has been no dearth of great stories in the country's premier domestic competition; the opening round will feature an array of stars such as Rahul and Jaiswal in action

RANJI TROPHY

N. Sudarshan
VIJAYAWADA

There is an ever-so-slight feast and famine feel to this season's Ranji Trophy.

The opening round of India's premier red-ball competition, which begins on Sunday, is set to feature a battery of stars, including Karnataka's K.L. Rahul and Mumbai's Yashasvi Jaiswal.

But after that, the big guns are expected to depart for New Zealand, first for the A-series and then the Tests.

Yet, history shows that the Ranji terrain has seldom suffered a drought of great stories. The tournament is in its 10th decade, but like a classic old fiddle, it continues to play the good tunes.

One needs to look no further than the previous campaign when Jammu & Kashmir won its maiden Ranji title by overcoming past champions in Madhya Pradesh, Bengal and Karnataka consecutively.

The catalyst: Pacer Nabi played a stellar role in Jammu & Kashmir's fairytale campaign last season. FILE PHOTO: K. MURALI KUMAR

Topping the charts

Auqib Nabi's chart-topping 60 wickets fashioned that historic triumph, and his prize was an India cap, albeit in the one-day game.

Vidarbha left-arm spinner Harsh Dubey's 69 wickets in 2024-25 did not go unnoticed. Neither did Karnataka southpaw R. Smaran's competition-leading 950 runs in 2025-26.

Rewarded

Harsh has since played for India (ODIs), and Smaran, following his match-winning effort for Rest of India in the recent Irani Cup, will soon fly out to New Zealand with the A-squad.

With the Ranji Trophy running parallelly to the National team's busy home season, there is always a lurking fear that the tournament may struggle to attract interest.

But this time, there will certainly be a National selector or two glancing over, for it will bookend India's upcoming Test series versus New Zealand and Australia, which are also the last two opportunities for Shubman Gill & Co. to make the grade for the World Test Championship final. The 2026-27 Ranji Trophy will start just over a month before the first of two Tests against the Kiwis in Wellington.

It is scheduled to finish on the same day Australia will end its five-Test Indian sojourn in Ahmedabad in March 2027.

Like the previous two editions, it will be played in two phases, with the Vijay Hazare Trophy (50 overs) and Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy (T20) sandwiched in between. However, in a slight departure, the first phase will see four rounds of group-stage matches instead of five, with the other three played mid-January onwards.

Thick and fast

Fixtures will also come thick and fast, with no more than four days' gap. But such is the allure of the red ball that one can always bet on a willing mind dragging a tired body over the line.

RANJI SCHEDULE — FIRST ROUND

Group A: Bihar vs. Uttar Pradesh (Rajgir); Goa vs. Baroda (Panaji); Jammu & Kashmir vs. Madhya Pradesh (Srinagar); Vidarbha vs. Pondicherry (Nagpur).
Group B: Hyderabad vs. Tripura (Hyderabad); Andhra vs. Karnataka (Vijayawada); Punjab vs. Assam (New Chandigarh); Saurashtra vs. Chhattisgarh (Rajkot).
Group C: Jharkhand vs. Kerala (Jamshedpur); Bengal vs. Delhi (Kalyani); Gujarat vs. Odisha (Ahmedabad); Services vs. Maharashtra (New Delhi).
Group D: Haryana vs. Himachal Pradesh (Lahli); Railways vs. Uttarakhand (Brabourne Stadium, Mumbai); Rajasthan vs. Tamil Nadu (Jaipur); Mumbai vs. Chandigarh (Wankhede Stadium, Mumbai).
Plate: Sikkim vs. Meghalaya (Rangpo); Mizoram vs. Manipur (Nadiad); Arunachal Pradesh vs. Nagaland (Ahmedabad).

Will TN's top-of-the-class cricket ecosystem finally shine through?

S. Prasanna Venkatesan
JAIPUR

There was a long-running joke until Tamil Nadu ended its 33-year wait for a second Ranji Trophy title in 1988 – the only way the team could have the trophy was by stealing it!

Nearly four decades on, it still retains an uncomfortable currency. At the 2023 TNCA annual day function, former president N. Srinivasan posed a question that was as simple as it was pointed: if Vidarbha could win the trophy, why not Tamil Nadu, with one of the country's best cricket ecosystems? Jammu & Kashmir's rise to the summit has since made that question harder to avoid.

On Sunday, Tamil Nadu returns to the business of answering that question when it opens its latest campaign against Rajasthan at the Sawai Mansingh Stadium here. The fixture carries its history: Rajasthan was Tamil Nadu's opponent in the 2011-12 Ranji final. Both teams would hope this season carries them that far again – and beyond.

Tamil Nadu's new coach Yo Mahesh said on Saturday that frequent changes had denied the team stability in recent seasons. "There were a lot of changes happening consistently, which didn't really help the team. When we have so much talent in the room, we need to trust them," he said.

"We need to give them that security and a stable environment. That's when their best is going to come. We need to crack the combination. Definitely, chopping and changing won't happen that much (this season)."

The pace attack lacks experience. All-rounder Sonu Yadav is its most experienced member, with just 10 First Class matches. "Some really good fast bowlers have been coming through the junior ranks. This is an attempt to give them a starting point. They have a lot of promise, but it will take some time. When it falls into place, it's going to be something we can bank on for the next five years," the coach said.

Tamil Nadu received a boost with India all-rounder Washington Sundar joining the squad on Friday. Pacer Esakkimuthu has replaced the injured Pranav Ragavendra.

Key personnel: TN skipper Sai Kishore received a boost with India all-rounder Washington joining the squad. S. PRASANNA VENKATESAN

SNAPSHOTS

Kesharwani and Vaidehee.

Vaidehee clinches third crown; Kesharwani bags maiden title

NEW DELHI: Top seed Vaidehee Chaudhari and sixth seed Maan Kesharwani clinched the women's and men's singles titles respectively at the Fenesta Open National tennis championship on Saturday.

The results (finals):
Women: Vaidehee Chaudhari bt Shruti Ahlawat 6-4, 7-5; **Men:** Maan Kesharwani bt Nitin Sinha 6-0, 6-4.
U-18: Boys: Ribhav Saroha bt Om Ramesh Patel 6-4, 6-3; **Girls:** Parthsarthi Mundhe bt Aahan Aahan 6-3, 6-4.

TN beats Pondicherry

CHANDIGARH: Tamil Nadu scored a 67-run win over Pondicherry in the Vinoo Mankad Trophy under-19 Elite Group C match on Saturday.

The scores:
Tamil Nadu 238 in 49.4 overs (M.G. Nithilan 44, S. Prabanjan 80) bt Pondicherry 171 in 49 overs (Aahil Kachru 60, B.K. Kishore 4/37, S. Prabanjan 3/32).

Two-wicket win for TN

BENGALURU: Tamil Nadu defeated Goa by two wickets in the BCCI women's under-19 Trophy Elite Group D match at the Alur Cricket Stadium-II on Saturday.

The scores:
Goa 116/3 in 20 overs (Usma Akram 50 n.o.) lost to Tamil Nadu 117/8 in 20 overs (Nandana Sridharan 41 n.o., N. Naik 3/27).

Yagavan's five-for highlights Tiger's win

CHENNAI: V. Yagavan's five for 23 set up Tiger CC's comfortable eight-wicket victory over Sounder CC in a TNCA fourth division 'C' zone match held recently. In a fifth division 'A' zone clash, S.K. Rithesh's seven for 31 helped TFUCC secure a comprehensive 102-run win.

The scores:
IV-C: Chennai Port 245/8 in 50 overs (M.K. Akash 37, R.A. Akshai 34, G. Pravin 34, S.J. Simmar 58 n.o., K. Richards 47, M. Srinivasan 3/65, T. Udhayanithi 3/68) bt Fox Trotters 184 in 42.2 overs (C. Surendar 64, A. Syed Shoaib 52, M. Abhiram 3/37).
Galaxy 285/7 in 50 overs (R. Francis Frankfort 130, V. Karthikai Kumaran 49, K.S. Siddarth 34, V. Nakul Varshan 4/80) bt Friends XI 162 in 38.3 overs (P. Vishal 76, V. Ajay 3/44, R. Francis Frankfort 3/32).
Sounder 90 in 34.3 overs (V. Yagavan 5/23) lost to Tiger 93/2 in 16 overs (A.R. Siva Murugan 43 n.o., R. Hiruthick 37).
Youth Centre 182 in 45.5 overs (S. Kaushik Babu 107, C. Suresh 3/48, L. Jai harish 4/51) lost to KMC 188/3 in 39.4 overs (S. Swetheesh Krishnan 62, B. Akshadh Rao 70).
V-A: TFUCC 233/8 in 50 overs (M. Aaship Ahamed 102 n.o., S. Sathya Narayanan 47, K. Mathan 3/59, S. Sachin 3/67) bt Magnet 131 in 38 overs (A. Gokulraaj 41, S.K. Rithesh 7/31).
Triplicane Cosmopolitan 275 in 49.5 overs (Veeramani 87, C. Ashokkumar 88, N. Ebenezer 4/74, T. Adhavan 4/65) lost to Gandhi Nagar Starlets 279/6 in 45.2 overs (B. Arun Kumar 141 n.o., T. Adhavan 33, Abhinav Ramesh 59).
Unicorn 65 in 27.3 overs (K. Kishorekumar 4/24) lost to Gopalapuram 71/3 in 20 overs.
Bharathi SC 240/4 in 50 overs (B. Sashaanth 81, S. Maithresh 102) bt GTUC 164 in 43.5 overs (A. Arun 51, S. Baranidharan 34, S. Kumaresan 5/26, S. Sachin 3/26).
Globe 160 in 45.5 overs (Sudhikshan 62, M. Chandru 3/56, S. Vetrivel 5/28) bt Netaji 112 in 36.5 overs (V.P. Vishal 4/38, V. Ranjith Kumar 3/6).

Yagavan (Tiger, 5/23); Arun (Gandhi Nagar Starlets, 141 n.o.); Francis (Galaxy, 130); Aaship (TFUCC, 102 n.o.).

Rithesh (TFUCC, 7/31); Kaushik (Youth Centre, 107).

Kumaresan (Bharathi SC, 5/26); Maithresh (Bharathi SC, 102).

Vetrivel (Netaji, 5/28).

ENGAGEMENTS

Cricket: TNCA League, III-A: Royapettah vs SPIC (Jones Krish, turf); National RC vs Aruna (Gojan-B, turf); Chatnath vs Indian Bank (A.M. Jain); Falcon vs Sir M.CT.M. Old Boys (PBEL City); Mambalam Mosquitos vs SNJ (Gojan-C, turf); Ranji vs IOB (Tagore), 9 a.m.

IV-A: Prasad vs Reserve Bank (Wahe Guru-B); Vigneswara vs Prithvi (Alstom-B); Kamyuth Club vs Bharathi CC (Union); Book Sellers vs Milkyway (Gojan); Purasawalkam vs Perungalathur (Wahe Guru-A); Sumangali Homes vs Vijay's (Sumangali-A), 9.30 a.m.

V-B: Grand Prix vs Indian Oil (St. Patrick's); CCL vs Vepery (Engg.); Chennai P&T Audit vs Tangedco (St. Bede's-B); Lusuraj vs Free Lancers (St. Bede's-A); YMCC vs Twentieth Century (Gandhi Nagar); MRC-B vs Companions (Fomra-B), 9.30 a.m.

V-C: Sir Ashley Biggs Institute vs Harnath (S. Rly.), 9.30 a.m.

TDCA Women's League, Niranjana XI vs Thirush Kamini XI, 9 a.m., DRBCCC Hindu-A.

TDCA league, IV-A: SSCA vs United, 1 p.m., OCF.

DCAC league, I div., Seshadhri MCC vs SRM IST (SRM University) 9.30 a.m.

II-A, Gurunanak Combines vs Asiatic CA, SMK Fomra-A, 8 a.m.

II-B, Friends XI vs Sritic CC, SMK Fomra-A, 1 p.m.

Top-order under the scanner as India-A looks to avoid clean sweep

Anish Pathiyil
PUDUCHERRY

Australia-A's tour of India will conclude on Sunday with the final one-day against India-A here.

Tim Paine's side has improved continuously as the trip progressed.

After a dispiriting loss in the first multi-day game, it was one wicket away from levelling the red-ball series. Strong bowling performances have helped the team dominate the white-ball games.

It comes into the final game with a chance at a clean sweep.

The pacers stepped up on contrasting surfaces to skittle out an experienced batting pack twice.

If India-A hopes to get on the board in the one-day series, its top-order must hold its fort in the first period of play.

"When you lose three wickets in the PowerPlay, you are already on the back foot and catching up," India-A skipper Ruturaj Gaikwad told broadcasters after the second game. "A lot of credit to them. They have adjusted to the conditions really well. They have batted long and hit the right lengths throughout."

India-A's spin arsenal has been powerless through the middle overs. While the second one-dayer's surface offered turn, its slow nature helped the visiting batters push it through the gaps easily. Ruturaj and the team management will need an aggressive option to operate with the old ball during this phase.

Australia-A rested three players after the first game, and a couple more changes could be due ahead of the finale, with the series already in the bag.

The third one-dayer will begin at 9 a.m. IST.

A draw signals Chennaiyin-Goa ISL campaign opener

Sports Bureau

Chennaiyin FC and FC Goa scored once each in the second half as they began their Indian Super League campaigns with a 1-1 draw in Margao on Saturday.

At the end of a nice passing move in the 63rd minute, Chennaiyin forward Irfan Yadwad unleashed a razor-sharp shot from the edge of the 18-yard area, finding the left corner of the net.

But Goa equalised just before the second cooling break when Christian 'Chiki' Borrego (75th) headed the ball home with precision after being picked out by Aakash Sangwan's sumptuous in-swinger off a free-kick.

CFC striker Ramon Tanque, however, had an excellent opportunity to reclaim the lead in stoppage time.

But the Brazilian failed to punish Goa goalkeeper Bob Jackson, who was off his line, and did not even hit the target at a crucial juncture.

The game was a slow burner with neither team threatening in the opening period that was devoid of clear-cut chances. The match sprang to life some 10 minutes into the second half, with the home side having three cracks at breaking the deadlock.

Borrego was directly involved in two of those: he first tried to put the ball in the far corner instead of chipping it over an out-of-position Mohammad Nawaz and then struck straight at the custodian. But the Spaniard later made amends with the leveller.

Chennaiyin midfielder Ayush Chhetri had luck on his side, avoiding an own goal after a deflection sailed just over the crossbar.

Thunderous strike: Irfan scored for Chennaiyin with a screamer from the edge of the box. X@CHENNAIYINFC

The results: FC Goa 1 (Christian 'Chiki' Borrego 75) drew with Chennaiyin FC 1 (Irfan Yadwad 63).

At Bengaluru: BFC 3 (Borja Martinez 22, 75, Menno Koch 89) bt SC Delhi 2 (Rodriguinho 26, Menno Koch-og 32).

Sunday's matches: Inter Kashi FC vs. Kerala Blasters FC (Pune, 5 p.m.); Churchill Brothers SC vs. Mumbai City FC (Margao, 7.30 p.m.).

Lights-to-flag wins for Ishaan and Gyan

MOTORSPORTS

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

Ishaan Madesh and Gyan Satish recorded lights-to-flag victories in the MRF Formula 2000 and Formula 1600 categories, respectively, in the third round of the MRF Indian National Racing Challenge 4W – 2026 at the Madras International Circuit, here on Saturday.

Ishaan was near-flawless while winning his race with a measure of comfort, outpacing points leader Saishiva Sankaran, just like he did in the third race of the previous round.

Similarly, Gyan did well to stay in front of the pack while keeping a sharp eye on points leader Bhuvan Bonu who finished second with Tanmay Kothari completing the podium.

The results (Provisional, all 8 laps unless mentioned): MRF F2000: Race-1: 1. Ishaan Madesh (12 mins, 47.336 secs); 2. Saishiva Sankaran (12:50.666); 3. Krishay Gutte (12:53.825). **MRF F1600: Race-1:** 1. Gyan Satish (13:58.546); 2. Bhuvan Bonu (13:59.069); 3. Tanmay Kothari (14:05.371). **Formula LGB 1300: Race-1, Open:** 1. Viswas Vijayaraj (DTS Racing) (15:05.241); 2. Vinithkumar (DTS Racing) (15:05.529); 3. T.S. Dilijith (DTS Racing) (15:13.891). **Junior:** 1. Neythan McPherson (Delta Speeds) (15:18.321); 2. Kaveen Rajapaksa (Momentum Motorsports) (15:21.732); 3. Aadam Junaid (Momentum Motorsports) (15:31.381). **Super Stock: Race-1:** 1. Diljith (16:42.380); 2. Lal Kattikulam Bharathan (DTS Racing) (16:46.929); 3. Deepa S. John (DTS Racing) (16:48.315). **MRF Saloons: Race-1:** 1. Aakash Vivek (Redline Racing India) (17:12.082); 2. S. Gokula Rathinam (Redline Racing India) (17:14.889); 3. R. Hemachandran (Redline Racing India) (17:19.637).

Ishaan Madesh.

Factionalism rocks BFI once again

Sports Bureau
KALYANI

Shortly after the boxers contributed six medals, including three gold, to India's campaign at the recently concluded Asian Games, factionalism rocked the Boxing Federation of India (BFI) again.

BFI secretary-general Pramod Kumar has moved a "no-confidence motion" against president Ajay Singh while its CEO Col. (retd.) Arun Malik has countered it, terming the attempt "illegal and unconstitutional".

On October 8, Pramod, claiming the support of a majority of the affiliated state units, sent out a letter convening a Special General Meeting on October 24 with a call for no-confidence motion against Ajay on grounds of "total breakdown of trust and serious governance collapse".

Later, he revised the date to October 28 as a 21-day notice period was required to make such a move.

In response to it, Malik wrote a letter to the units terming Pramod's letter "illegal, unconstitutional and without authority" as "the power to call a Special General Meeting is vested with the president".

The letter urged the units not to treat the communication, issued by Pramod, who himself is "facing a disciplinary enquiry", as a valid notice.

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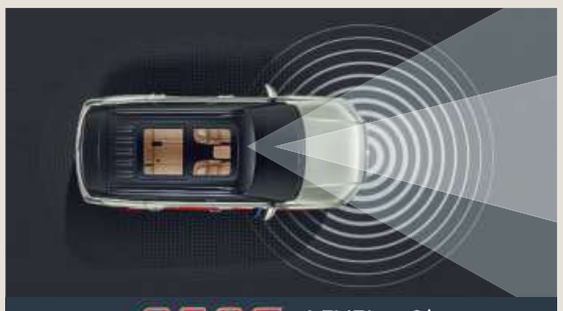

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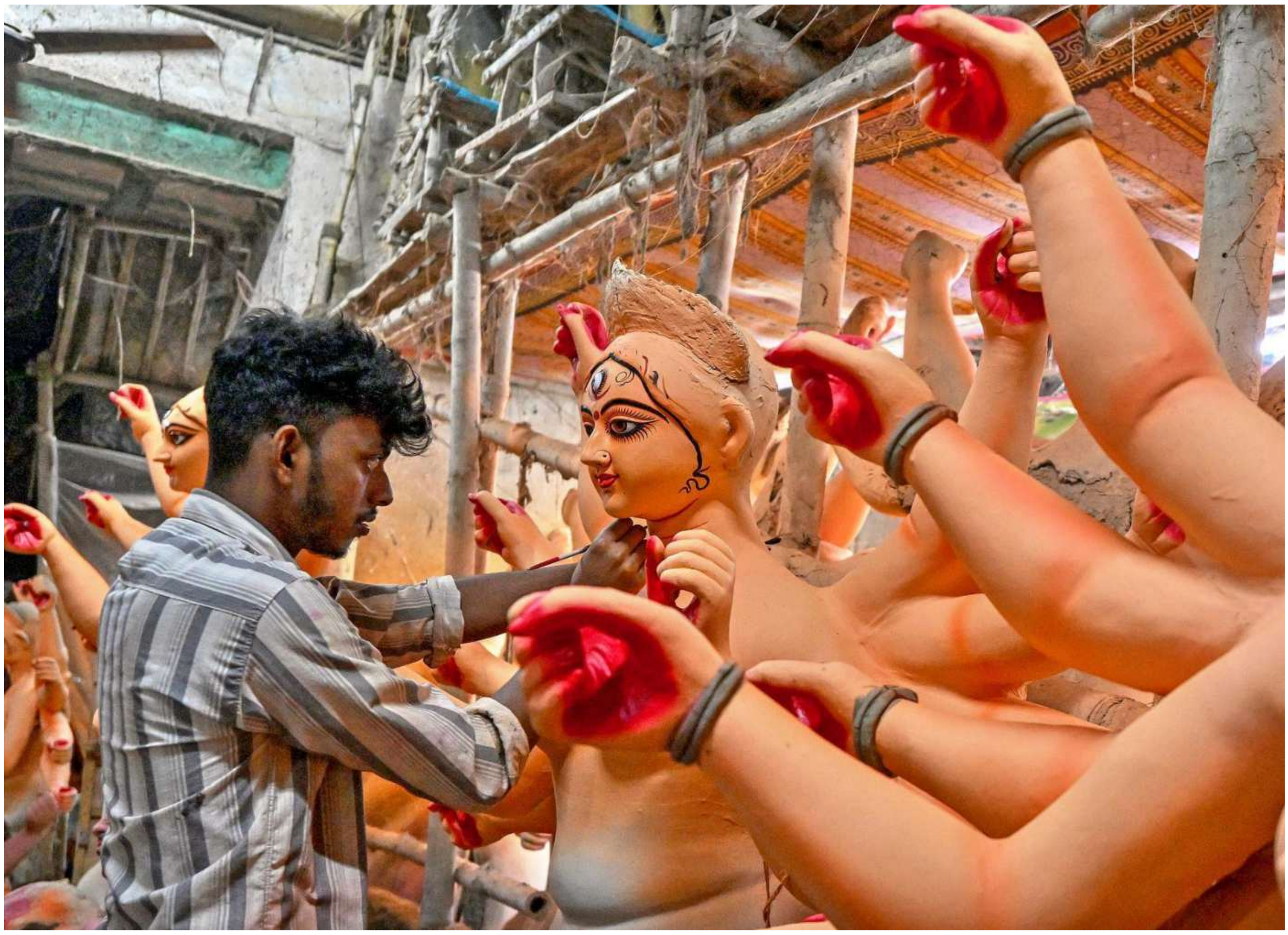
Work in progress: Ahead of Durga Puja, artisans perfect clay idols of Goddess Durga, Lord Ganesh and other deities at Kumartuli in Kolkata.

Basic coat: An artisan sprays paint on a clay idol at Kumartuli, where few women have broken barriers to enter the traditionally male-dominated craft.

Divine details: Idols cost between ₹50,000 and ₹3 lakh, depending on their size, with eco-friendly colours adding to the making charge.



Expert strokes: While some workshops retain the traditional *shabeki* style, others experiment with contemporary designs to meet specific commissions.

Kumartuli: where clay comes alive

In the historic lanes of Kolkata's potters' quarter, majestic idols of Goddess Durga come alive this Puja season as tourists, photographers and social media enthusiasts throng the open-air workshops to witness the meticulous craftsmanship behind the art

K.R. Deepak
deepak.kr@thehindu.co.in

In Kolkata's famed potters' quarter Kumartuli, the rhythm of Durga Puja takes shape in clay. Weeks ahead of the festival, artisans work long hours in cramped workshops, transforming bundles of straw, layers of clay and bamboo frames into majestic idols of Goddess Durga. With remarkable skill and patience, they mould the clay, shape the figures, refine the facial features and carefully paint the idols, gradually bringing the idols to life before they are carried to *puja pandals* across Kolkata and beyond.

Kumartuli's history dates back nearly 300 years and is closely linked to Krishnanagar, in West Bengal's Nadia district. Maharaja Krishnachandra of Krishnanagar is credited with popularising idol worship, with the first Durga Puja believed to have been celebrated there in 1606. Over time, potters from the area migrated to the city, settling along the Hooghly River.

While some workshops retain the traditional *shabeki* style, others experiment with contemporary designs. Idols made for community *pandals* and household *pujas* cost between ₹50,000 and ₹3 lakh, depending on their size, with eco-friendly colours adding to the price. Few women have broken barriers to enter the traditionally male-dominated craft in Kumartuli.

As the festival approaches, the narrow lanes fill with bloggers, photographers, social media influencers and tourists documenting the artisans at work. The crowds reflect how the age-old craft now intersects with tourism and social media, offering visitors a glimpse of Durga Puja preparations and the painstaking craftsmanship behind one of Kolkata's most celebrated festivals.

Celestial celebrities: With precision and patience, artisans mould, shape and paint the clay idols before they are carried to *puja pandals* across Kolkata and beyond.

Moulded by time: For many artisan families, idol-making is a generations-old tradition, with Durga Puja believed to have been first celebrated in Krishnanagar, Nadia district, in 1606.

Festive flair: One of Kolkata's most celebrated festivals, Durga Puja brings communities together in a celebration of faith while providing a livelihood for many.

Young fans: Visitors take selfies and pose for photographs beside unfinished idols of Goddess Durga at Kumartuli.

Form to faith: Artisans breathe life into the clay idols that will soon grace *puja pandals* and move devotees.

Decked to impress: People crowd around to photograph an idol of Goddess Durga as it is readied for transport from Kumartuli.